

DeskPRO Admin Manual

June 5th, 2014 • Revision #22

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1. Introducing DeskPRO

Welcome to DeskPRO, the helpdesk software platform.

This manual explains the details of how to install, configure and manage a DeskPRO helpdesk as an **admin**.

If you just need to know how to help users as an **agent**, please see our [Agent Quick Start Guide](#). If you are new to DeskPRO, we suggest you read the Agent Quick Start Guide before reading this manual.

1.1. Helpdesk basics

If you're completely new to the concept of helpdesk software, you might be wondering why anybody needs a dedicated helpdesk platform like DeskPRO.

Companies that need to manage user issues - whether that's handling complaints from external customers, or IT help requests from colleagues - often start out trying to do it all with email.

The problem with this approach is that email is just not a good tool for tracking issues. If all your support email goes to a single address, it's hard to keep track of who is dealing with which issue; but if each of your staff uses a personalized address, what happens if the staff member who has been dealing with an important client falls sick or leaves the company?

And how do you keep track when a user sends emails from two different addresses, or two people from the same company are chasing the same issue independently?

DeskPRO helps you track issues with **tickets** - each ticket denotes a question, problem or complaint associated with a user. A ticket is a way to tie together everything you know about an issue - all the messages passed between your helpdesk and the user and internally between your agents, which agent or team is dealing with it, whether the user is waiting for a reply or you're waiting to hear back from them, how urgent it is, and so on.

Messages users send by email or via the web are automatically converted into tickets in DeskPRO's web-based agent interface. Agents write replies from the interface and DeskPRO automatically emails them to the user.

1.2. DeskPRO features and benefits

We've worked hard to make DeskPRO **powerful yet simple**. We understand that to be accepted by your agents, our software has to be intuitive and pleasant to use, but powerful enough that it enhances their productivity rather than holding them back.

We've carried the principle of "powerful yet simple" to the administration of the platform, as well. It's easy to set up a working helpdesk in minutes, you can then configure it to match your business processes instead of changing the way you work.

Here are some of the key benefits of DeskPRO:

Flexible configuration: you can arrange your helpdesk using teams and departments to reflect how your company works, or add your own completely custom fields. You can configure fine-grained access permissions to control what agents and users can see.

Automation: DeskPRO supports powerful conditional actions called triggers and escalations, which you can set up with a simple web interface. You can customize any of the default automatic actions using the same system.

Agents can speed up their workflow with snippets (shortcuts to enter common pieces of text) and macros, which automate repetitive sets of actions.

Branding: you can fully customize the web portal and embed it into your website, or integrate some DeskPRO features (like live chat) into your website using widgets.

Extensibility: We refer to DeskPRO as a platform because it can be extended using DeskPRO apps. We offer authentication apps to allow users to sign in to DeskPRO with credentials from other services, and full apps which integrate functions from third-party services into your helpdesk.

You can customize the agent interface by writing simple widgets using just HTML and Javascript, or write your own apps with our REST API.

1.3. DeskPRO terminology

Before we go any further, here are a few key terms and concepts you need to understand to configure DeskPRO.

Users: people who need help and support from your helpdesk, whether that is external customers or others within your enterprise (for example if you're running an IT helpdesk)

Agent: someone within your enterprise who helps users

Team: a team is a group of agents; you can assign a ticket to a team instead of an individual agent, so teams are usually made of agents who work together closely and could all answer the same type of ticket

Department: departments are a way to divide up the helpdesk and control access. They usually reflect different sections of your enterprise, for example 'Support' and 'Sales'.

Agent interface: the web interface that **agents** use to get their work done. When you have set up your helpdesk, it will be at http://YOUR_HELPDESK_ADDRESS/agent

Admin interface: the web interface that you will use to configure the helpdesk and check that it is working correctly. It will be at http://YOUR_HELPDESK_ADDRESS/admin

Web portal: this is an optional way to allow users to interact with the help desk through the web; depending on how you choose to configure it, users can view their tickets, submit feedback, see knowledgebase articles, etc. If enabled, it will be accessible to users at http://YOUR_HELPDESK_ADDRESS/

2. Creating Your Helpdesk

There are two hosting options for DeskPRO:

- **DeskPRO Cloud:** where the software runs on our servers, and we manage the technical details of hardware, upgrades, off-site backups, network and bandwidth. This is the quickest and easiest method, and it's what we recommend for most customers.
- **DeskPRO Download:** where you download and install DeskPRO on your own servers. This gives you more control over your data and reduces your reliance on third parties. You have full access to the DeskPRO source code. You will need the technical skills to be able to configure and maintain the servers, and you will have to arrange hosting and bandwidth yourself.

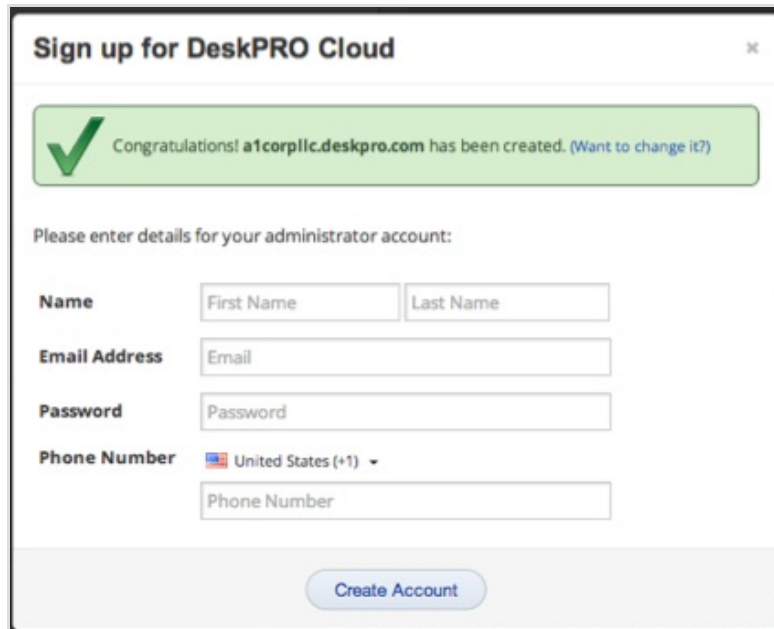
Note that you can always migrate between these two options at no extra cost: you can evaluate DeskPRO using Cloud then move your helpdesk to your own servers, or start with Download and then move your helpdesk into the cloud.

Even if you are using Cloud, you can configure DeskPRO so that both the agent interface and the portal are accessed through a custom domain - i.e. instead of `yourcompany.deskpro.com`, your users see the portal at `support.yourcompany.com` and your agents log in at `support.yourcompany.com/agent`.

2.1. Cloud sign-up

Creating a Cloud helpdesk is easy:

- 1 Go to <https://www.deskpro.com/pricing/> and enter a name for your helpdesk.
- 2 The **Sign up for DeskPRO Cloud** pop-up opens. Enter the details for your admin account.



The screenshot shows a pop-up window titled "Sign up for DeskPRO Cloud". At the top, there is a green success message with a checkmark icon: "Congratulations! a1corp11c.deskpro.com has been created. (Want to change it?)". Below this, the text "Please enter details for your administrator account:" is displayed. The form contains the following fields:

- Name:** Two input fields labeled "First Name" and "Last Name".
- Email Address:** One input field labeled "Email".
- Password:** One input field labeled "Password".
- Phone Number:** A dropdown menu showing "United States (+1)" and an input field labeled "Phone Number".

At the bottom of the form is a blue button labeled "Create Account".

- 3 You can now log in with the email address and password you provided.

2.2. Download installation

Setting up a Download helpdesk is fairly simple, but does require that you have some server and database administration skills on your platform of choice.

DeskPRO Download is web-based software written in the PHP language. It is designed to be independent of the underlying operating system, so will run on any recent version of Windows, Linux or Mac OS X.

DeskPRO requires the following:

A webserver: any web server that works well with PHP should be able to run DeskPRO, such as a recent version of Apache, nginx/PHP-FPM or Microsoft IIS.

PHP: minimum supported version is v5.3.2, but we recommend always using the latest version.

DeskPRO will also need access to the command line version of PHP (often called php or php-cli on Linux or php-win.exe on Windows). This is generally installed by default on any server with PHP installed.

PHP extensions that you need enabled are:

- PDO with the MySQL driver installed
- mbstring or iconv
- json
- session
- ctype
- dom
- tokenizer
- GD or Imagick or Gmagick
- OpenSSL (recommended)

It is recommended, but not required, that you install an **opcode cache** such as [Alternative PHP Cache](#) or [Windows Cache Extension](#), which can dramatically increase performance.

mySQL database: The minimum supported version is 5.0; we recommend always using the latest 5.x.x. version.

cron (on a Unix-based OS) or **Scheduled Tasks** (on Windows) to run regular processes such as sending email

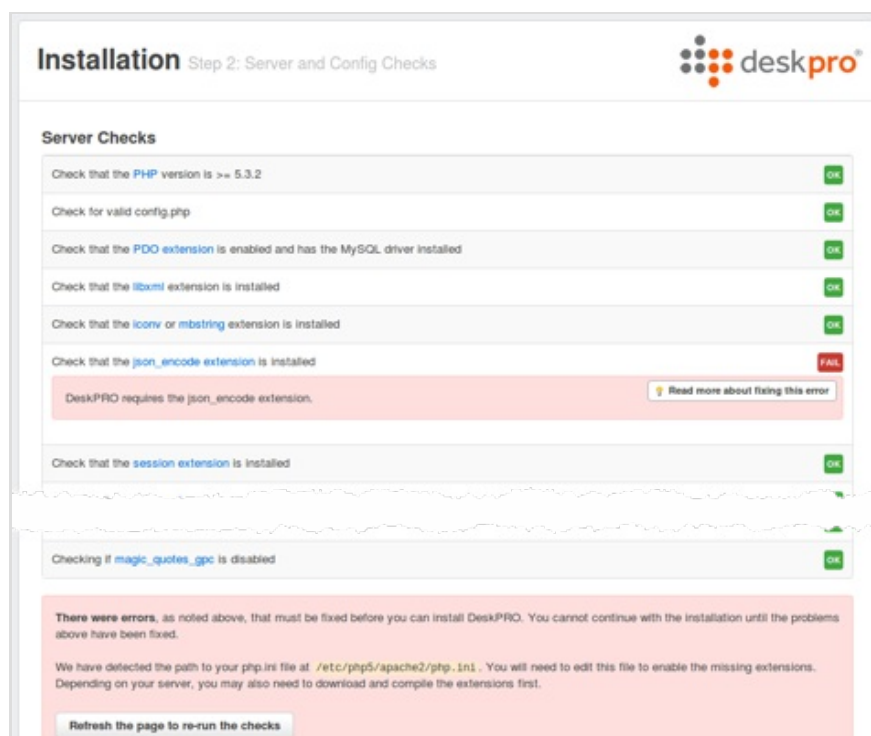
An email server: DeskPRO can send email via an SMTP server or using the PHP mail() function. It can receive email from a server using the standard POP3 protocol. Instead of running your own mail server, you can use the email features of a Google Apps account.

Hardware: DeskPRO runs well on modest hardware, and can easily run from a standard virtual machine or even virtual hosting account. If you are expecting a very busy helpdesk, the limiting factor for speed is generally the database, which can be helped by increasing the amount of RAM and using fast disks for storage. You can run all the required software on one machine; however, you may wish to separate the web server from the database server.

We can't provide a step-by-step installation guide for every possible combination of operating system, version and configuration. However, DeskPRO has an installation wizard which will check your server environment and tell you what steps you need to take to complete the install.

The installation process generally runs like this:

- 1 Install a web server and enable PHP support and URL rewriting.
- 2 Install PHP, with the PHP extensions listed above.
- 3 Install MySQL, and create a 'deskpro' user account.
- 4 Download the latest version of DeskPRO from <https://www.deskpro.com/downloads/deskpro.zip>
 - remove the default page (e.g. `index.html`) from your web server's base directory, and unzip `deskpro.zip` into it
 - copy the resulting `config.new.php` file as `config.php`
 - set a cron job or Scheduled Task to run `cron.php` once per minute
 - edit `config.php` to add your email address and MySQL database credentials
- 5 Ensure the web server is running and go to the URL (or IP address) where it is serving DeskPRO.
- 6 The wizard will then take you through the required steps to complete installation.



- 7 Once installation is complete, you can log on with the account details you gave during installation.

You may be able to find more detailed installation advice for your platform in our knowledgebase at <https://support.deskpro.com/kb>. If you need more help, we also offer an [Installation service](#).

Proxy servers and load-balancing

You can run DeskPRO with proxy servers. You may also choose to run it across multiple load-balanced nodes to increase availability.

In these scenarios, you must ensure that forwarded requests are being sent with the correct headers.

To enable proxy mode, in the DeskPRO `config.php` edit the following line:

```
$DP_CONFIG['trust_proxy_data'] = false;
```

replacing `false` with `true` .

This enables proxy mode for all web requests. You can instead specify IP addresses or address ranges in CIDR notation to whitelist:

```
$DP_CONFIG['trust_proxy_data'] = array(  
    '192.168.1.83',      // whitelist this specific IP  
    '192.168.0.0/24'    // whitelist this range (192.168.0.0 - 255)  
    '@etc/proxy_list.php', // read addresses from file (as PHP array)  
);
```

For DeskPRO to function properly, the servers it interacts with must be sending proper headers with each request:

- **X-Forwarded-For:** The IP address of the user
- **X-Forwarded-Host:** The real hostname the user requested
- **X-Forwarded-Port:** The real port the user requested (usually 80 or 443 for SSL)
- **X-Forwarded-Proto:** The protocol (http or https) of the user request

File storage mechanisms

By default, uploaded files are stored in the MySQL database. However, databases are not designed to store binary files, so this configuration can slow down database operations like backups or replication.

For increased efficiency, we recommend that you use the option to switch DeskPRO to store files in a directory on the web server.

Go to **Server > File Uploads** and click **switching to filesystem storage**

The files will be stored in `/data/files` within the directory where you installed DeskPRO.

If you have existing files, they are transferred gradually from the database using a scheduled task.

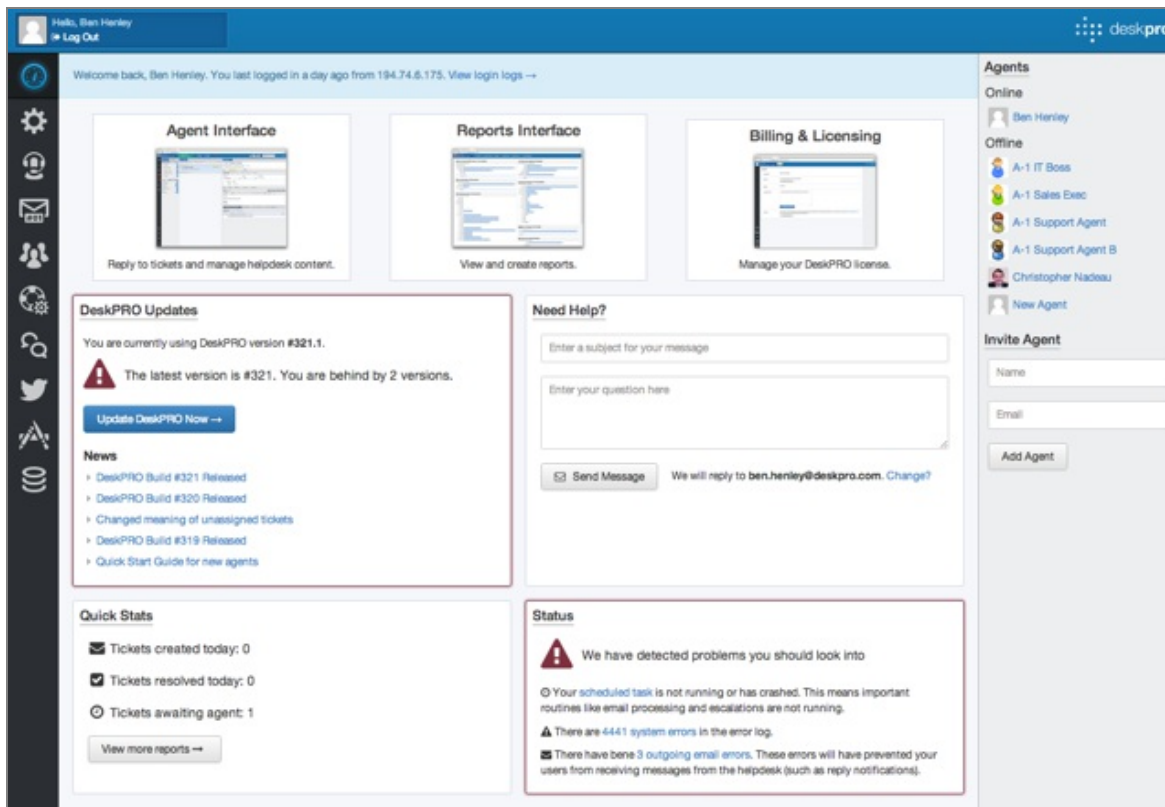
If you have multiple web servers with separate filesystems, this will not work correctly. The best option is to set up shared storage such as a NAS or SAN.

3. Configuring Your Helpdesk

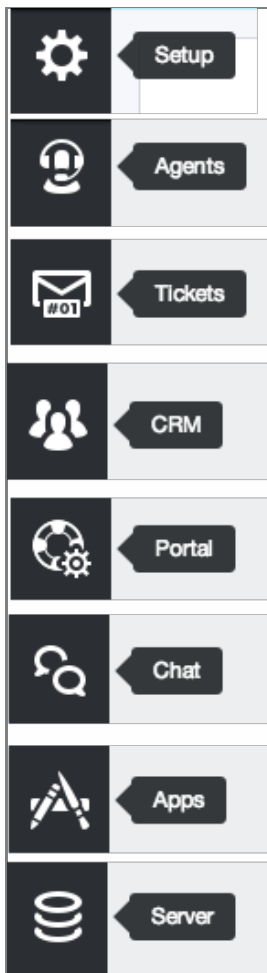
Once your helpdesk has been created, you will be able to log in to the admin interface.

DeskPRO configuration is very flexible, but in this chapter we'll walk through the basic first steps that almost every helpdesk will need.

The admin home page gives you an overview of the status of your DeskPRO installation.



The icons in the bar at the far left give you access to different admin sections:



At the top of the home page are links to the other interfaces within DeskPRO:

- the **agent** interface where agents reply to tickets - see the Agent Manual for more details
- the **reports** interface where you can produce detailed statistics and graphs about agent performance
- the **billing & licensing** interface where you manage your DeskPRO license

Note that you don't need to make yourself a separate agent account to use the agent interface: any **admin** account (like the one you're using now) is automatically an agent.

3.1. Initial customization

The first step to configuring your helpdesk is to customize it with details of your enterprise.

Go to the **Setup** section by clicking the gear icon in the left-hand bar.



Enter the details requested under **Your Helpdesk** and **Your Website**.

Settings

Your Helpdesk

Helpdesk Name

This is the name of your helpdesk. The name is displayed to users in their browser window title, and is also

Helpdesk URL

The primary URL for your helpdesk. This URL is used whenever the system needs to link to your helpdesk.

Your Website

Website Name

Enter the name of your company or company website.

Website URL

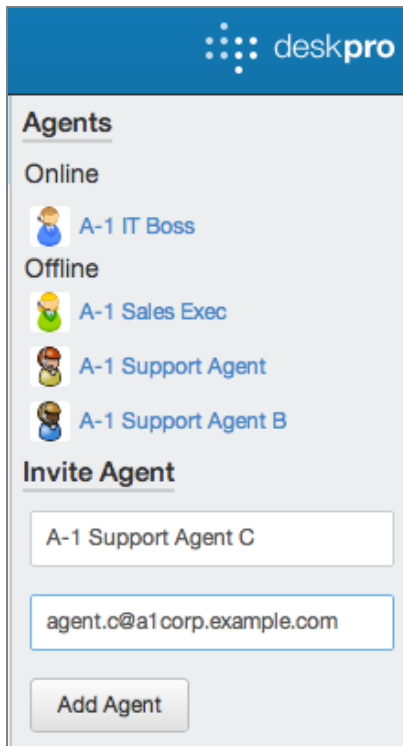
Enter the URL to your company website.

The **Helpdesk URL** entry should be the address of the web portal.

While you're on this page, check that the **Default Timezone** at the top of the **Dates and Times** section is set correctly.

3.2. Creating agents

You can see the list of agents in the system at the top right of the home page.



Initially, you will only see your account.

You can quickly add your colleagues as new agents using **Invite Agent**, just by entering the new agent's name and email, then clicking **Add Agent**.

The person will get an email notification about their new agent account, with the [Agent Quick Start Guide](#) (a brief overview of how the agent interface works) attached.

You can create and manage agents in more detail from the **Agents** section.

The screenshot shows the 'Properties' tab of the DeskPRO agent configuration interface. At the top, there are five tabs: 'Properties' (selected), 'Permissions', 'Departments', 'Ticket Notifications', and 'Other Notifications'. A gear icon is in the top right corner. The form contains several sections: 'Name' with a text input field containing 'Newbie Agent' and a checkbox 'Display a different name to end-users'; 'Email Address' with a text input field containing 'new.agent@a1 corp.example.com'; 'Zones' with two checkboxes, 'Admin Interface' and 'Reports Interface'; 'Teams' with three checkboxes, '1st Level Support' (checked), '2nd Level Support', and 'Support Managers'; and 'Permission Groups' with three checkboxes, 'All Non-Destructive Permissions' (checked), 'All Permissions', and 'Interns'. Below the 'Permission Groups' section, there is a note: 'Switch to the **Permissions** tab to manage permission overrides.' At the bottom of the form are two buttons: 'Save' (blue) and 'Delete' (red).

We'll discuss these settings in more detail, but for now, use the **Properties** tab to set up your first agents' accounts.

Teams are a way of assigning tickets to groups of agents instead of a single agent. The default teams we've given you ("1st Level Support", "2nd Level Support" and "Support Managers") are just an example - you can rename or replace them later.

Agent **permissions** control what each agent is allowed to do. You can set these down to very fine details, but the quick way to set permissions is by adding agents to a **Permission Group**. While your first agents are getting used to DeskPRO, putting them in the **All Non-Destructive Permissions** group will let them use most features of DeskPRO while limiting the potential for mistakes.

Zones control which agents can access the admin interface (marked with a wrench icon) or the reports interface (marked with a bar chart icon). It's a good idea to give at least one other person admin access, in case there's a problem with the helpdesk and you're not available.

Bear in mind that anyone with admin access can delete or alter most of the data in the helpdesk, including deleting your account, so you should only grant admin access to people you trust with that power!

3.3. Set up ticket email accounts

You can now set up the email accounts where users will submit messages to be turned into tickets. Any new message to these accounts is automatically converted to a ticket within your helpdesk. If it's part of an ongoing conversation, it will be shown as a reply to a ticket.

Note that a ticket email account can't also be used as an agent/admin email address. This is necessary to prevent email loops; otherwise DeskPRO could end up replying to its own emails endlessly. It's best to add agents using personal email accounts (e.g. `john.smith@yourcompany.com` or `agent1@yourcompany.com`), rather than with generic addresses like `support@`.

While most helpdesks use email to accept tickets, it's not essential; you could choose to have users submit all tickets through the web portal.

Email account configuration differs slightly between the Cloud and Download products.

DeskPRO Cloud support email configuration

If you are using DeskPRO Cloud, you will first create cloud-hosted support email accounts with addresses ending `@yourcompany.deskpro.com`.

You can ask users to submit tickets to these addresses straight away, but you probably have an existing support address like `help@yourcompany.com`. In that case, you can use the **custom email address** option to forward email from the existing address to a cloud address - for example, you would forward `help@yourcompany.com` to `help@yourcompany.deskpro.com`.

The **New Ticket Trigger** settings affect what happens when a new ticket is created from this a custom email address. + **Department** is the department assigned automatically to the ticket. The default 'Support' department is a good choice for your first email address. + **Send user an auto-response confirming their new ticket** uses a template that you can customize under **Tickets > Email Templates**. You can also set the **From Name** that the user sees on the email.

The helpdesk will then send emails out with your custom address in the "From" field. This means your users will never see the default DeskPRO email address.

DeskPRO Download support email configuration

Here's how to add your first support email account in DeskPRO Download:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Email Accounts** and click **New Email Account**.
- 2 This screen is displayed:

Email Address *

Enter the main email address for this account.

☐ This account has additional email addresses associated with it (aliases)

Type

Ticket Email Account

Ticket accounts are email accounts that DeskPRO will download emails from and process into tickets and replies.

Account Details *

IMAP

Host localhost

Port 110

Secure ☐ Enable secure network connection

Username

Password

IMAP Folder ☒ Read messages from the inbox
☐ Read messages from a specific folder

Read Mode ☒ Read all unread messages
 DeskPRO will read and process all unread messages in the mailbox. After processing, messages are marked as read but stay in the mailbox.
☐ Read all messages and then move
☐ Read all messages and then delete

[Test Account Settings](#)

Outgoing Email *

Send mail using PHP mail()

PHP Mail Send mail through the server `mail()` function.

[Test Account Settings](#)

New Ticket Trigger

Department: Support

☐ Send user an auto-response confirming their new ticket

- 3 **Email Address** is simply the user-facing email address you want to use for support e.g. `support@yourcompany.com`
- 4 Leave **Type** as **Ticket Email Account**
- 5 Select the type of email account you are using, and enter the details.

- For **IMAP** and **POP3** accounts, enter the server details requested. You can find these in the settings of your email program or mail provider. **Host** means the address of the IMAP or POP3 (incoming mail) server.
- If you use a Gmail or Google Apps account, you must ensure that **POP Download** is enabled in the **Settings** page.

POP Download:
[Learn more](#)

1. Status: **POP is enabled** for all mail that has arrived since 3:17 pm
☐ Enable POP for **all mail** (even mail that's already been downloaded)
☐ Enable POP for **mail that arrives from now on**
☐ Disable POP

2. When messages are accessed with POP keep Gmail's copy in the Inbox

3. **Configure your email client** (e.g. Outlook, Eudora, Netscape Mail)
[Configuration instructions](#)

Enable POP for **all mail** if you want DeskPRO to import all email messages in the account inbox as tickets. Enable POP for **mail that arrives from now on** if you just want DeskPRO to process new emails.

For **IMAP** and **POP3** accounts, you must specify how DeskPRO sends outgoing email.

- 6
 - The default **Send mail using PHP mail()** option sends emails directly from your DeskPRO installation with a PHP function - this should work without extra configuration in Linux environments, but you may need to configure PHP further.
 - For more reliability, we recommend sending email via a separate SMTP server. You must ensure that your server is configured to relay mail from your DeskPRO installation: consult the documentation for SMTP server on how to do this.
 - You can also use a Gmail or Google Apps account just to send mail.
- 7

Click **Test Account Settings** to try sending an email to yourself and confirm that DeskPRO can send email.
- 8

The **New Ticket Trigger** settings affect what happens when a new ticket is created from this email address.

 - **Department** is the department assigned automatically to the ticket. The default 'Support' department is a good choice for your first email account.

3.4. Set up departments

Departments are a way to divide up the helpdesk and control access. They have multiple effects within DeskPRO. They are generally used to reflect different sections of your enterprise: for example, you might have "Support" and "Sales" departments, or "US", "France" and "UK" departments.

At this stage of setting up the helpdesk, you should consider the following properties of departments:

- 1 Each department can have its own email account. For example, you could have emails to `jobs@yourcompany.com` create tickets in the HR department, and emails to `help@yourcompany.com` create tickets in the Support department.
- 2 User and agent permissions are based on departments; if you anticipate that you will want to let some people see certain tickets but not others, this will be handled with departments.
- 3 The fields shown when a user or an agent creates a ticket through the web can be customized depending on the department.

To create or edit ticket departments, go to **Tickets > Departments**. To make a new department, you only need to enter information in the **Properties** tab.

The screenshot shows the 'Properties' tab of the Department configuration interface. It includes the following fields and options:

- Title ***: A text input field containing 'Support'. Below it, a note states: 'This is the title as it will appear throughout the agent and user interfaces.' There is also an unchecked checkbox labeled 'Show a different title to end-users'.
- Parent**: A dropdown menu set to 'No Parent'. Below it, a note states: 'By setting a parent department, this department becomes a child. This is just an organizational feature that helps you create department structures that are easier to use.'
- New Ticket Trigger**: A section with 'Set Email account:' followed by a dropdown menu showing 'support@a1.example.com'. Below this is an unchecked checkbox labeled 'Send user an auto-response confirming their new ticket'.
- At the bottom, there are three buttons: 'Save' (blue), 'Reset' (grey), and 'Delete' (red).

Use the **Permissions** tab to control each agent's access to tickets in each department:

- **Full** means the agent can view and work on tickets in that department.
- **Assign** means the agent can assign tickets to the department, but nothing more (they can't view them afterwards).

If departments don't seem relevant to your needs, you don't have to use them. Delete all but one department. You can always add them again later.

3.5. Set up teams

Agent **teams** are a way to allow group ticket assignment. Assigning a ticket to a team brings it to the attention of all the members of that team: it will show up in the **My Teams' Tickets** filter in the agent interface.

This is useful because agents may not know exactly who the best person is to handle a ticket, especially if you work in a large enterprise. For example, if a technical support agent finds a ticket asking for a product demonstration, but they don't know who handles those, the agent can just assign it to the 'Sales' team.

Teams usually consist of agents who work closely together and all handle the same kind of ticket (e.g. first-line support team, sales team, engineering team). Teams are not compulsory; if they don't help with your work flow, you don't have to use them.

You can create and edit teams under **Agents > Teams**. Teams only have two properties: a name and a list of agents.

Click on a team to edit its name and select its members using the checkboxes.

Team Name	2nd Level Support
Members	☐  A-1 IT Boss  ☒  A-1 Sales Exec  ☒  A-1 Support Agent  ☒  A-1 Support Agent B  ☐  Newbie Agent 

Click **Add** to create a new team, enter its name, and select members.

If you want to organize your agents into groups who can't see each other's tickets, you should use **departments**, not **teams**.

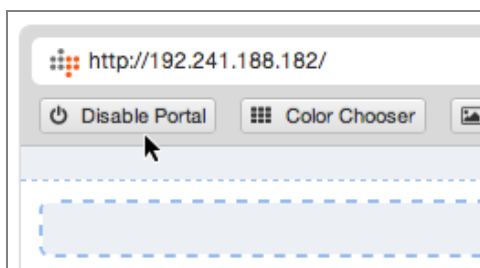
3.6. Set up the user web portal

The portal is the web-based view of the helpdesk accessible to users. They can use it to view their tickets, access useful help content created by agents with the agent interface **Publish** app, and submit feedback.

Click on the portal icon to configure it.



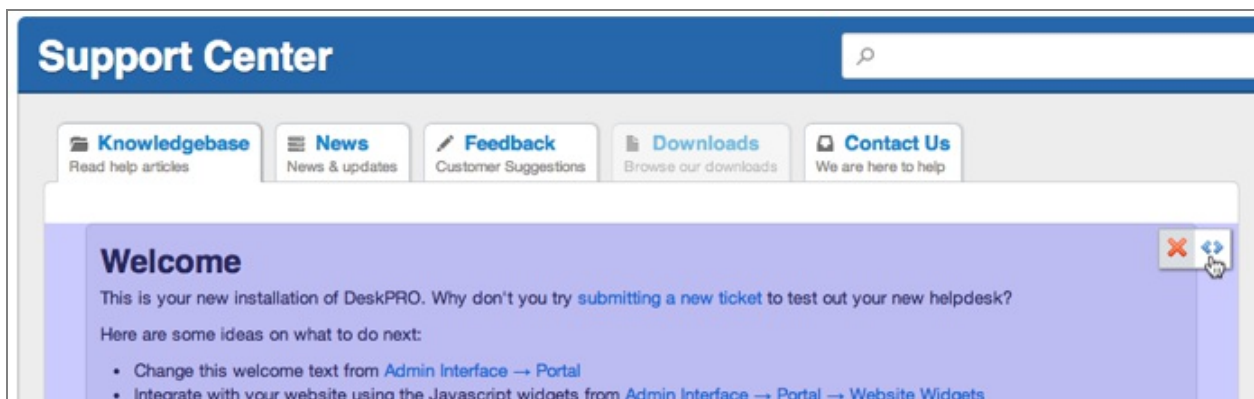
If you prefer not to use the portal, you can turn it off with the **Disable Portal** button.



With the portal disabled, users can only submit tickets via email or have them created on their behalf by agents, and can't view help content or submit feedback.

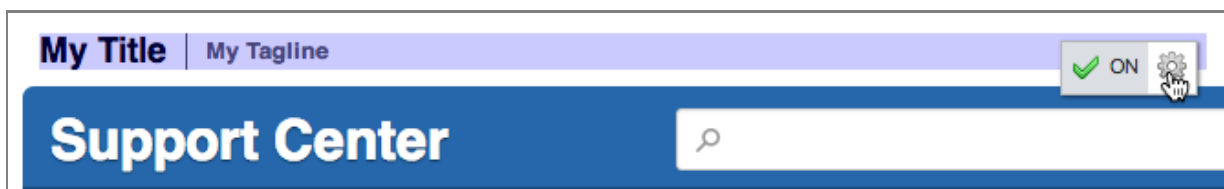
If do you want to use the portal, you should customize the default welcome message on the front page.

Mouse over the **Welcome** section of the portal, and click the edit control.



You can then edit the HTML of the welcome message to something more relevant to your users.

You might also want to customize or remove the placeholder title and tagline at the top of the portal.



There are many more ways to customize the web portal. You can add or remove sections, change the design, use a custom URL (for Cloud users), or embed it entirely within your website. See the [Customizing the User Experience](#) chapter for details.

3.7. Attachments and files

Users and agents can send files as attachments to ticket messages or via chats.

You can configure what sort of attachments are allowed from **Setup > Settings**

User Attachments	Agent Attachments
☒ Allow all files	☒ Allow all files
☐ Only allow specific file extensions	☐ Only allow specific file extensions
☐ Just disallow specific file extensions	☐ Just disallow specific file extensions
Max file size a user can upload.	Max file size a agent can upload.
The max file size supported by your server is 42.67 MB. Learn more.	The max file size supported by your server is 42.67 MB. Learn more.
5.00 MB	5.00 MB

There are separate settings for agents and users. You can choose to allow all file types, or allow only files with specific **extensions** (e.g. .JPEG, .GIF, .DOC), or ban specific **extensions** (e.g. .EXE, .MSI).

You can also set a maximum allowed file size.

DeskPRO download file storage

Your server configuration limits the largest file size DeskPRO can handle. You should ensure that you don't allow files bigger than this.

See **Server Settings > File Uploads** for details of which settings affect the file size limit, and how to change it. You can also change how files are stored.

4. Localization

We're committed to making DeskPRO suitable for international use.

There is currently support for 19 languages, with the ability to option to enter your own custom phrase translations, or to contribute new translations into languages you need.

You can also fully customize the date format.

4.1. Date & time settings

You can customize the format that DeskPRO uses to display dates and times in the **Dates and Times** section of **Settings**.

The formatting will apply to the agent interface and the user web portal.

Use the format characters from the table below to specify how DeskPRO should display dates.

For example, the date format `M j Y` means that when the interface needs to display a date, it will display something like "Jan 1 2015". If you wanted it to display "1st January 15", you would edit the Date format field to read `"jS F y"`.

format character	Description	Example output
Day		
d	Day of the month, 2 digits with leading zeros	01 to 31
D	A textual representation of a day, three letters	Mon through Sun
j	Day of the month without leading zeros	1 to 31
l (lowercase 'L')	A full textual representation of the day of the week	Sunday through Saturday
S	English ordinal suffix for the day of the month, 2 characters	st, nd, rd or th. Works well with j
z	The day of the year (starting from 0)	0 through 365
Week		
W	ISO-8601 week number of year, weeks starting on Monday	Example: 42 (the 42nd week in the year)
Month		
F	A full textual representation of a month, such as January or March	January through December
m	Numeric representation of a month, with leading zeros	01 through 12
M	A short textual representation of a month, three letters	Jan through Dec
n	Numeric representation of a month, without leading zeros	1 through 12
Year		
Y	A full numeric representation of a year, 4 digits	Examples: 1999 or 2003
y	A two digit representation of a year	Examples: 99 or 03
Time		
a	Lowercase Ante meridiem and Post meridiem	am or pm

A	Uppercase Ante meridiem and Post meridiem	AM or PM
g	12-hour format of an hour without leading zeros	1 through 12
G	24-hour format of an hour without leading zeros	0 through 23
h	12-hour format of an hour with leading zeros	01 through 12
H	24-hour format of an hour with leading zeros	00 through 23
i	Minutes with leading zeros	00 to 59
s	Seconds, with leading zeros	00 through 59
Timezone		
e	Timezone identifier	UTC, GMT, Atlantic/Azores
I (capital i)	Whether or not the date is in daylight saving time	1 if Daylight Saving Time, 0 otherwise
O	Difference to Greenwich time (GMT) in hours	+0200
P	Difference to Greenwich time (GMT) with colon between hours and minutes	+02:00
T	Timezone abbreviation	EST, MDT
Full Date/Time		
c	ISO 8601 date	2004-02-12T15:19:21+00:00
r	RFC 2822 formatted date	Thu, 21 Dec 2000 16:01:07 +0200

4.2. Languages

DeskPRO has support for many international languages, and we are expanding our language support all the time using crowdsourced translation.

At **Setup > Languages** you can see:

- the default language of your helpdesk
- installed languages
- other installable languages

The screenshot shows the 'Default Language' section with a dropdown menu set to 'English (English)'. Below this is the 'Installed Languages' section, which lists three languages: 'English (English)' with 'admin', 'agent', and 'user' labels; 'العربية (Arabic)' with a 'user' label; and 'Français (French)' with 'agent' and 'user' labels. At the bottom is the 'Other Installable Languages' section, which lists 'Dansk (Danish)' with a 'user' label.

The level of translation support varies: most language packs currently have translations for **user** text (portal and emails) only. Some additionally translate the **agent** interface (and agent notification emails), and some translate **admin** as well.

The interfaces which a language pack covers are denoted by the blue labels.

DeskPRO records a language for tickets and users. When a new ticket/user is created, the language is not defined, and DeskPRO uses the default language.

Users can pick their preferred language (from those you have installed) when they are logged in to the web portal, using the language selection control at the upper right.

The screenshot shows a 'Language:' dropdown menu with three options: 'English' (with a US flag), 'العربية' (with a Saudi flag), and 'Français' (with a French flag). A mouse cursor is hovering over the 'Français' option.

Agents can also change the user's language from within the agent interface, using the **Properties** section of the user record.

The screenshot shows the 'PROPERTIES' section of a user record. It has 'Cancel' and 'Save' buttons at the top right. Below the 'Timezone' field is the 'Language' field, which has a dropdown menu open. The dropdown menu shows three options: 'English', '✓ Français' (which is selected and highlighted in blue), and 'العربية'.

Changing a user's language will change the language in which they view the web portal, as well as the language of their notification emails.

When a user's language changes, all their tickets are switched to that language.

Installing a new language

Installing a supported language is easy. Just go to the **Other Installable Languages** section, click on the language you want to install, then click **Install Language**.

After you've installed the language, you can click on it to view its settings.

The screenshot shows a form for configuring a language. It includes the following fields and sections:

- Title:** A text input field containing "English". Below it, a note says "The language title as it appears to users."
- Edit Phrases:** A blue button with a speech bubble icon and the text "Edit Phrases".
- Locale Code:** A text input field containing "en_US". Below it, a note says "This is the standard locale code for the language."
- Flag:** A dropdown menu showing a US flag and the text "us".
- Availability:** A section stating "This language pack has translations for the following areas:" followed by a bulleted list:
 - The user portal and user emails
 - The agent interface and agent email notifications
 - The admin interface and the reporting interface
- Save:** A blue button at the bottom right.

For a full translation, you will need to provide the translated terms for any custom values you have entered. For example, if you enable French, DeskPRO won't know the correct French names for your 'Returns' department, so you have to enter it.

- 1 Click on your newly-installed language to view detailed settings.
- 2 Click the **Edit Phrases** button, and on the following page, click on the first entry under **Resources**.
- 3 In each **Resources** section, click on each item in the **Translated** column, and enter a translation into the new language, then click **Save**.

The screenshot shows the 'Resources' section for the language 'Français (French)'. It includes a sidebar with navigation options and a main table for editing translations.

Language: Français (French) (dropdown)

Resources:

- All Custom Phrases
- Ticket Departments** (selected)
- Chat Departments
- Products

Default	Translated
Support	Au secours!
Sales	Prix réduit!

Save button at the bottom.

- 4 Repeat until you have translated all your custom values.

Note that if you're not satisfied with the translation/phrasing of other areas, you can change **User Interface Phrases** from the same page. Edit the **Custom** column to override the default translation of phrases in the web interface or emails to users.

You can select which country's flag to display for each language. This is useful if the language you've installed is used in multiple countries, but you want to display the flag for a particular country.

If you don't want to install languages one by one, you can click **Settings & Tools** at the bottom of the page, then select **Automatically install new languages**.

Interface text phrases

Almost all of DeskPRO's interface text (including text for notification emails) is stored as **phrases**. You can enter a custom version of these phrases to change the interface text; this can be used to change the text for your default language as well as any alternative languages. You could use this to fix translation problems, or to completely rewrite the user-facing text to better reflect your enterprise's writing style.

Note that even if your helpdesk only has one language, the interface text is stored as phrases.

How does DeskPRO decide where a particular phrase is shown? The **template** system, used to define the portal and notification emails, includes references to the phrases.

For example, look at **Tickets > Email Templates**. In all the templates, the body of the email begins:

```
{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}
```

This tells DeskPRO to insert the `user.emails.greeting` phrase automatically at the beginning of every email.

If you wanted to change how you greet your users, you could enter a custom version of `user.emails.greeting`:

Phrase	Default	Translation	Custom
user.emails.greeting	Dear {{to_name}},	Dear {{to_name}},	Howdy {{to_name}}!

See the chapter on [Editing Templates](#) for more information.

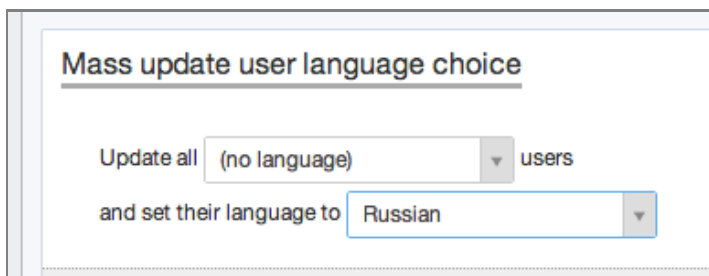
Changing the default language

Simply select an installed language from the **Default Language** pulldown to change the default language.

The new language will be applied to all users (and agents/admins if the language pack supports it) who haven't explicitly picked a language.

From **Settings & Tools**, you can apply mass updates to tickets or users. This is useful if you want to apply the new default language to users who have not explicitly picked a language.

For example, suppose most of your users speak Russian and you have been evaluating DeskPRO for a week with only English installed, during which time some users have registered.



You would update all 'no language' users to Russian. Any users who hadn't explicitly selected English as their language would have their language set to Russian.

Agent language support

If a language has **agent** support, agents can select which language they wish to use from their **Preferences** in the agent interface.

You can't change agent language from the admin interface, except by logging in as the agent.

Helping us to improve language support

If the language you want is not available, or doesn't support all the interfaces you require, you can contribute a translation via our crowdsourced translation system at <http://languages.deskpro.com>. You can also use this system to fix any translation errors you find, so they will be corrected in future DeskPRO updates.

You will need to create an account or login via Facebook to contribute.

If you have other translation requirements, please contact us at support@deskpro.com.

5. Importing User Data

If you have data on users from another system, and you want to quickly create DeskPRO accounts for them, you can import data as a CSV (*Comma-Separated Values*) file. CSV is a simple comma-separated text format that can be exported from spreadsheet programs (e.g. Excel) and databases.

The exact format of the CSV file containing user data doesn't matter. The DeskPRO import function lets you select which column from the CSV file corresponds to which field in DeskPRO.

If you are using DeskPRO Download, you can use a more flexible data importer which can import all the data from [legacy helpdesk systems](#).

An alternative to importing account data is to enable users or agents to log in using credentials from a different system (for example, from an existing database, or their network login) by installing [authentication apps](#).

If you have other data import requirements, please contact us at support@deskpro.com.

5.1. Importing user data in CSV format

Here's an example of how a simple user data CSV file might look in your spreadsheet program:

	A	B	C	D
1	Brian Coyot	coyote1@example.com	Aardvark Inc.	enter
2	Maria User	maria1961@example.com	DreadCo	rando
3	Davey	daveyh@example.com		extra
4	Sue Cheam	suey333@example.com	Alpha	junk

and in a text editor:

```
Brian Wolf,coyote1@example.com,Aardvark Inc.,enter
Maria User,maria1961@example.com,DreadCo,rando
Davey,daveyh2@example.com,,extra
Sue Cheam,suey333@example.com,Alpha,junk
```

Some programs may output CSV files with the fields quoted, e.g.:

```
"Maria User","maria1961@example.com","DreadCo","rando"
```

DeskPRO will ignore the quotation marks when importing the data.

Note that some programs may output "CSV" files where the fields are separated by semicolons ; or tabs, instead of commas. Importing these formats is not supported; consult the documentation for the software you're exporting from to find out how to output a comma-separated file.

In **CRM > CSV import**, click **Select CSV File**, select the CSV file with your data, then **Click here to upload file**.

Once the file is uploaded, you can use the next screen to map the CSV columns to DeskPRO fields.

Import CSV File

Configure Importing:

Column Name	Example Data	Mapping Field
Brian Coyot	Maria User	First Name
coyote1@example.com	maria1961@example.com	Primary Email
Aardvark Inc.	DreadCo	Organization ☒ Create if does not exist
enter	rando	Do Not Map

☐ Skip the first row
 This should be selected if the "column name" values above contain labels rather than actual data.

☒ Import the first row
 This should be selected if the "column name" values above contain actual data.

[Click here to start Import](#)

By default, the importer assumes that the first row of your data consists of labels like "Name", "Email" etc. If that is *not* the case (as in this example) you should select the **Import the first row** option.

All users must have at least one email address, so you must select a mapping to the "primary email" field.

- Users without a valid email address will not be imported.
- If an account already exists with a user's primary email address, the user will not be imported.

If you do not map a password field, a random password will be generated automatically for each user.

Once you have the configuration you want, you can start the import. The import will be automatically scheduled and done for you in the background. You do not need to keep your browser on the page except to get status updates as the import happens.

Importing into custom fields

If your data set has fields that you can't map to standard DeskPRO fields, you can import them into custom fields. If you haven't created the fields ahead of time, you can create them when configuring the import by selecting the **New Custom Field** mapping option.

If you create a new choice-based field, new choices will be automatically created as new values are found for the field. If you import into an existing choice-based custom field, you can control whether new choices will be automatically created.

To import into a date-based custom field, the data you are importing must either be a UNIX timestamp or in the format YYYY-MM-DD (for example, 2012-10-24).

Importing contact data

The CSV importer supports importing contact data such as phone numbers and addresses and assigning a "label" to them. This label can be used to indicate, for example, a business phone versus a home phone. The label is optional in most cases.

However, when importing addresses, the label field is used to group related address parts together (such as the street with the city with the postal code). Therefore, if your data set has two or more sets of addresses, you must enter a distinct label for each "set" of address fields.

For example, if your data has "Business Street", "Business City", "Home Street" and "Home City", then you would need to enter one label (e.g.) for "Business Street" and "Business City", and a different label (e.g.) for "Home Street" and "Home City".

6. Ticket Customization

You can customize the information stored in a ticket using optional built-in fields and custom fields.

Categories are a general field, often used to handle grouping tickets within a department.

Priorities describe how important a ticket is. The different priority values you set have an order, from most to least important.

Workflows are used to record the ticket's stage in your support process - for example "Triage", "Troubleshooting", "Follow-Up".

Products usually denote a real product or service that your enterprise offers and your helpdesk supports. If enabled, products can apply to items other than tickets, such as feedback and articles.

Custom fields are the most flexible way to add extra information to tickets. The four built-in fields are each designed for a particular purpose; if you need a new ticket field for some other reason, use a custom field. You decide the name of the field as well as the possible values; you can pick from a variety of formats for the allowed input (for example, a short text string, or selecting predefined choices).

For each of these fields you can set a default value. You can use **validation** rules to require users, agents or both to select a value when creating a ticket through the portal or agent interface.

Note that for these fields to be visible, they must be included in the relevant form layout under **Departments**.

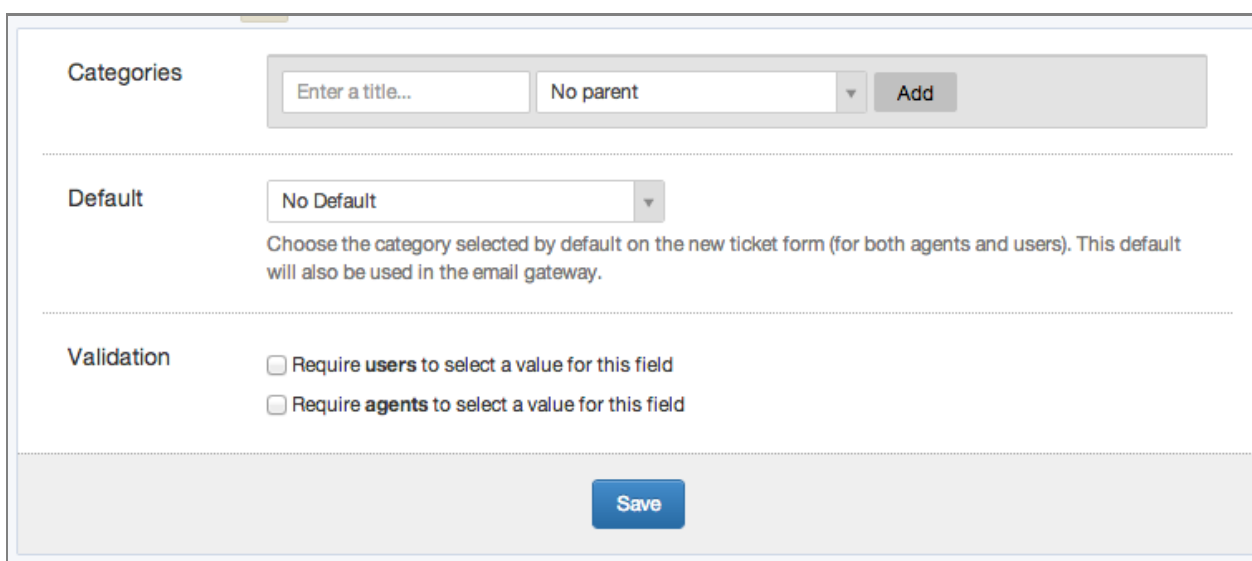
When you create a custom field, you can also select whether it is displayed to agents only, or to both users and agents.

6.1. Categories

Categories are a way to group similar tickets. Departments are used to represent different parts of your enterprise, while categories can be used to record different *types* of tickets. For example, you could use categories to classify emails as 'Questions'/'Product Defects'/'Other'; that would then enable you to compare the number of tickets about product defects between different departments.

To create categories:

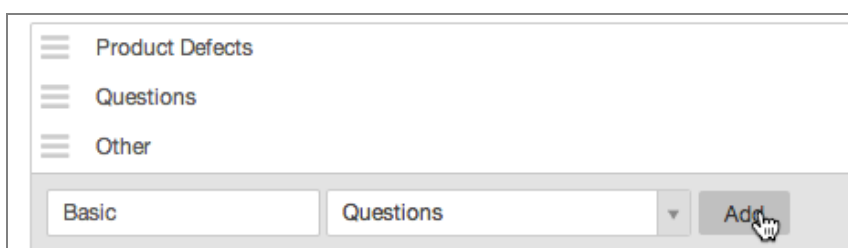
- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Categories** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Categories**, fill in the name of the category you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Enter your desired categories, then click **Save**.



The screenshot shows the 'Categories' configuration form. It has three main sections: 'Categories', 'Default', and 'Validation'. The 'Categories' section has a text input 'Enter a title...', a dropdown menu 'No parent', and an 'Add' button. The 'Default' section has a dropdown menu 'No Default' and a description: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' The 'Validation' section has two checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' and 'Require agents to select a value for this field'. At the bottom is a 'Save' button.

Categories can have subcategories one layer deep. For example, you could divide the 'Questions' category into 'Basic' and 'Advanced'.

To create a 'child' category, enter a new category as normal, then change the drop-down menu to the right from **No parent** to the desired parent category. For example, this would create the subcategory 'Basic' within 'Questions':



The screenshot shows the 'Categories' configuration form with a list of existing categories: 'Product Defects', 'Questions', and 'Other'. Below the list, the 'Enter a title...' input contains 'Basic', and the dropdown menu is set to 'Questions'. The 'Add' button is highlighted with a mouse cursor.

If categories are enabled, users and agents can select a category when they create a ticket, through the portal Contact Us form or the agent interface, respectively.

Setting a **Default** category prefills that category in the user and agent forms. The user/agent can change the category; they can clear it unless validation is enabled. Tickets submitted via email will be assigned to the default category.

Under **Validation** you can require users and/or agents to select a category when they submit a ticket through the web. This does not apply to tickets submitted via email; if it is important that new tickets are assigned a category, set a default category.

6.2. Priorities

Priorities are an alternative way to record how important it is to answer a certain ticket.

Priorities differ from urgency in the following ways:

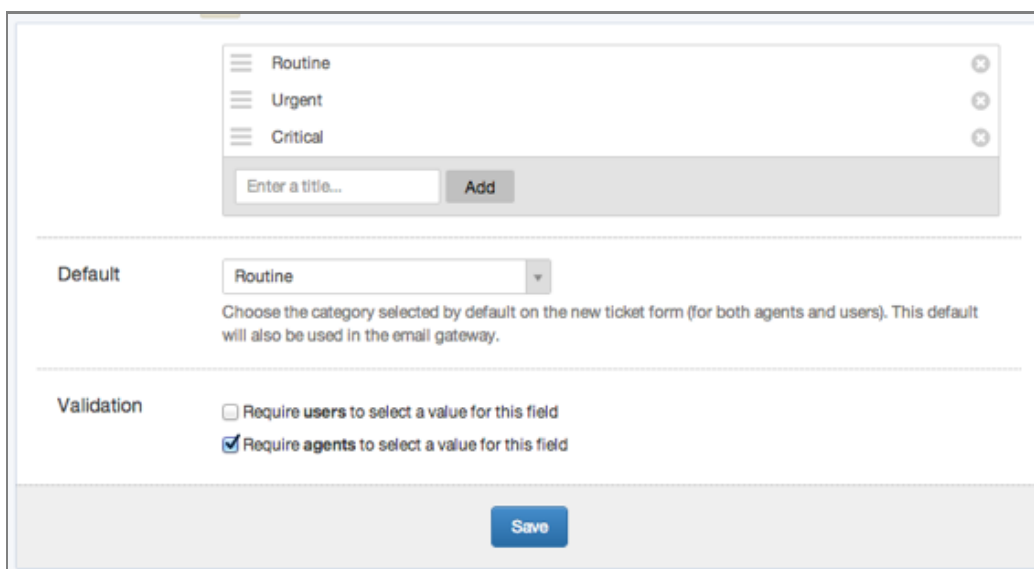
- Priorities are an ordered set of named values, e.g. 'Routine', 'Urgent', 'Critical', whereas urgency is a numerical score from 1 to 10.
- Actions from triggers, SLAs, macros and escalations cannot *increase* or *decrease* priority; they can only set a particular priority value. In contrast, you can have an action that increases urgency by 4.
- Priority can be seen and set by users, whereas urgency is only ever visible to agents.

Priorities can be useful when the service you offer has different tiers. For example, suppose you offer a service plan where you allow users to declare 'Critical' tickets, which you guarantee to answer faster than normal tickets.

You could implement this in DeskPRO by setting 'Critical' as a priority, allowing users to select it when they submit a ticket, and then defining a new SLA that is applied to new tickets with 'Critical' priority.

To create priorities:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Priorities** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Priorities**, fill in the name of the priority you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Repeat until you have made all the priorities you want.
- 4 Drag priorities by the handles at left to order them, from the least important at the top to the most important at the bottom.



The screenshot shows the 'Priorities' configuration page in DeskPRO. At the top, there is a list of existing priorities: 'Routine', 'Urgent', and 'Critical', each with a handle icon on the left and a delete icon on the right. Below this list is a form to add a new priority, consisting of a text input field labeled 'Enter a title...' and an 'Add' button. Underneath the add form, there is a 'Default' section with a dropdown menu currently set to 'Routine'. A note below the dropdown states: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' Below the default section is a 'Validation' section with two checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' (unchecked) and 'Require agents to select a value for this field' (checked). At the bottom of the form is a blue 'Save' button.

The order of priorities is used:

- when displaying them to users/agents
- to enable agents to order tickets by ascending or descending priority in the list pane

Setting defaults and validation for priorities works just as with categories.

6.3. Workflows

Workflows are a way to record the stage of your support process that a ticket has reached.

Ticket **status** essentially records only whether an agent or user is due to reply to a ticket. By design, there is no way to add extra **statuses** in DeskPRO.

DeskPRO admins often want to be able to add extra statuses; for example, to record that a ticket is brand new and needs to be assigned to the relevant team, or that it is ready to be resolved and should be reviewed by quality control.

Workflows are a way to record this sort of information; for example, you could have workflow values of 'Triage', 'Support' and 'QC', and automatically assign 'Triage' to new tickets.

To create workflows:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Workflows** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Workflows**, fill in the name of the workflow value you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Repeat until you have made all the workflow values you want.
- 4 Drag workflows by the handles at left to order them. This only affects the order of display to agents.

The screenshot shows the 'Workflows' configuration page in DeskPRO. At the top, there is a list of existing workflow categories: 'Triage', 'Support', and 'QC', each with a handle icon on the left and a delete icon on the right. Below this list is a form to add a new workflow, consisting of a text input field labeled 'Enter a title...' and an 'Add' button. A horizontal dashed line separates this from the 'Default' section, which features a dropdown menu currently set to 'Triage'. Below the dropdown is a descriptive text: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' Another horizontal dashed line leads to the 'Validation' section, which contains two checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' and 'Require agents to select a value for this field'. At the bottom of the form is a blue 'Save' button.

6.4. Products

Products are a way to link tickets to products or services that your helpdesk supports. For example, if your company makes software, you might use products to track different versions and platforms.

Note that, unlike the other built-in fields, products can apply to items other than tickets, such as feedback and Knowledgebase articles.

Products can have subproducts, which work the same way as nested categories.

To create products:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Products** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Products**, fill in the name of the product you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Repeat until you have made all the products you want.
- 4 You can drag products by the handles at the left to order them. This only affects the order of display to users/agents.

The screenshot shows the 'Products' configuration page in DeskPRO. At the top, there is a list of products with handles on the left and delete icons on the right. The products listed are: Robo-cat, Robo-cat Mk 1, Robo-cat Mk 2, Drivers, Windows, and Mac. Below the list is a form to add a new product, consisting of a text input field labeled 'Enter a title...', a dropdown menu currently showing 'Drivers', and an 'Add' button. Below this form, there is a 'Default' section with a dropdown menu set to 'No Default' and a descriptive text: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' Underneath is a 'Validation' section with two checked checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' and 'Require agents to select a value for this field'. At the bottom of the form is a blue 'Save' button.

Setting defaults and validation for product works as with categories.

6.5. Custom fields

Custom ticket fields are the most flexible way to add extra information to a ticket. You choose both the name of the field, and the type of values it can store.

You can also add custom fields to users, organizations, and chats. These are all separate systems; even if you have a custom ticket field and a custom user field with the same name, you'll need to set their properties separately.

Note that you can include both custom ticket fields and custom *user* fields in the ticket form. See [Ticket Form Layouts](#) for details.

To create a custom field, go to **Tickets > Fields**, then click the **+ Add** button in the Custom Field section.

Select the type of field you want. There are a number of different types you can use, depending on the kind of data you want to store.

Enter a **Title** and **Description**. Both of these can be displayed if the field is included in a form, so it's important to make sure they explain the purpose of the field in a way that will make sense to the people who will be using it.

Remember that a custom field must be added to a form layout under **Tickets > Departments** for it be visible to users/agents.

Custom field types

- Text inputs, with an optional default value (pre-filled text):
 - **Text**: a single-line text input box that users/agents can type into; accepts up to 136 characters

A screenshot of a 'Text field' configuration box. The box has a title bar with the text 'Text field' and a question mark icon. Below the title bar is a text input field containing the text 'This is the default text'.

- **Textarea**: a larger multi-line text input area that users/agents can type into

A screenshot of a 'Textarea' configuration box. The box has a title bar with the text 'Textarea' and a question mark icon. Below the title bar is a multi-line text input area containing the text 'The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog'.

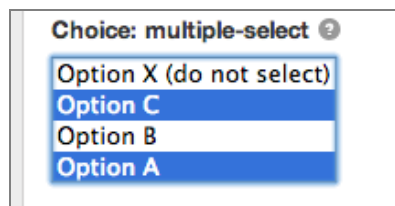
- **Choice**: a set of options you define for users/agents to pick from, with the option to set pre-selected default(s). Can be presented in the following ways:

- **Select box**



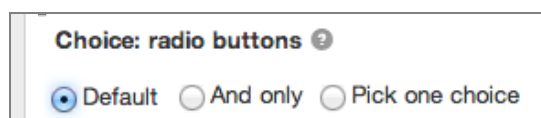
Only one can be selected at a time

- **Multiple-select box**



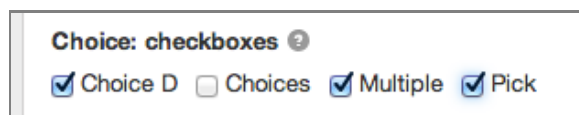
Allows multiple selections

- **Radio buttons**



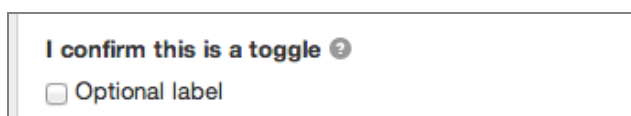
Only one can be selected at a time

- **Checkboxes**

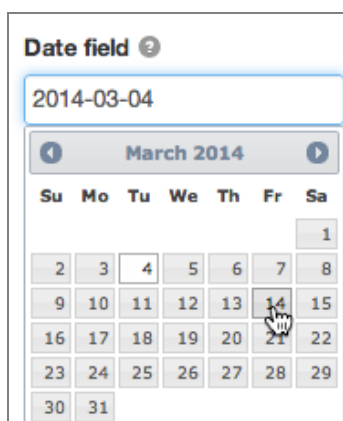


Allows multiple selections

- **Toggle:** a simple checkbox; can either be on or off by default; can require user or agent to check it (for example, to confirm they accept your terms and conditions)



- **Date:** stores a calendar date; users/agents can select from a calendar, or enter a date in text in YYYY-MM-DD format.



- **Display:** this type of field is just used to display HTML, and cannot take input; you could use it for warnings or disclaimers or design customization.



- **Hidden:** a special field that's never visible to users, which can take information from cookies or parameters in the URL; you can use this to capture information about the user's browsing session which agents can then see as part of the ticket.

6.6. Field data validation

You can set **validation** requirements for the field types which take input: this lets you enforce rules about what data users/agents can enter.

For example, all input field types have the option to require the user and/or agent to enter a value:

User Validation	☐ No user validation
	☒ Require the user to provide a value
Agent Validation	☒ No agent validation
	☐ Require the agent to provide a value

When this is enabled, the user/agent won't be able to successfully submit a ticket until they've entered a value for that field.

Note that you can also control when a field is *displayed* and *editable* from the ticket form layout editor in the **Departments Layout** tab - see the [Ticket form layouts](#) section for details.

Options

☒ Show this field during ticket creation

☒ Show the field to agents when viewing the ticket

☒ Only show when there is a value

☒ Allow agents to edit the field

☐ Only show this field based on custom criteria

Done

The validation rules you set will only apply if the field is being displayed.

Text validation with regular expressions

The **text** and **textarea** custom field types allow validation of the content using **regular expressions**; instead of just requiring the user/agent to provide a value, you can require them to enter a value that matches a certain pattern.

For example, suppose you need to know the user's account number to help them. You could use a regular expression to make sure that they have entered an account number in the correct format.

Here are some examples:

```
/^[d]{8}$/ - match an 8 digit account number
```

```
/^[a-zA-Z0-9]{6,32}$/ - match an alphanumeric username 6 to 32 characters long
```

```
/(\d{5}-\d{4})|(\d{5})/ - match a valid US zip code
```

The regular expression system DeskPRO uses is [PHP Perl Compatible Regular Expressions](http://www.php.net/manual/en/regexp.reference.pcre.php). We suggest using <http://www.regexr.com/> to write and test regular expressions.

Date validation options

You can also specify additional **date validation** options:

Default value	☒ Use date at time of submission ☐ Specific date
Valid week days	☒ Monday ☒ Tuesday ☒ Wednesday ☒ Thursday ☒ Friday ☐ Saturday ☐ Sunday
Valid dates	☐ Any date is valid ☐ Date range ☒ Days before/after Date selected must be between 1 and 365 days from the time of submission

7. Departments

Departments are used to divide up the helpdesk into separate areas.

Every ticket always has a department.

The department field has a number of different effects:

- Agent permissions are based upon departments; you can configure it so that agents can view tickets/chats in some departments, but not others.
- User permissions are based upon departments; you can configure it so members of a usergroup can create tickets/chats in some departments, but not others.
- Different departments can have different custom form layouts.
- You can have embedded contact forms which only allow users to submit tickets to a particular department.
- You can set a user-facing department name to be displayed only to users e.g. agents see "Terms of Service Violations", while users see "Support".
- You can link email accounts to departments (e.g. have tickets submitted via `sales@yourdomain.com` assigned to the "Sales" department, tickets submitted via `help@yourdomain.com` assigned to the "Support" department, etc.).

As well as ticket departments, there are **chat departments**. The two types of department are not linked; you configure departments separately for tickets and chats.

Departments usually reflect different divisions of your enterprise with different requirements. Here are some common scenarios where you would need to use departments:

- You want to have separate contact forms for sales requests and support requests, with different custom fields.
- You want to configure your helpdesk so that your manufacturing staff only see manufacturing tickets, and your retail staff only see retail tickets, while your research staff can see everything.
- You want any user to be able to chat with your sales department, but only users in the "Premium" usergroup are allowed to use your technical support chat.

You can have an unlimited number of departments. Most enterprises will have fewer than ten departments, but you can structure your departments as you feel suitable.

A department can have sub-departments, e.g. the "Support" department can contain "Support Tier 1" and "Support Tier 2". Note that you can't assign tickets to a department if it contains sub-departments; you must assign to the sub-departments. In the example above, you could assign tickets to "Support Tier 1" and "Support Tier 2", but not to the parent-level "Support".

7.1. Configuring departments

To manage your ticket departments, go to **Tickets > Departments**.

At left, you'll see the list of departments currently in your helpdesk. The defaults for a new helpdesk are "Support" and "Sales", but you are free to edit these.

You can change the order of departments by dragging them with the handles at left. This just affects the order in which they're displayed to users and agents.

To edit a department, click its name.

If you decide you don't want to use departments at all, just delete all but one of them. Tickets always have a department, but if you only have one department defined (without more than one sub-department), it will not be shown to users, effectively disabling the field.

Department properties

The screenshot shows the 'Properties' tab of a department configuration form. It includes fields for 'Title' (set to 'Support'), 'Parent' (set to 'No Parent'), and 'New Ticket Trigger' (set to 'Set Email account: a1.help.address@gmail.com'). There are checkboxes for 'Show a different title to end-users' and 'Send user an auto-response confirming their new ticket'. At the bottom are 'Save', 'Reset', and 'Delete' buttons.

Properties | Permissions | Layout | Website Embed

Title * 

This is the title as it will appear throughout the agent and user interfaces.

☐ Show a different title to end-users

Parent

By setting a parent department, this department becomes a child. This is just an organizational feature that helps you create department structures that are easier to use.

New Ticket Trigger Set Email account:

☐ Send user an auto-response confirming their new ticket

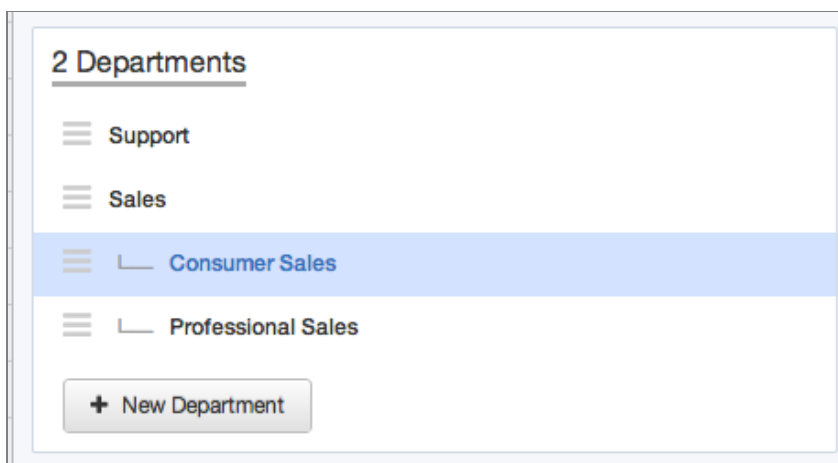
Edit the **Title** field to change the department's name. Click the globe icon to enter translations for each language you have enabled.

You can choose to **Show a different title to end-users** if you want to enter an alternative name for the department to be displayed to users in the web portal.

To create a sub-department, create a new department and then select its **Parent**. For example, you could create a **Consumer Sales** department, then make its parent **Sales**.

Note that if a department is a *parent* (i.e. has sub-departments), you can only assign tickets to its sub-departments. If you make a department with its own tickets into a parent, its tickets are moved to the sub-category.

As a result, there is little point having only a single sub-department within a department - in the example above, you would want to create a **Professional Sales** sub-department as well.



You can only have sub-departments one layer deep: i.e. you can have **Sales > Consumer Sales** and **Sales > Professional Sales** sub-departments, but not **Sales > Consumer Sales > Budget Range**

7.2. Department permissions

Click the **Permissions** tab for a ticket or chat department to edit the related permissions.

User department permissions

In the **User Group Permissions** section of a department's **Permissions** tab, you can select which [usergroups](#) have permission to create tickets in that department.

User Group Permissions

User Group permissions control which of your end-users can select a department when submitting or editing their tickets from the web portal.

Note that it is still possible for agents to change the department to one that a user would not normally have access to. Triggers can also be used to assign any department regardless of user permissions. User group permissions are therefore very much about what the user can select themselves.

User Group	Use
Everyone	☐
Registered	☒
VIP	☒

Note that this permission setting only affects *creating* tickets. If a ticket is assigned to the user, they will be able to see it on the portal, get replies etc, regardless of department permissions; and similarly, if the user is CC'd into the ticket, they will receive ticket messages.

If the user only has permission to select one department, the department field is not shown at all on contact forms etc.

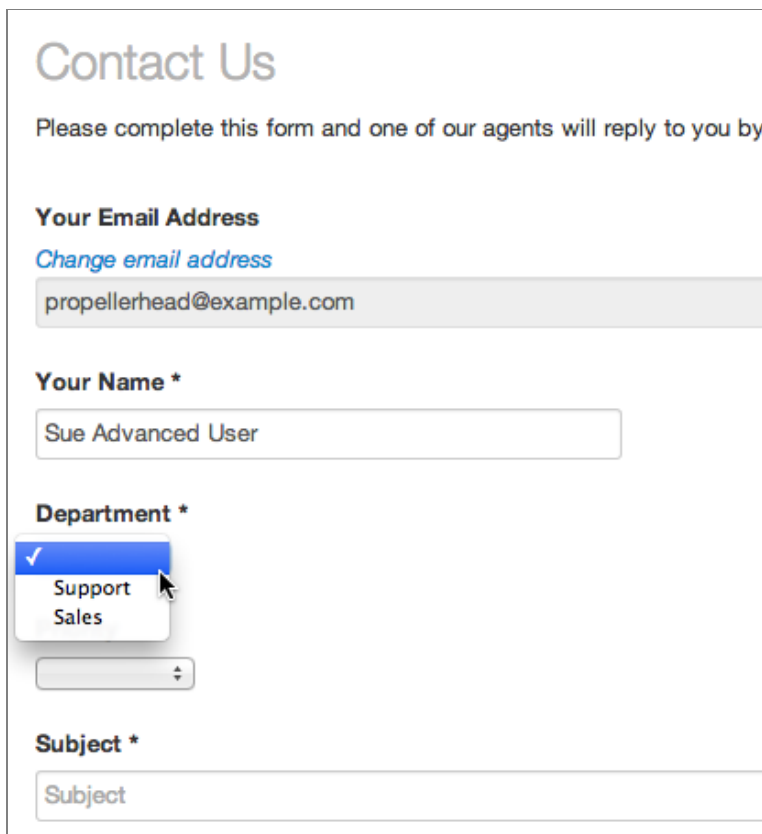
For example, suppose you have two departments, "Support" and "Sales".

You set the permissions for the groups like this:

User Group		Use
Everyone	Sales	☒
Registered		☒

User Group		Use
Everyone	Support	☐
Registered		☒

On your portal contact form, a user who is logged in will see this:



Contact Us

Please complete this form and one of our agents will reply to you by

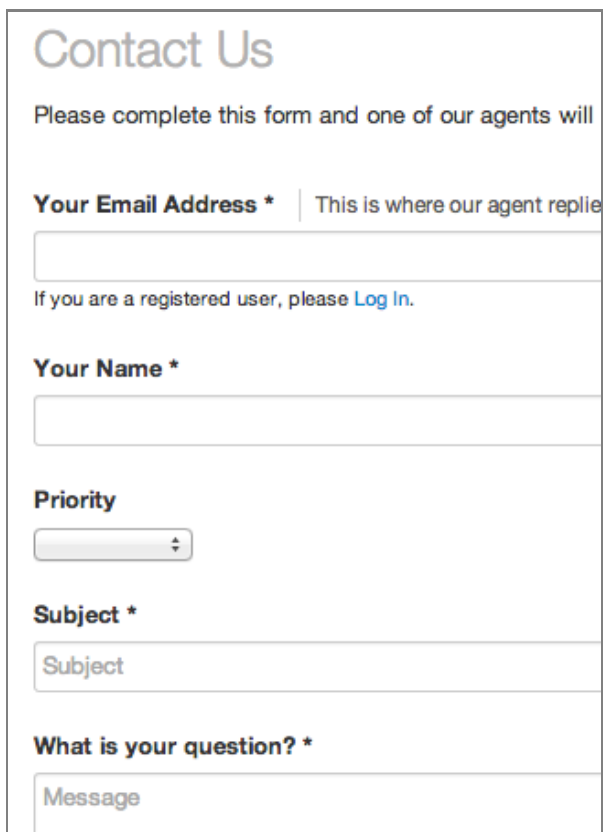
Your Email Address
[Change email address](#)
propellerhead@example.com

Your Name *
Sue Advanced User

Department *
Support
Sales

Subject *
Subject

whereas a user who isn't logged in will see this:



Contact Us

Please complete this form and one of our agents will

Your Email Address * | This is where our agent replies

If you are a registered user, please [Log In](#).

Your Name *

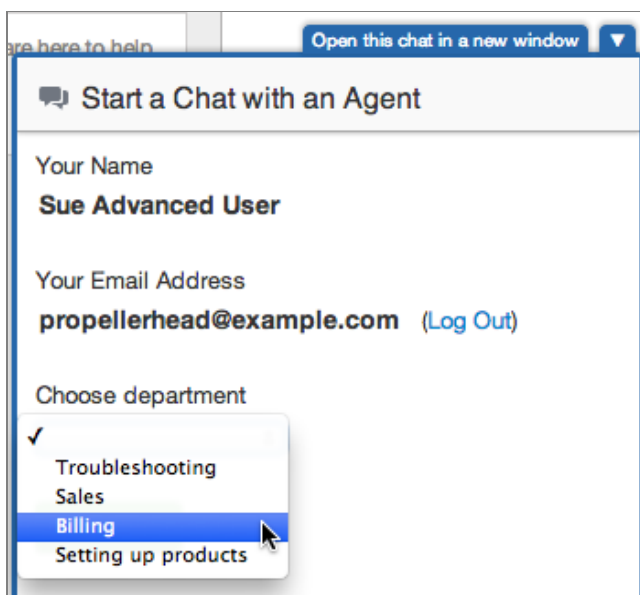
Priority
Priority

Subject *
Subject

What is your question? *
Message

The user registration settings under **CRM > Registration** can override department permissions; for example, if the **Everyone** usergroup has permission to create tickets in a department, but registration is required, guest users who aren't logged in will not see the contact form at all.

Chat department permissions for users work as for ticket departments, except that they control which departments users can select when they initiate a chat.



Agent department permissions

In the **Agent Permissions** section of a department's **Permissions** tab, you can select which [agent permission groups](#) and individual agents have access to that department.

Agent / Agent Group	Assign	Full Access
All Non-Destructive Permissions	☒	☒
All Permissions	☒	☒
Interns	☐	☐
Sales	☒	☐
Tech support	☒	☒
A-1 IT Boss	☒	☒
A-1 Sales Exec	☒	☒

There are two levels of agent permission for departments:

- 1 **assign** means that the agent can assign tickets to the department
- 2 **full access** permission means the agent can view and work with tickets in the department as normal

This means that an agent who only has **assign** permission can assign a ticket to a department, but will not be able to view it afterwards.

Note that department permissions are overridden by ticket assignment and following. If a ticket is assigned to an agent or one of the agent's teams, or the agent is added as a follower, the agent can view and work with it regardless of department.

You can also manage these settings from **Agents > Agent Permission Groups**

In the screenshot above, you will see that many of the permissions are on and locked. There are two reasons for this:

- 1 granting **full access** includes **assign**, so if the agent/group has been granted **full access**, **assign** is locked on.
- 2 if an agent is a member of a user permission group which already grants them a permission, it will be locked on.

Chat department permissions for agents work like those for ticket departments, except they control which chats agents can accept. Unlike the two permission levels of **assign/full access** for ticket departments, chat department access is either on or off.

7.3. Ticket form layouts

You can configure the fields which appear in the forms used to submit and edit tickets:

- For users, the Contact Us form in the web portal, and any embedded ticket forms.

The left screenshot shows the 'Support Center' interface. It includes a navigation bar with links to Knowledgebase, Downloads, Feedback, Contact Us, and News. Below this is a 'New Ticket' button and a 'Contact Us' form. The form fields include: Your Name, Your Email Address (with a note that replies will be sent here), Department (a dropdown menu), Subject, and a large text area for the message. There is also an 'Attachments' section with a file upload button and a 'Submit' button at the bottom.

The right screenshot shows a 'Welcome to A1 Corp' message. Below the message is a form for submitting a ticket. The form fields include: Your Email Address, Subject, and a large text area for the message. There is also a 'Priority' dropdown menu set to 'Routine' and a 'Submit' button at the bottom.

- For agents, the ticket form in the agent interface.

The screenshot shows the 'New Ticket' form in the agent interface. The form is divided into several sections: 'USER' (with a dropdown for 'Choose a person to create this ticket for' and a 'Create a new person' button), 'PROPERTIES' (with a 'Department' dropdown), and 'TICKET' (with 'Agent' and 'Subject' dropdowns). Below these sections is a rich text editor with various formatting options (bold, italic, underline, link, etc.). At the bottom of the form, there are buttons for 'Send Reply as Awaiting User', 'Email User', and 'Open Tab'.

You can have different layouts depending on the ticket department, and for agents and users within each department.

You set the defaults and validation Default values and data validation are properties of the field, not the form, but you can have different validation rules for users and agents.

To edit a form layout, go to **Tickets > Departments** and click on the **Layout** tab.

By default, all your forms use the same default layout. The buttons at the top of the **Layout** tab enable you to switch between editing the default, or just editing the form for the current department.

The screenshot shows the 'Form Layout' editor in DeskPRO. At the top, there are two tabs: 'Use Default Form Layout' and 'Use Custom Form Layout for "Support"'. A callout box points to these tabs with the text: 'Select whether to edit all departments or just this one'. Below the tabs, a blue banner states: 'All of your departments are using this layout. If you make changes to this layout, all departments will be affected.' Another callout box points to this banner with the text: 'Select whether to edit the user or agent form using tabs'. Below the banner are two tabs: 'User Form' and 'Agent Form'. A callout box points to these tabs with the text: 'Select whether to edit the user or agent form using tabs'. The main area displays a list of fields currently in the form, each with a menu icon on the left and a settings icon on the right. The fields are: Department, Subject, Message, User Email, Priority, Workflow, Category, CC, Product, CAPTCHA, Attachments, and User confirms T&Cs. A callout box points to the list of fields with the text: 'Fields currently in the form'. To the right of the main list is a panel titled 'Ticket Fields · Manage Fields' and 'User Fields · Manage Fields'. The 'Ticket Fields' panel contains a blue button labeled 'User confirms T&Cs'. The 'User Fields' panel contains four blue buttons: 'Name', 'Timezone', 'Language', and 'Level'. A callout box points to these panels with the text: 'Unused fields'. Below the 'Unused fields' panel is a callout box with the text: 'Remove field from form' pointing to the settings icon of the 'Product' field. Another callout box with the text: 'Edit field details' points to the settings icon of the 'Attachments' field. A callout box with the text: 'Custom field' points to the 'Attachments' field.

On the left is the list of fields currently in the form; the blue tabs at right are fields which are available for adding to the form (including custom fields for both tickets and users).

Drag and drop the blue fields you want onto the form. You can also set the order by dragging the fields on the form up and down.

Note that you can add both **ticket** fields and **user** fields. This enables you to have the user submit their identifying data, such as their account number, from the ticket form - see our Knowledgebase article [Adding custom user fields to ticket forms](#) for details.

For all but the compulsory fields, you can click the small gear icon to set the details of how the field should behave:

Options

☒ Show this field during ticket creation

☒ Show the field to agents when viewing the ticket

☒ Only show when there is a value

☒ Allow agents to edit the field

☐ Only show this field based on custom criteria

Done

The options for a field are:

- Show this field during ticket creation
- Let the user view this field after the ticket is created/Show the field to agents when viewing the ticket
 - Only show when there is a value - if enabled, when a user views an existing ticket, they will not see the field if it's empty
- Let the user edit this field after the ticket is created/Allow agents to edit the field
- Only show this field based on custom criteria

So you can, for example, have users set a priority for a ticket when they initially submit it, which they can't then change; or have a field that users can see but only agents can edit.

☒ Only show this field based on custom criteria

Show when all of the following criteria match:

- Department
- Product
- Category
- Priority
- Workflow

Only show this field based on custom criteria lets you show a field selectively if it matches **all** or **any** of your specified:

- Department
- Product
- Category
- Priority
- Workflow

For example, suppose your company's "Robo-cat" hardware products have a unique serial number which is useful for debugging, but your other products don't. You want to have the user form ask for a serial number for Robo-cat products only, and only for tickets to the Support department (since users submitting Sales tickets don't have the product yet).

A screenshot of a configuration interface for a field. At the top, there is a green toggle switch labeled 'Only show this field based on custom criteria'. Below it, the text 'Show when' is followed by a dropdown menu set to 'all' and the text 'of the following criteria match:'. There are two criteria listed: 'Product is' followed by a box containing 'Robo-cat Mk 1' and 'Robo-cat Mk 2', and 'Department is' followed by a box containing 'Support'. Each criterion has a small 'x' icon to its right. At the bottom of the criteria list is a green button with a plus icon and the text 'Criteria'.

You can also set **validation** rules about the field values that the user/agent is allowed/required to enter. You can do this using the individual field settings in **Tickets > Fields**.

A screenshot of the 'Validation' settings for a field. The section is titled 'Validation'. There are two checkboxes: the first is checked and labeled 'Require users to select a value for this field', and the second is unchecked and labeled 'Require agents to select a value for this field'.

The validation rules you set only apply if the field is being displayed.

See the section on [Field data validation](#) for more details.

8. Customizing the User Experience

DeskPRO offers flexible options to tailor how you present your helpdesk to users. Almost every user-facing element of the helpdesk is highly customizable, from the design of the portal to the phrasing of automatic emails.

In addition, you can integrate the portal within your existing website by embedding the following:

- The **Feedback & Support** tab widget enables users to interact with the helpdesk from an overlay without leaving your site
- The chat widget offers access to DeskPRO real-time chat from your website
- You can embed a contact form to submit a ticket on any web page.
- You can embed the entire portal within another site

In addition, you can control what information you collect from users when they submit a ticket through the web interface, by editing the user [Ticket Form Layouts](#).

8.1. Customizing email messages

Go to **Tickets > Email Templates** to customize the automatic notification emails from the helpdesk. You can change the content of both the user and agent emails, as well as making changes to the email layout which apply to both types of emails.

Email templates are configured using the TWIG template system. See <http://twig.sensiolabs.org/documentation> for more details.

Removing links to the portal

By default, if you have the DeskPRO Portal enabled, email notifications will be sent that include links to allow the user to view the ticket in the portal.

To remove those links from email notifications:

- 1 Go to: **Admin -> Tickets -> Email Notification Templates**
- 2 Select the **User Emails** tab.
- 3 Open the "New Ticket Confirmation" template.
- 4 Delete the code:

```
{{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_access_ticket_online') }}  
<a href="{{ ticket.link }}">{{ ticket.link }}</a>
```
- 5 Click **Save Template**.
- 6 Repeat the above steps for "New Ticket Created by Agent", "New Agent Reply" and "User Reply Auto-Response".

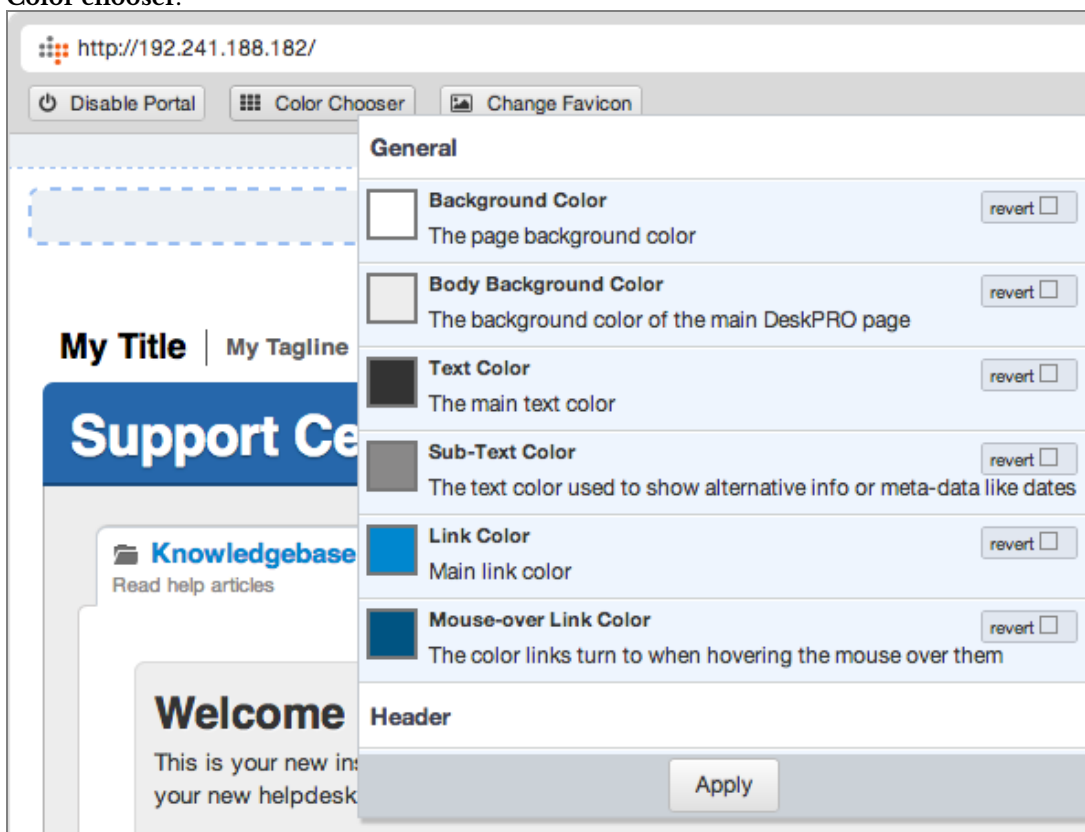
8.2. Portal editor

You can customize the look of the portal to make it closer to the design of your enterprise's website and other user-facing materials.

You can make simple changes to the portal design through **Portal > Portal Editor**.

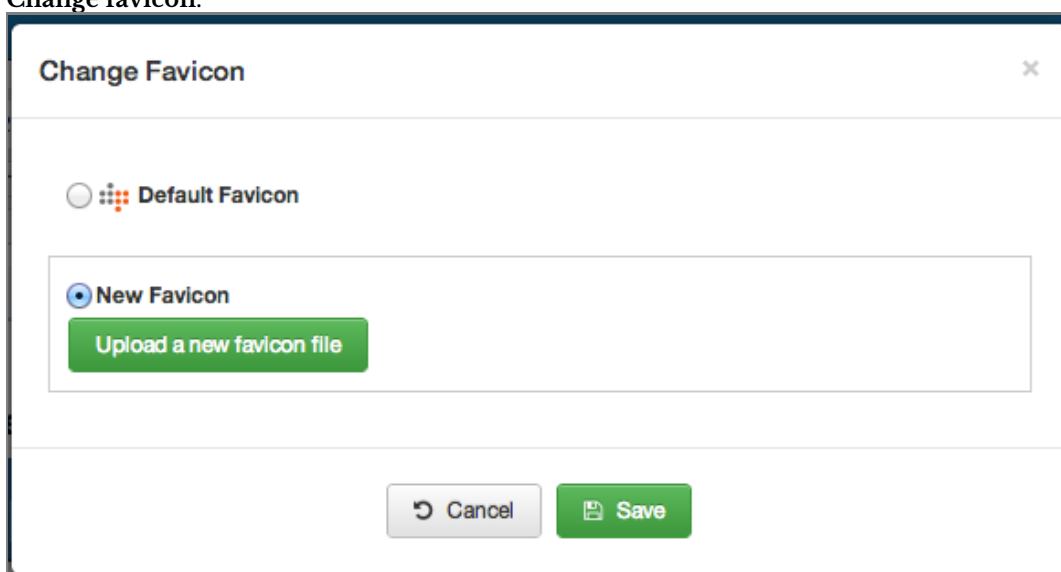
The design options available through the editor are:

Color chooser:

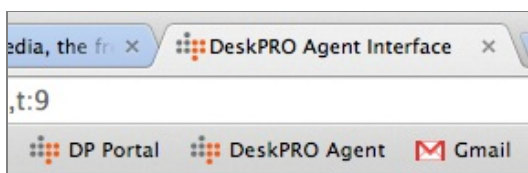


You can pick custom colors for most of the elements of the portal.

Change favicon:

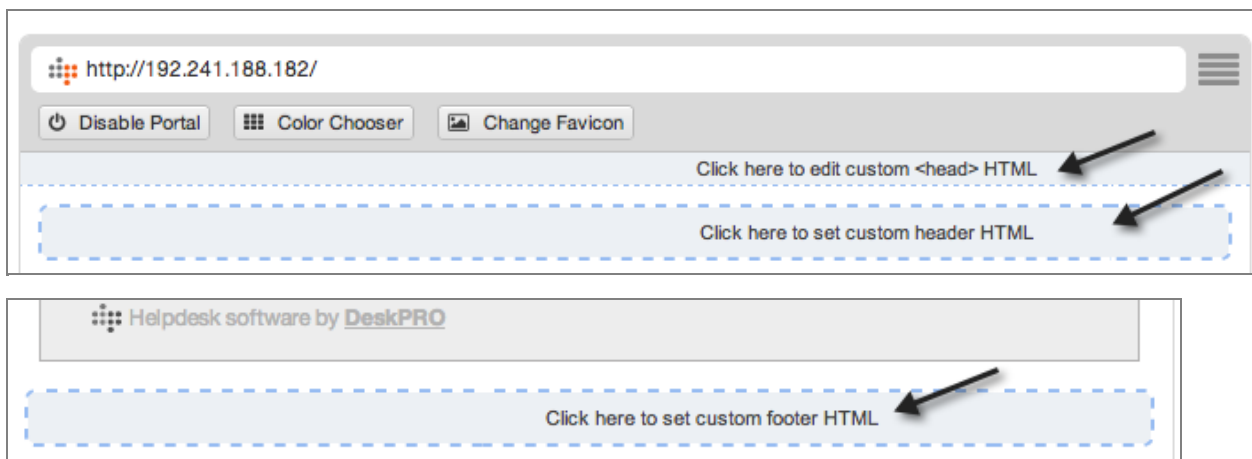


The favicon is the icon displayed by browsers to denote your site when the user bookmarks it, opens it in a tab, etc. This option lets you replace the default DeskPRO icon with your own logo.



Add custom HTML: You can insert a custom header and footer which will be displayed on all the pages of the web interface. You need to enter this as HTML code.

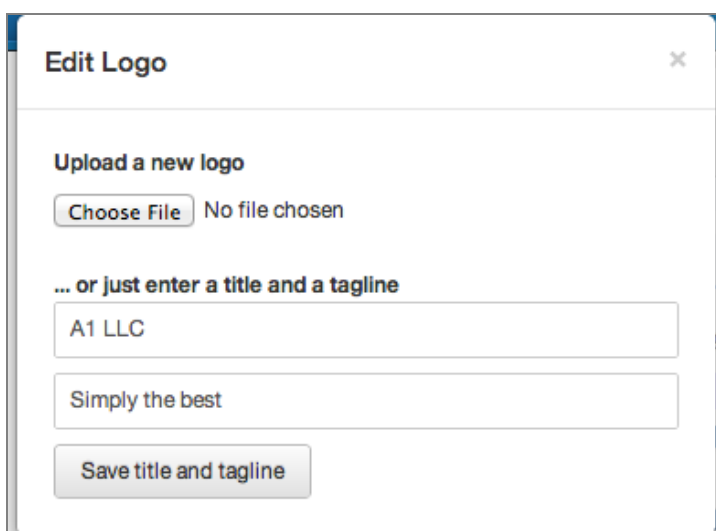
You can also enter code that will be inserted into the `<head>` element of the portal's HTML: this allows you to insert CSS or Javascript into the portal.



Add logo:



You can add a custom logo to the portal. Mouse over the title area and click the gear icon, then click **Choose file** to upload a logo image.



Note that uploading a logo replaces any title and tagline you have entered.

8.3. Changing portal design and content with templates

If you want to customize the portal more fully, you can edit the HTML and CSS directly using **Portal > Templates**.

This lets you dramatically alter the design of the portal to make it look like part of your website.

You can also use the template system in combination with custom **phrases** to customize the text content of the portal.

See the [Editing Templates](#) section for more details.

8.4. Customizing portal content

Most of the content displayed on the portal (Knowledgebase articles, news posts, downloads, and glossary terms) is created and managed from the **Publish** app in the agent interface. Feedback is managed from the agent **Feedback** app.

There are some aspects of portal content that can be customized from the admin interface.

Rearranging portal content

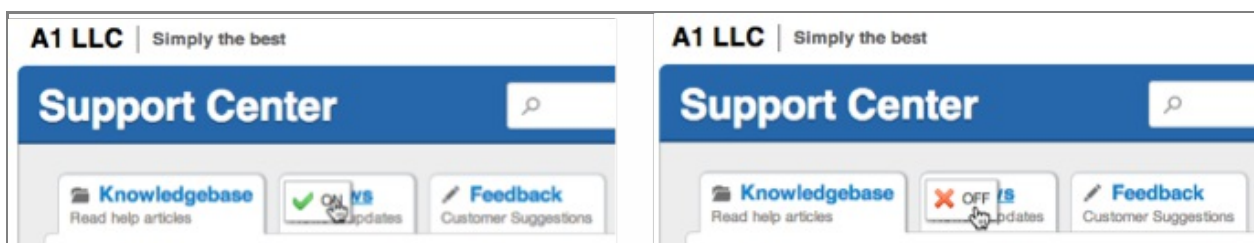
You can move most of the portal sections around.

Mouse over a section until a four-way arrow cursor is displayed. Click and hold down the mouse button while you drag the section to the desired location.

Hiding and displaying portal sections

If you don't want to use a certain portal content type, such as news posts, you can disable the relevant section of the portal from **Portal > Portal Editor**. This avoids users seeing an empty area of the portal.

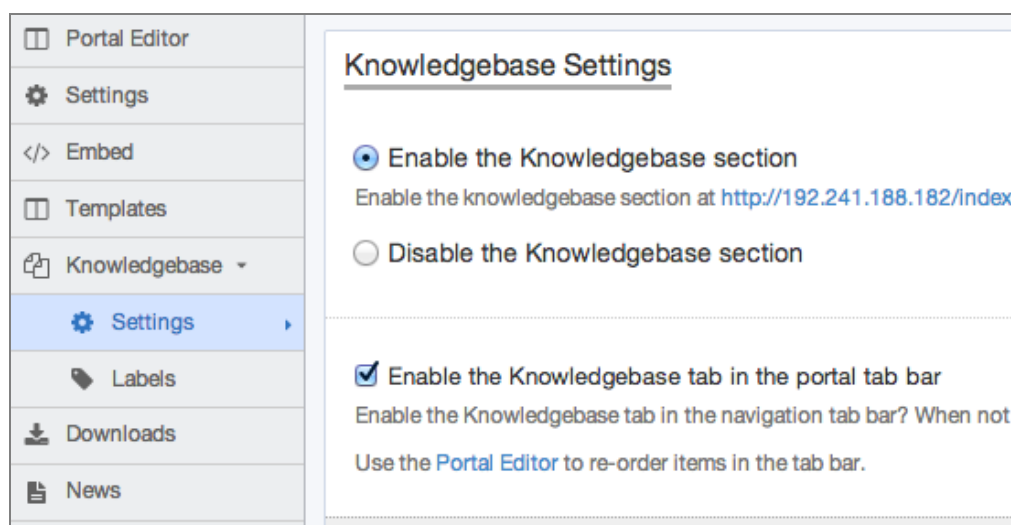
Mouse over a portal section, then click the **ON** control, to toggle the section off.



You can also drag the section tabs to reorder them.

Note that turning off a section in this way only prevents it from being displayed on the portal; any content isn't deleted, and remains accessible through the **Publish/Feedback** in the agent interface. You can continue to create content even if the section isn't being displayed. So you could, for example, disable your Knowledgebase section while it's empty, write an initial set of articles, then enable it again.

In the individual settings for each portal section, you also have the option to disable display of the tab, while leaving the section active. This means the section is still available for users who know the correct web address, but users who come to the portal homepage won't be able to navigate to it.



For example, suppose you have drivers in your Downloads section that should only be installed on the advice of an agent. You could disable the Downloads tab, so users can't find the section and experiment with drivers, but you could still easily send links to the drivers when needed.

Permissions will also affect the display of portal sections.

Sections are not shown if the user does not have:

- the correct *usergroup* permissions (set in **CRM > Permission Groups**)
- for Contact Us, sufficient *department* permissions to use at least one department available on the form (set in **Tickets > Departments** in the **Permissions** tab)

Note that the **Everyone** and **Registered** usergroups can affect what agents see on the portal. For example, suppose you have a single department, with **Everyone** and **Registered** permissions disabled. Your agents will not be able to see the **Contact Us** section on the portal, even if they have *agent* permissions to use that department in the agent interface.

User Group Permissions ?

User Group	Use
 Everyone	☐
 Registered	☐
 Troublemakers	☒
 VIPs	☒

Agent Permissions ?

Agent / Agent Group	Assign	Full Access
 All Non-Destructive Permissions	☒	☒
 All Permissions	☒	☒

Ticket deflection

Ticket deflection is a way to direct users to knowledgebase articles that might answer their question before they submit a ticket.

If you enable this option from **Tickets > Settings**, when users start typing into the **Contact Us** ticket submission form on the portal, matching articles will be suggested automatically.

Department *
Support

Subject *
email problem

What is your question? *
Message

We found the following content that may answer your question
Do not worry, you can click a title and you will remain on this page.

- Is there a debug mode for email processing?**
Yes. You can run the following command from the command line: `php cron.php --verbose -j process_ema...`
- Manually run the email processing command**
Sometimes you may want to manually run the email processing command. For example, to debug connectio...

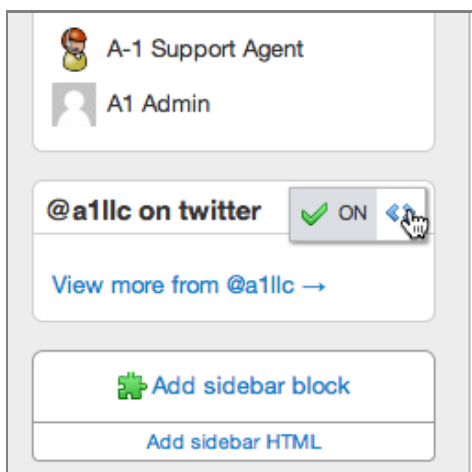
Portal contact form layout

You can edit the layout of the contact (ticket submission) form, including having different layouts for each department. See the section [Contact form layouts](#) for details.

Showing your Twitter account on the portal

You can show recent tweets from a Twitter account you control in the portal sidebar with the Twitter block.

Mouse over the block and then click on the <> control to configure it.



Enter the Twitter account you wish to include, and how many recent tweets you want to show.

You must authenticate with Twitter by clicking the link and authorizing the portal to access the account.

Custom portal sidebars

You can add custom sidebar blocks to the portal.

If you want to include a simple sidebar that is the same for all users, click **Add sidebar block** and enter the block title, then its contents (marked up as HTML).

The **Add sidebar HTML** option is more powerful, because it allows you to use variables and conditional logic from the template system.

The following variables are useful for creating blocks:

{{ app.user.id }}	User ID - useful for conditional tests to see if user is logged in
{{ app.user.name }}	User's name
{{ app.user.primary_email_address }}	User email address
{{ app.user.organization.name }}	

Here's an example sidebar that displays a personalized greeting to the user, if they are logged in:

```
{% if app.user.id %}

<p>Hello, {{ app.user.name }}!</p>

<p>A1 Corp especially values the custom of your employer, {{ app.user.organization.name }}.</p>

{% endif %}
```

See the section on [Editing Templates](#) for more about using the template system.

Custom ticket form

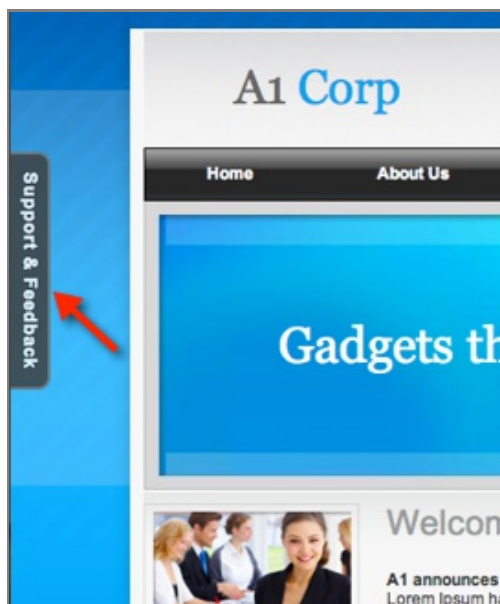
You can customize the layout of the Contact Us section ticket submission form from **Tickets > Departments**, using the **Layout** tab. See the section on [Ticket form layouts](#) for details.

8.5. Website integration

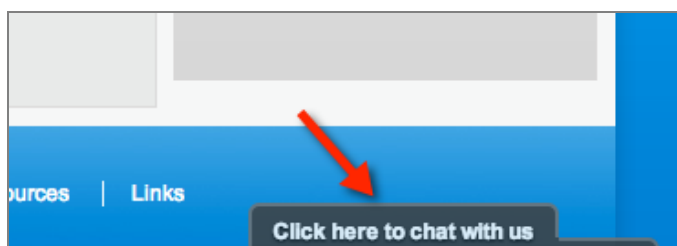
You can embed some DeskPRO functions, or your entire portal, into your existing website. This means that users don't have to navigate to your portal before using the helpdesk.

The available options for embedding are:

- a **Feedback & Support** tab at the left or right hand side of your site, giving users access to ticket submission, feedback, chat and the ability to search knowledgebase articles and news posts



- a **chat widget** at the bottom of your site

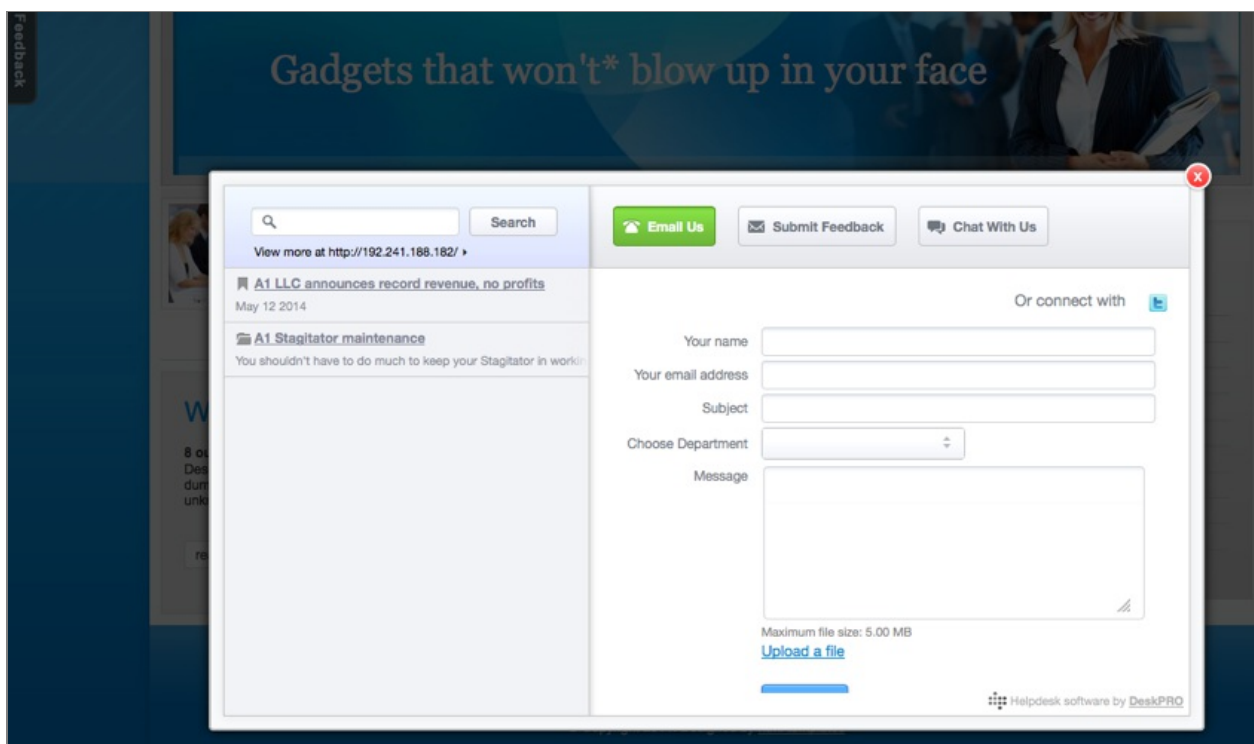


- a **contact form** for ticket submission, which can be set to submit to a particular department or allow the user to choose
- **embedding the whole portal** into a page on your site

Embedding any of these requires adding some Javascript code (which you can copy from the admin interface) to your website. It's simple, as long as you know how to edit the code of your website directly. Some "easy website builder" hosting services may not allow you to add the required code.

Embedding the Feedback & Support tab

When clicked, the Feedback & Support shows the following pop-up window over your website content:



The **Email Us** option displays a ticket submission form using your default layout from **Tickets > Departments**.

The **Submit Feedback** option enables the user to submit a feedback item, and the **Chat With Us** option enables the user to start a chat.

The search bar at the left searches through knowledgebase articles and news posts. You can also choose some articles or news items to display by default (see below).

To embed the Feedback & Support tab:

Feedback and Support Tab

The tab widget places a tab button on the left of your website. When the user clicks the tab

Tab title:

Tab position:

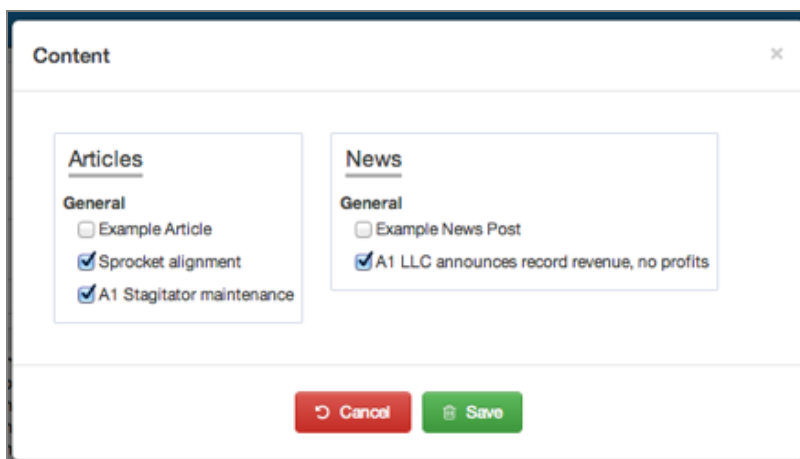
Language:

```
<!-- DeskPRO Widget -->
<script type="text/javascript">
  var DpOverlayWidget_Options = DpOverlayWidget_Options || {};
  DpOverlayWidget_Options.phrase = 'Support & Feedback';
  DpOverlayWidget_Options.tabLocation = 'left';
  DpOverlayWidget_Options.languageId = 0;
  DpOverlayWidget_Options.topPosition = '200px';
```

- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**
- 2 In the **Feedback and Support Tab** section, set the options you want for your tab:
 - Edit the **Tab title** to change the text displayed on the tab.
 - Choose the **Tab position** (left or right edge of your site).
 - Set the **Language** displayed in the tab (note that unlike on the portal, the language cannot be changed by users).
- 3 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 4 Insert the code into the HTML of the page on your website where you want the tab to appear. We recommend putting it just before the `</body>` tag, i.e. after all the other page content.

Note that the settings for the above tab options are stored in the embed code. If you want to change them, you will need to copy and paste the Javascript again.

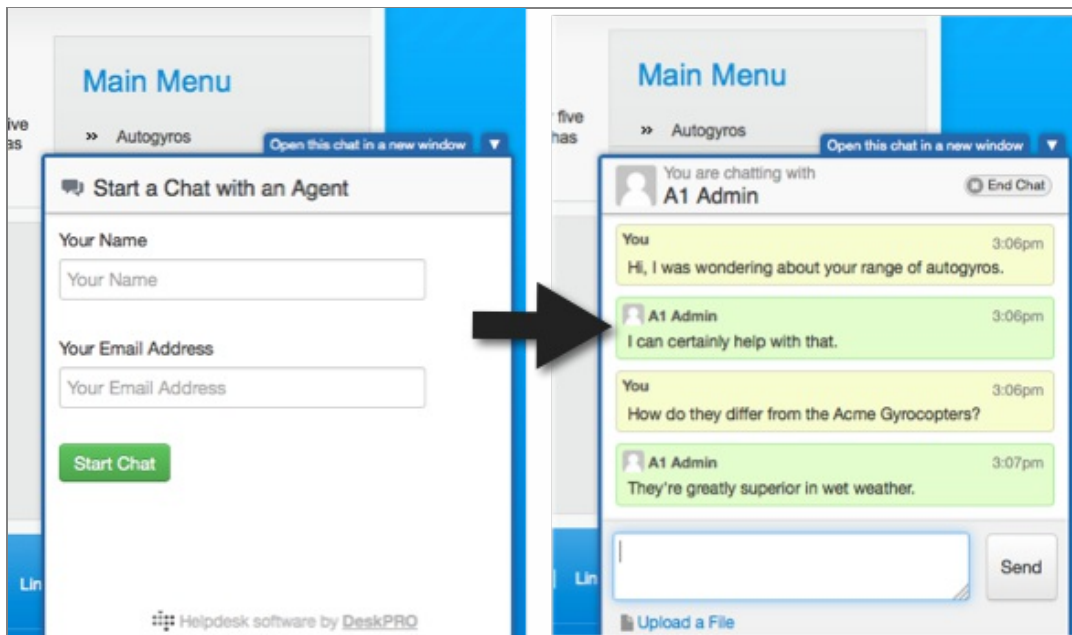
You can select the articles and news posts to display by default on the left of the overlay. Click the **Select content to show** button:



You can change this setting and the content displayed will update without you needing to re-paste the Javascript.

Embedding the chat widget

When clicked, the chat widget expands into a chat window.



Note that, depending on the chat permissions settings for the **Everyone** usergroup, users may have to log in before starting a chat.

To embed the chat widget:

Chat

The chat widget puts a small button on the bottom left of your website. When the user clicks the button, a chat to browse around your site while the chat is active.

Tab title:

Tab position:

Language:

☐ Show button even when chat is offline

```
<!-- DeskPRO Chat -->
<script type="text/javascript">
  var DpChatWidget_Options = DpChatWidget_Options || {};
  DpChatWidget_Options.startPhrase = 'Click here to chat with us';
  DpChatWidget_Options.tabLocation = 'right';

  DpChatWidget_Options.openInWindowPhrase = 'Open this chat in a new window';
```

- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**
- 2 In the **Chat** section, set the options you want for the widget:
 - Edit the **Tab title** (text displayed on the minimized chat tab)
 - Choose the **Tab position** (bottom left or bottom right)
 - Choose the chat language.
- 3 By default, the chat widget is not shown if chat is disabled or there are no agents logged in. Check **Show button even when chat is offline** to change this; you can provide alternative text and a link where the tab will direct users when chat is offline (by default, this is to your contact form).
- 4 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 5 Insert the code on the page on your website where you want the chat widget to appear. We recommend putting it just before the `</body>` tag.

Using a custom button with the chat widget

If you want to use your own custom HTML element/button to launch the chat widget on a page, add the special classname `dp-chat-trigger` to it. For example:

```
<button class="dp-chat-trigger">Start chatting</button>
```

You can use custom CSS on your page to hide the default button, and make sure your button is hidden when agents are offline:

```
<style type="text/css">
#dpchat_wrap {
  display: none !important;
  visibility: hidden !important;
}

.dp-chat-trigger {
  display: none !important;
}

.dp-chat-enabled .dp-chat-trigger {
  display: block !important;
}
</style>
```

Embedding a contact form

You can embed a contact form to allow users to submit tickets from your website.

Welcome to A1 Corp

We're here to serve you
Your Email Address *

Subject *

What is your question? *

Message

Priority
Routine

Submit

Main Menu

- » Blimps
- » Autogyros
- » Jet skidoos
- » Dynamite
- » Springs
- » Fake tunnels
- » Biped traps

To embed a form:

Contact Form

Embed a contact form directly in to any web page.

Language: Default

Department: Let the user choose

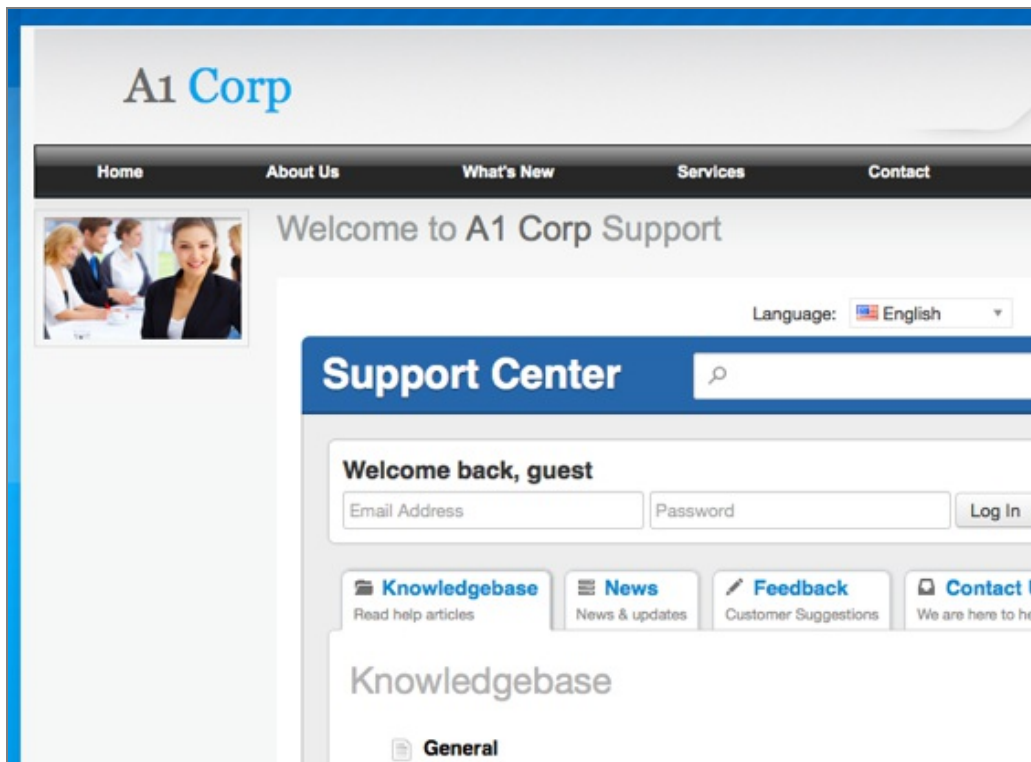
```
<!-- DeskPRO Ticket Form -->
<div id="dp_newticket_form" style="display: none;"></div>
<script type="text/javascript">
var DpNewTicket_Options = DpNewTicket_Options || {};
DpNewTicket_Options.departmentId = 0;
DpNewTicket_Options.languageId = 0;
```

- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**
- 2 In the **Contact Form** section, select the language for the form.
- 3 Choose whether to let the user select a department, or to make this form submit to a specific department only.
- 4 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 5 Insert the code where you want the form to appear.

You can use the ability to specify a department to put the most relevant forms on each area of your site. For example, you could put a form for your Sales department on a page about an upcoming product.

Embedding the whole portal

You can embed the whole portal within a page on your website.



- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**
- 2 Under **Embed your entire helpdesk**, set the embedding options.
 - **Hide the sidebar and border**(on by default)
 - Select which helpdesk section is displayed initially.
 - Select the initial language to display
- 3 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 4 Insert the code where you want the portal to appear.

To make the embedded portal look more like a part of your site, you could use the Portal Editor **color chooser** or edit the portal template.

8.6. Ticket ref codes

By default, a ticket's ID number is displayed to users in email notifications and the portal, and acts as the user's reference for that ticket.

The screenshot shows the 'Support Center' interface. On the left, a navigation pane includes 'Knowledgebase' and 'News'. The main content area shows a ticket titled 'Missing piece' with a 'Ticket Ref: 31' and a timestamp 'Wed, 14th May 2014 9:35a'. Below this is a table with 'Assigned Agent' and 'Unassigned' columns, and a 'Department' row showing 'Support'. On the right, a 'Ticket' summary table displays the following information:

View this ticket online: https://acmeinc.deskpro.com/agent/#ap	
ID	68
Status	Awaiting Agent
Agent	Acme Support Agent 1
Department	Support Dept.
Category	Consumer

However, ticket ID numbers are assigned in sequence. That means they will reveal the total number of tickets you have had to your helpdesk, and let repeat users work out how many tickets you deal with. In addition, once you have a lot of tickets in your helpdesk, you will end up with long ID numbers that aren't readable or user-friendly.

You can choose to show **ref codes** to users instead of the ticket ID. A ref code is a string of numbers and letters that uniquely identifies a ticket, but isn't assigned sequentially, avoiding the problems mentioned above.

You can customize the ref code format to include information about the time the ticket was created; ticket reference `2014-01-26-AB379` is more meaningful than ticket ID `74983`.

To enable ref codes, go to **Tickets > Settings** and then the **Ticket Ref Codes** section, and check **Use ref codes**.

The 'Ticket Ref Codes' settings page includes the following information:

Each ticket is given a unique ID number. You may also enable "ref codes" to show a reference string to users instead of the ID number. These ref codes are generally more readable and user-friendly.

By default, ref codes are in the format "ABCD-1234-EFGH". You can customize the ref code format.

☒ **Use ref codes**
Show user the ref code instead of numeric ID's in email notifications, the web portal and URLs.

☐ **Use a custom ref code**
Enable to use a custom format for your ref codes.

By default, ref codes are in the format `ABCD-1234-EFGH`.

If you check **Use a custom ref code** you can enter the format you want as a string of tokens, surrounded by angle brackets. For example, `<YEAR>-<MONTH>-<A><A><A><#><#>` would give you codes such as `2014-05-QZD45`.

Anything you enter that isn't in angle brackets will be the same in every code.

Here are the available tokens:

Token	Result
<A>	A random letter

<#>	A random number
<?>	A random letter or number
<YEAR>	Year as a four-digit number (e.g. 2013)
<MONTH>	Month as a two-digit number (01-12)
<DAY>	Day as a two-digit number (01-31)
<HOUR>	Hour in 24-hour time (00-24)
<MIN>	Minute as a two-digit number (00-59)
<SEC>	Second as a two-digit number (00-59)

You can also choose to have up to 8 digits added onto the end of the code. These are added sequentially.

Ticket Ref Codes

Each ticket is given a unique ID number. You may also enable "ref codes". These ref codes are generally more readable and user-friendly. By default, ref codes are in the format "ABCD-1234-EFGH". You can customize the format.

☒ Use ref codes

Show users the ref code instead of numeric ID's in email notifications

☒ Use a custom ref code ?

Enable to use a custom format for your ref codes.

<YEAR>-<A><A><?><?><?>

and append

0 digits
1 digit
2 digits
3 digits
4 digits
5 digits
6 digits
7 digits
8 digits

Here are some examples:

<YEAR>-<MONTH> and append 3 digits	2013-10-001, 2013-10-002 (counting upwards)
<?><?><?><?><?><?>	1045885, 6947325
<YEAR>-<A><A><?><?><?>	2013-AB34, 2013-HXR8
ACME-<A><A><?><?><?><?>	ACME-AB2952, ACME-FV4541

9. Customizing the Agent Interface

This chapter explains options you can use to change the agent interface.

9.1. Time log & billing

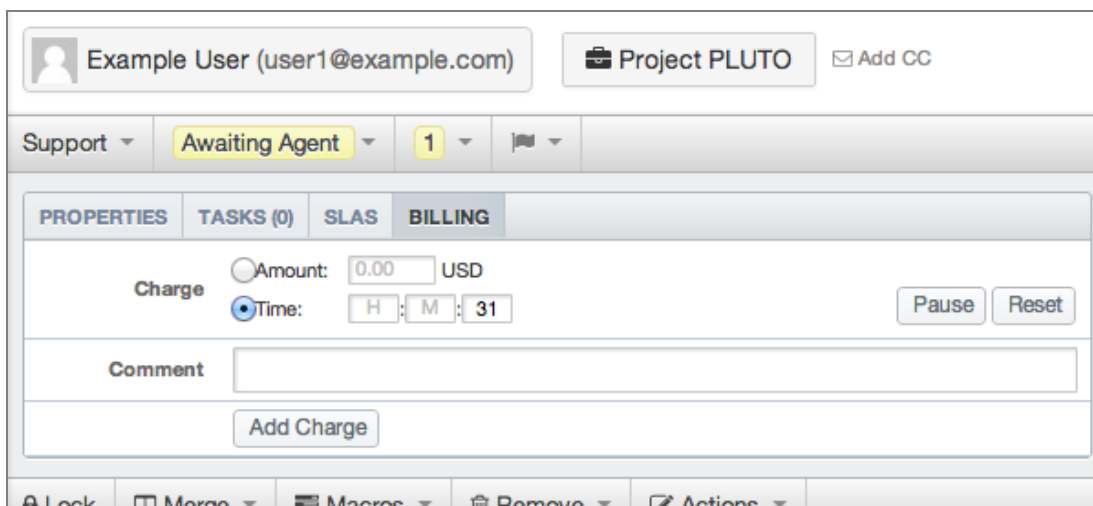
If your agents need to bill users based on the support they provide, you can enable the **time log** and **ticket billing** features.

The time log lets agents record the amount of time they spend on a ticket, while ticket billing lets them specify an amount of money to charge for support.

This is not to be confused with the **Billing & Licensing interface** where you pay for your DeskPRO

license, accessible through the  icon at the lower left.

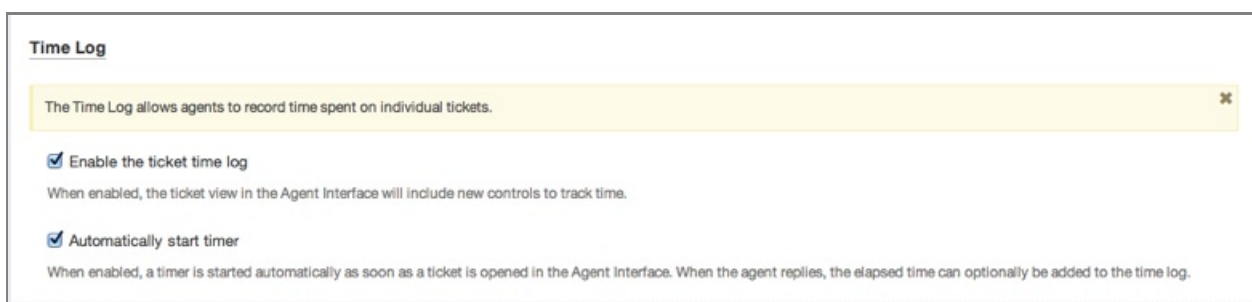
You can enable time logging and billing separately. If either option is enabled, tickets in the agent interface have a **Billing** tab.



The screenshot shows the DeskPRO agent interface. At the top, there's a header with a user profile (Example User, user1@example.com), a project name (Project PLUTO), and an 'Add CC' button. Below this is a navigation bar with 'Support', 'Awaiting Agent', and a dropdown showing '1'. The main content area has tabs for 'PROPERTIES', 'TASKS (0)', 'SLAS', and 'BILLING'. The 'BILLING' tab is active, showing a 'Charge' section with radio buttons for 'Amount' (0.00 USD) and 'Time' (H: M: 31). There are 'Pause' and 'Reset' buttons. Below this is a 'Comment' text area and an 'Add Charge' button. At the bottom, there's a toolbar with 'Lock', 'Merge', 'Macros', 'Remove', and 'Actions'.

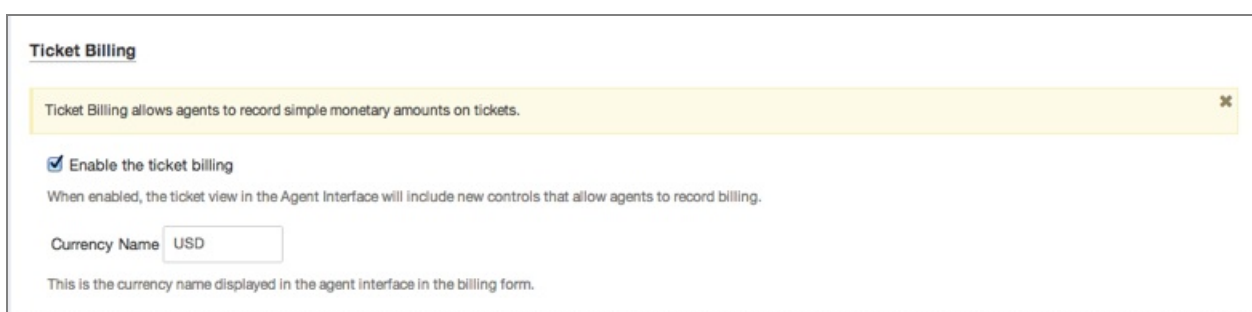
Go to **Tickets > Time Log & Billing** to change the settings.

The **Time Log** sections lets you enable the time log, and choose whether to **Automatically start timer** as soon as the ticket is opened by an agent. Note that the agent still has to press the **Add Charge** button to save the elapsed time.



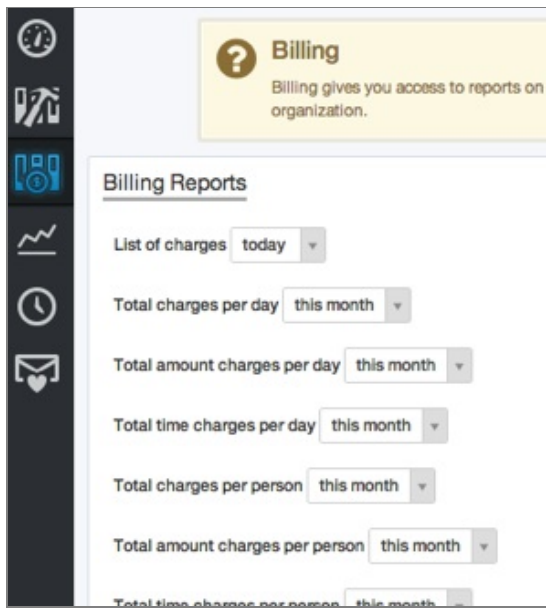
The screenshot shows the 'Time Log' settings panel. It has a title 'Time Log' and a description: 'The Time Log allows agents to record time spent on individual tickets.' There are two checkboxes: 'Enable the ticket time log' (checked) and 'Automatically start timer' (checked). Below each checkbox is a brief explanation of what happens when it's enabled.

The **Ticket Billing** section lets you enable or disable monetary billing. You can edit the currency name.



The screenshot shows the 'Ticket Billing' settings panel. It has a title 'Ticket Billing' and a description: 'Ticket Billing allows agents to record simple monetary amounts on tickets.' There is a checkbox 'Enable the ticket billing' (checked). Below it is a text input field for 'Currency Name' with 'USD' entered. A note at the bottom says: 'This is the currency name displayed in the agent interface in the billing form.'

Users are not notified of times and charges recorded by agents - you will need to bill users outside of DeskPRO. To facilitate this process, you can use the **Reports** interface to see summaries of all charges; note that you can generate reports by organization as well as by user.



9.2. Automatic ticket locking

Confusion about who is working on a ticket is usually prevented by:

- 1 | agent assignment
- 2 | the ability for agents to see each other's draft messages

If an agent needs to prevent other agents changing a ticket, they can use the DeskPRO **locking** feature to manually lock it.

You can also enable **automatic locking** of tickets from **Tickets > Settings**, based on which agent has opened the ticket:

Ticket Locking ?

☐ **Automatically enable lock**
When enabled, a ticket will be automatically locked when an agent opens it in the agent interface.

☐ **Automatically release lock**
When enabled, the ticket will be automatically unlocked when the owner closes the ticket tab.

Lock timeout ▼
The time a ticket can be kept locked to one agent before the system automatically unlocks it.

Automatic locking might be useful if you find your agents are duplicating work, or getting into disagreements about who is replying to a ticket.

The **lock timeout** is the period of time before the lock is automatically removed. It applies to both automatic and manual locks. This is necessary to prevent locks being left on too long (for example, if an agent locks a ticket and then forgets about it).

9.3. Managing labels

The **labels** system lets agents apply text tags to the following helpdesk content:

- Tickets
- Users
- Organizations
- Downloads
- News posts
- Feedback

These help with search and filtering of items from the agent interface.

There is a **Labels** management screen under the settings for each item.

You can add, rename or delete labels. This can be useful to correct misspelled or unhelpful label names.

9.4. Setting agent interface defaults

Under **Tickets > Settings > Ticket Defaults** you can configure the default values for agent interface inputs.

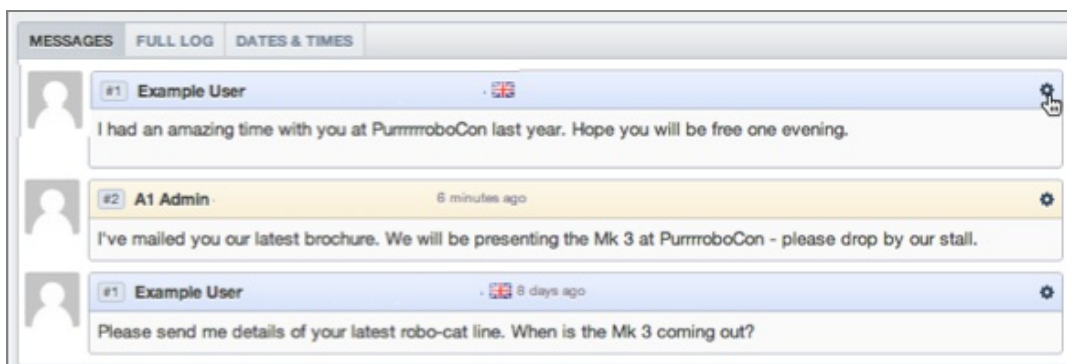
Ticket Defaults ⓘ	
New Ticket	
Set status	Awaiting User ▼
Set agent (when ticket is unassigned)	Assign to self ▼
Set team (when ticket has no team)	▼
User notification	☒ Check the "send user email notification" checkbox by default
Ticket Reply	
Set status	Awaiting User ▼
Set agent (when ticket is unassigned)	Assign to self ▼
Set agent (when ticket is already assigned)	▼
Set team (when ticket has no team)	▼
Set team (when ticket is already assigned to a team)	▼
User notification	☒ Check the "send user email notification" checkbox by default
Automatically set status	☐ When changing the assigned agent from the reply box, automatically change the status to Awaiting Agent
Automatically enable "close tab"	☐ When changing the status to Resolved from the reply box, automatically check the "close tab after reply" option.
Ticket View	
Reverse message order	☒ Show newest messages first with the reply box at the top.

You can change these to reflect how your agents use DeskPRO. Pick defaults which reflect what agents do most often to increase their productivity.

For example, when an agent is replying to an unassigned ticket, the default is to assign it to that agent when the reply is sent, unless the **Agent** checkbox is cleared. If this default does not reflect how your agents use DeskPRO, you can change it.

Ticket message forwarding

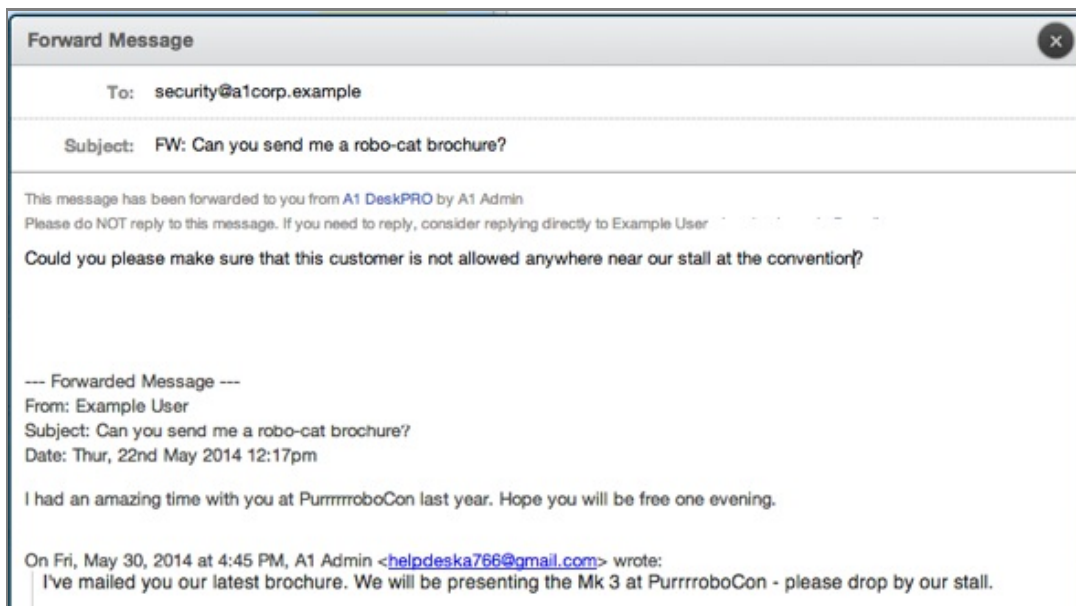
Agents can forward individual ticket messages via email, using the **Forward message** option accessible from the gear icon to the right of each message.



This is useful for forwarding messages outside of the helpdesk if they would better be dealt with as a private email conversation.

Under **Tickets > Forward Settings** you can change which email account is used to send the emails.

By default, the forwarded email will appear to come from ticket email account's address, but you can choose to use the agent's address in the From: field instead. For this to work, you may need to configure your email server to accept messages with any From: address.



9.5. Custom filters

Ticket filters enable agents to view a list of all the tickets which meet a set of conditions. Agents can create their own filters from the agent interface; these are visible only to the agent who made them.

You can define custom filters for your helpdesk to be shown to all agents, to supplement the built-in filters like **My Tickets**. Filters make it easy for agents to track specific groups of tickets without repeated searching.

Create filters from **Tickets > Filters**.

Filter Creation Form:

Title * Zenith robo-cat critical
This title will be displayed in the agent interface

Permission

- ☒ Everyone can use this filter
- ☐ This filter belongs to a specific agent
- ☐ This filter belongs to a specific team

Search Terms ?

If The following conditions are met:

- Priority is Critical
- Department is not Sales
- Product is Robo-cat Mk 1
- Organization Name is Zenith Inc.

Criteria

Agent Interface Filter Pane:

TICKETS SEARCH

AWAITING AGENT

- My Tickets** 11
- Tickets I Follow 0
- Unassigned Tickets 43
- All Tickets 57
- FILTERS** 1
- Zenith robo-cat critical 1

Each filter has its own set of criteria and will only show tickets that match them all. Filters are shown in the agent interface filter pane. Filters you create from the admin interface can be visible to a specific agent, to a specific team, or to everyone.

10. Permissions and Access

Permissions control what actions agents and users are allowed to carry out within DeskPRO.

DeskPRO has a powerful permissions system for agents; you can shut off access to whole apps, or choose what actions to allow at a very detailed level. This enables you to give agents access only to the functions they need, simplifying training and limiting the potential damage from mistakes as agents learn to use the helpdesk.

For example, you can create a very limited account for a trainee agent that can't change or see any tickets apart from those they are specifically assigned.

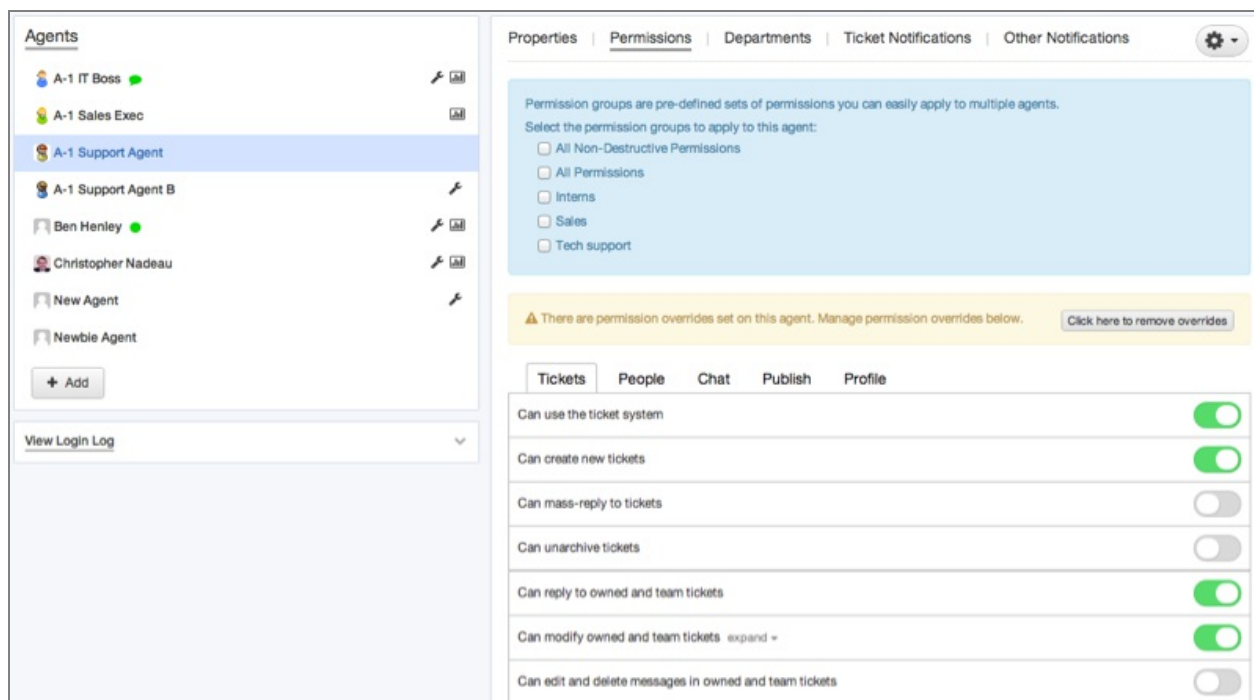
There are dozens of possible settings for each agent. To avoid the need to set each one individually for all of your agents, DeskPRO has **permission groups**, pre-defined sets of permissions you can easily apply to multiple agents.

There is a similar permissions system to control what users can do, with **usergroups** that work in a similar way to agent permission groups.

You can also set a user **registration** policy which determines how users create an account on your helpdesk, and what they can do without registering. You can configure the helpdesk so that can authenticate with credentials from outside DeskPRO, for example from a separate database, your network or using a social media account.

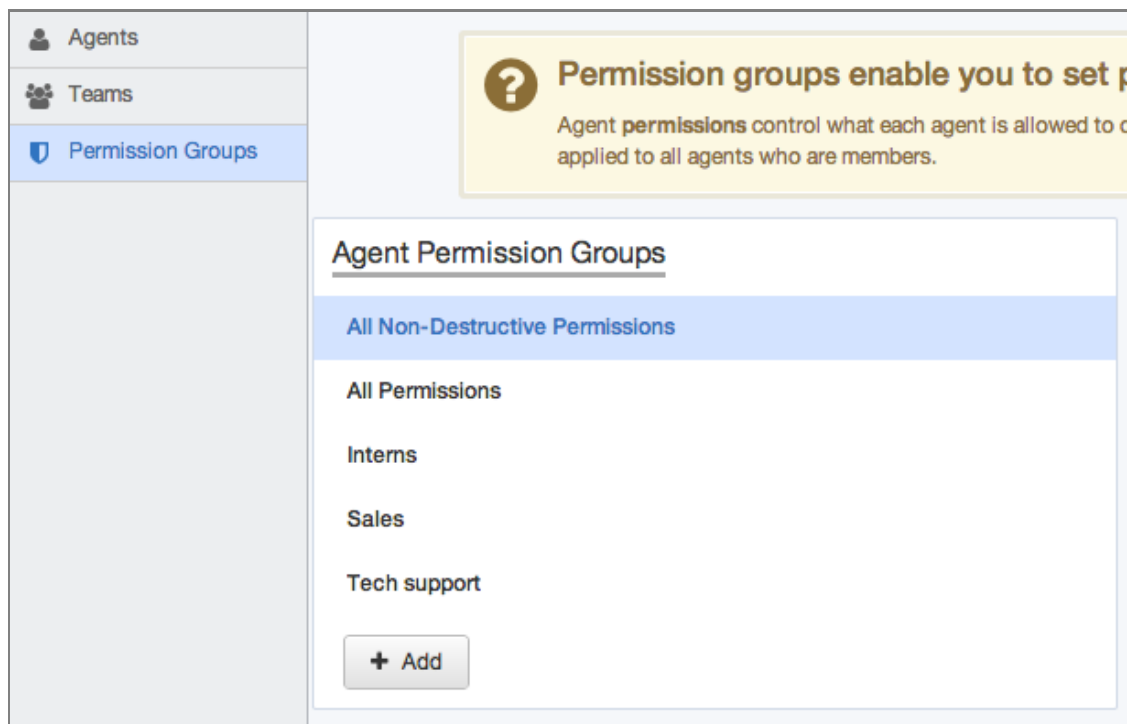
10.1. Agent permissions

To set individual permissions for an agent, go to **Agents** and click on the agent's name, then the **Permissions** tab.



You can use the toggle controls at right to enable and disable the agent's ability to carry out a wide variety of ticket actions. Click the **People**, **Chat**, **Publish** or **Profile** tabs to set permissions for other parts of the helpdesk.

Instead of making decisions about each of the dozens of possible actions for every one of your agents, we recommend you use permission groups to store sets of permissions you can quickly apply to multiple agents. These are managed from **Agents > Permission Groups**



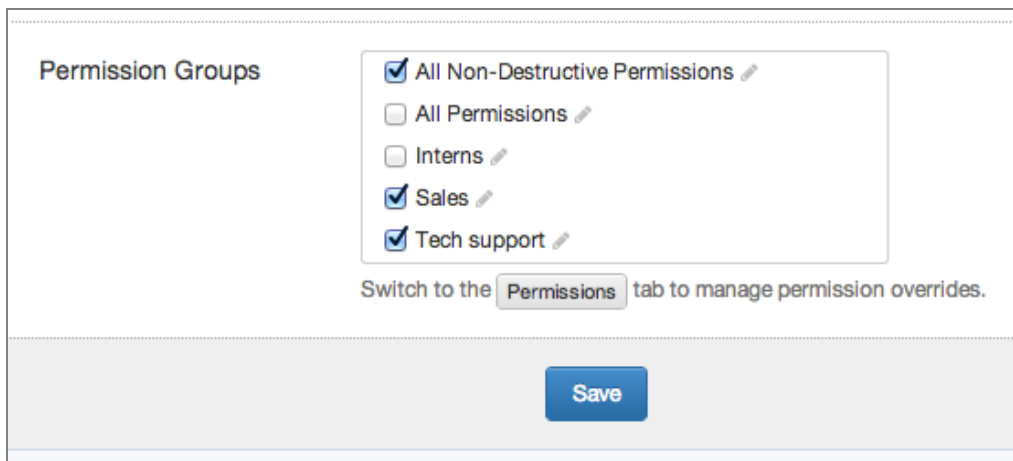
The default groups when you first create your helpdesk are "All Permissions" and "All Non-Destructive Permissions". The latter allows the agent to use most DeskPRO features, except ones which could cause you to lose information or otherwise be harmful (like sending mass replies).

To create a new permission group, click the **Add** button.

In the **Properties** tab, enter a **Group Name**. Then click on the **Permissions** tab and set permissions as for an individual agent. You can also set [department permissions](#) for the group.

Agents can belong to more than one permission group. If an action is allowed by *any* of an agent's groups, the agent can do it.

You can either select permission groups for an agent from their **Properties** tab:



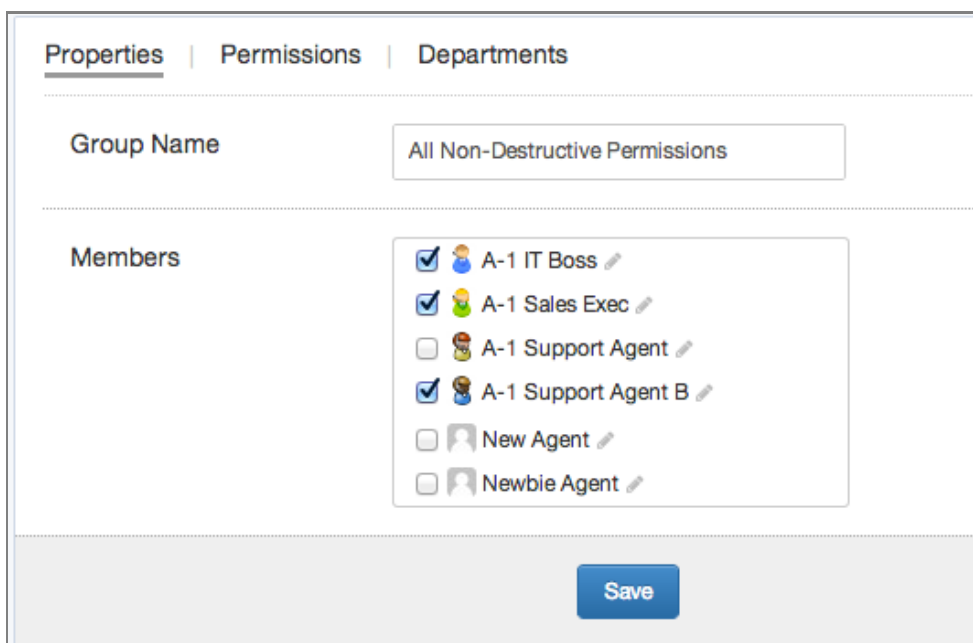
Permission Groups

- ☒ All Non-Destructive Permissions
- ☐ All Permissions
- ☐ Interns
- ☒ Sales
- ☒ Tech support

Switch to the **Permissions** tab to manage permission overrides.

Save

or add agents to a permission group from the group's **Properties**:



Properties | Permissions | Departments

Group Name: All Non-Destructive Permissions

Members

- ☒ A-1 IT Boss
- ☒ A-1 Sales Exec
- ☐ A-1 Support Agent
- ☒ A-1 Support Agent B
- ☐ New Agent
- ☐ Newbie Agent

Save

Permission overrides

You can combine individual permission settings and permission groups.

For example, this agent is a member of "All Non-Destructive Permissions".

Properties | Permissions | Departments | Ticket Notifications | Other Notifications

Permission groups are pre-defined sets of permissions you can easily apply to multiple agents.
Select the permission groups to apply to this agent:

☒ All Non-Destructive Permissions
☐ All Permissions
☐ Interns
☐ Sales
☐ Tech support

Tickets | People | Chat | Publish | Profile

Can use the ticket system	
Can create new tickets	
Can mass-reply to tickets	
Can unarchive tickets	
Can reply to owned and team tickets	

Suppose you need to grant the agent permission to mass-reply to tickets.

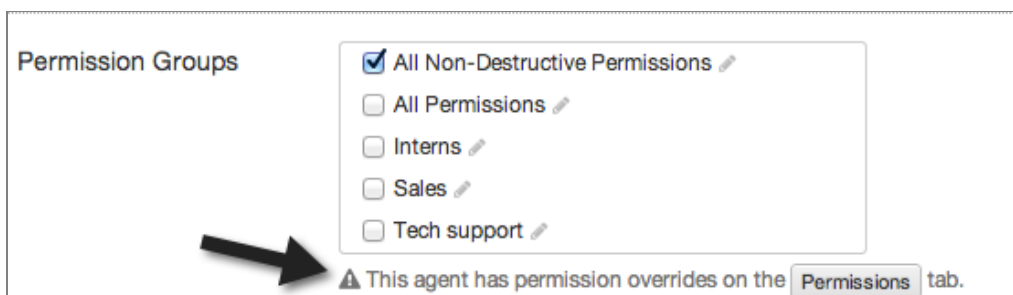
You can just click the **Can mass-reply to tickets** toggle to add that permission.

There are permission overrides set on this agent. Manage permission overrides below. [Click here to remove overrides](#)

Tickets | People | Chat | Publish | Profile

Can use the ticket system	
Can create new tickets	
Can mass-reply to tickets	
Can unarchive tickets	
Can reply to owned and team tickets	

A permission that's not granted through a permission group is considered an **override**. To make it easier to work out which agents have which permissions, DeskPRO alerts you if there are overrides, both in the agent's **Permissions** tab as you can see above, and in the agent **Properties** tab:



Note that you can't *remove* permissions which are granted by a permission group; this is indicated by the lock symbols on the other toggle controls.

Agent permissions are always additive - an agent only needs to be granted a permission by a single group or an override to be able to use it, even if none of their other groups include that permission.

Agent zones

In the **Properties** tab, you can also select what **zones** the agent can use.

Granting **admin** zone access means the agent is an admin and can use the admin interface. Note that there is no way to customize admin permissions; admin access is all or nothing.

For security reasons, DeskPRO Download admins can't reset their passwords from the web interface.

To reset an admin's password, use the command line to go to the folder where you installed DeskPRO, then run the following tool:

```
``cmd.php dp:agents --reset-password``
```

Granting **report** zone access enables the agent to use the Reports interface to view statistics and charts about your helpdesk's tickets, agents' performance, billing, etc.

Agent permissions for tickets and chats are also limited by departments: see the section on [Department Permissions](#) for details.

Admin access log

Admins have the power to lock out or delete other users, and make major changes to your helpdesk data that can't be undone.

You can view a log of all admin interactions with the helpdesk under **Agents > Audit Log**. This can be useful if you are trying to investigate an unexpected change to your helpdesk, or if you suspect that an admin account has been abused.

Agents	140	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	ts_agent_group:	UPDATE usergroups#1	2014-05-12 17:14:50
Teams	139	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	ts_agent_group: 1	UPDATE usergroups#1	2014-05-12 17:12:00
Permission Groups	138	Christopher Nadeau <chris.nadeau@deskpro.com>	permissions: REMOVE: Full for people#2 -- A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	UPDATE departments#2	2014-05-12 16:44:35
Audit Log	137	Christopher Nadeau <chris.nadeau@deskpro.com>	permissions: ADD: Full for usergroups#1 -- Everyone	UPDATE departments#1	2014-05-12 16:43:07
	136		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 16:42:36	UPDATE people#1	2014-05-12 16:42:36
	135	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#12	2014-05-12 15:26:53
	134	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		DELETE usergroups#11	2014-05-12 15:26:29
	133		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 15:10:06	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 15:10:06
	132	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#11	2014-05-12 15:05:41
	131	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	first_name: A1 last_name: Admin name: A1 Admin	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 13:58:39
	130		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 12:42:22	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 12:42:22
	129		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 12:31:17	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 12:31:17
	128		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 08:25:27	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 08:25:27
	127	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#10	2014-05-09 16:32:05
	126		date_last_login: 2014-05-09 15:31:02	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-09 15:31:02
	125		date_last_login: 2014-05-09 11:55:33	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-09 11:55:33
	124	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	title: Sales	UPDATE usergroups#6	2014-05-09 11:18:51
	123	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#9	2014-05-09 11:18:40
	122	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#8	2014-05-09 11:17:41
	121	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	title: Sales team	UPDATE usergroups#6	2014-05-09 11:16:15
	120	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		DELETE usergroups#7	2014-05-09 10:50:01
	119	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	permissions: ADD: Full for usergroups#7 -- VIP	UPDATE departments#1	2014-05-09 10:24:49
	118	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#7	2014-05-09 10:23:52
	117	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	parent: null	UPDATE departments#2	2014-05-09 10:06:05

10.2. Managing agents

To help monitor how your agents are using the helpdesk, you can view a **Login log** below the **Agents** list.

For more detailed information about agent activity, you can use the **Reports** interface, accessible from the chart icon at the lower left. DeskPRO's Reports system will be documented in a separate manual (forthcoming).

Satisfaction

To help measure agent performance, you can enable a **Satisfaction survey**.

This takes offers users the option to submit a brief rating and comment:

- when marking a ticket resolved through the user portal
- by going to a resolved ticket in the user portal
- after closing a chat

The image shows two overlapping user interface elements for feedback. The background is a 'Rate your support' form. It has a breadcrumb trail: 'Home → Your Tickets → Product csng vw1 iss'. The title is 'Rate your support'. Below it is a cartoon agent icon and the text 'Acme IT Boss helped you with your ticket "Product csng vw1 iss"'. The question is 'How would you rate the support you received?'. There are three rating buttons: 'It was great' with a green smiley face, 'It was OK' with a grey neutral face, and 'It was not good' with a red sad face. The 'It was OK' button is selected. Below the buttons is a text area for 'Optionally leave a comment' and a 'Submit feedback' button. Overlaid on the right is a 'Send us feedback' chat window. It has a title bar 'Open this chat in a new window'. The title is 'Send us feedback'. It contains two questions: 'Was our response time fast enough?' and 'Were you satisfied with this conversation?', both with 'Yes' radio buttons. There is a 'Comments?' text area. At the bottom are two buttons: 'Send Feedback & Close Window' and 'No thanks, just close the window'.

You can access satisfaction data through the **Reports** interface.

10.3. User permissions

Usergroups determine what permissions users have. Usergroup membership grants user permissions, much like belonging to an agent permission group does for agents. Unlike with agents, there is no way to set permissions for an individual user.

Users can belong to multiple usergroups, and, as with agent permissions, the effect is additive; a user has all permissions that are granted by any of their usergroups.

You may want users who aren't logged in (**guests**) to be able to access some portal content. There is a special **Everyone** usergroup which grants permissions to guests. All the permissions you grant to **Everyone** will be available to every other usergroup.

You can edit usergroups from **Users > Permission Groups**

The special **Registered** usergroup grants permissions to all registered users. Every usergroup (apart from **Everyone**) will have the permissions you grant to **Registered**.

Another way to think about this is that **Registered** inherits all the permissions from **Everyone**, and your custom groups inherit all permissions from **Registered**. Permissions that are inherited are marked with a padlock, and can't be changed.

You can grant extra permissions on top of inherited permissions, but you can't take permissions away. For example, suppose you want to make a "Basic Users" usergroup which can't access chat. You must remove chat access from **Everyone** and **Registered**, and make sure that users in "Basic Users" aren't members of other usergroups which grant chat access.

For each portal function, you can enable/disable access for the usergroup entirely.

Note that this is distinct from using the Portal Editor to enable/disable sections altogether. If you disable access to a portal section for the **Everyone** usergroup, it won't be seen by any users, but it will still be visible to agents.

For each section, you can enable/disable a usergroup's ability to rate content and submit content visible to other users, such as comments and feedback items.

For permissions that involve user-visible content, you can also choose whether or not to require agent validation. This means that agents have to approve content to check it is not abusive, spam etc.

Incoming comments and feedback in need of approval will be shown under **Comments to Review** and **Feedback** in the agent interface:

PUBLISH	SEARCH	FEEDBACK	SEARCH
PENDING Comments to Review 1 Pending Articles 6 My Drafts 4 All Drafts 4		PENDING Feedback to Validate 3 Comments to Review 4	

10.4. User registration and authentication

User registration settings govern how users create new accounts. This includes details like how the helpdesk checks that the supplied email address really belongs to the user, and your user password policy.

These settings interact with the user permissions system which determine what users (and unregistered guests) can do. Some of the registration settings override certain aspects of the permission system.

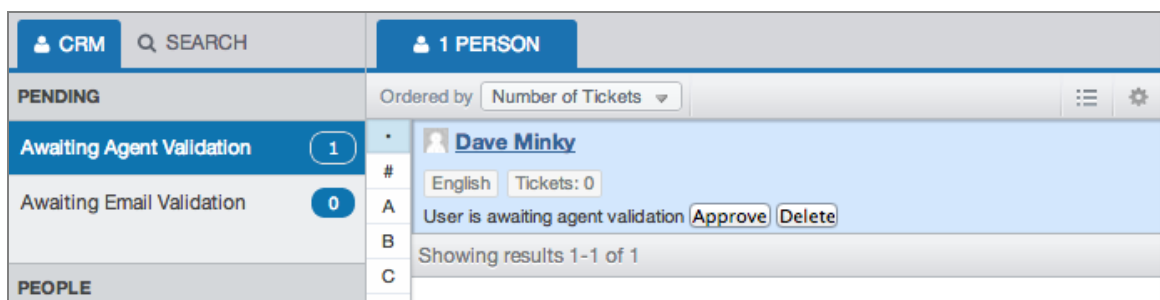
You can install **authentication apps** to let users or agents log in with credentials other than a DeskPRO account.

User registration settings

Go to **CRM > Registration** to change the helpdesk's settings for user registration and email validation.

The **Enable/Disable Registration** setting controls the ability for users to sign up for an account via the web portal. If you **disable registration**, agents must manually create an account for every user. Tickets submitted by email will only be accepted if the email From: address is already registered as a user's email address. Disabling registration gives you more control over who can access the helpdesk, at the expense of more time spent creating user accounts.

- **Require registration** hides any forms that a user can use to submit content: **Contact Us**, feedback and comments. If you enable this, even if the **Everyone** usergroup has the right permissions to submit content, the portal will not allow it.
- **Enable email validation for new registrations from the web portal** means that users who sign up for an account on your helpdesk must prove they own the associated email address before their account will work. This is done by sending a validation email with a special link that the user must click.
- **Enable email validation for new users submitting tickets from web** if this is not enabled, users can submit a ticket and provide any email address, even if it is not one they control; if it is enabled, the user must prove they own the email address by clicking a link in a validation email. Until the address is validated, the ticket is held in the **Awaiting Validation** filter in the agent interface. This option is useful if bots are submitting spam messages to your contact form. It also makes sure users have not made a mistake when entering their address.
- **Enable email validation for new users submitting tickets from email** it is easy for spammers to send email with a fake From: address. If this option is enabled, the user must prove their From: address is valid by clicking a link in a validation email. This option can help to prevent incoming spam email being turned into tickets.
- **Enable manual agent validation** means that your agents must approve every new account. Accounts that need approval will show up in the agent interface CRM app in the **Awaiting Agent Validation** filter:



While users are awaiting validation, they can still submit content, but it won't be shown on the portal until they are validated.

Restricting access to part of the portal

Note that requiring registration applies to *every* part of the helpdesk. What if you want some sections of the helpdesk to be public and others to be locked down? For example, you want ticket submission to be available to approved users only, but want to accept feedback from anyone without making them log in.

You can't apply the **Enable manual agent validation** setting just to Tickets, but the same effect can be implemented with the right combination of registration settings and [usergroups](#).

To implement the example, you'd check **Enable Registration** and uncheck **Require Registration**. You would need to keep the Everyone usergroup enabled, since that grants permissions for users who aren't logged in.

Then in **CRM > Permission Groups** you'd set the Everyone group to have permission to use Feedback, but not Tickets. You don't want every registered user to be able to submit tickets, just ones you approve, so you would also remove Tickets permission from Registered and any other existing usergroups.

You would then create a new "Approved" usergroup with permission to use tickets. Users added to "Approved" can use the ticket system as normal, while other users can't see even see the **Contact Us** section of the portal.

Password policy

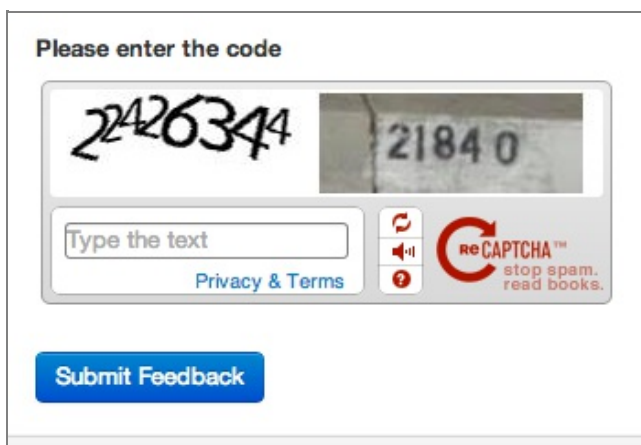
Go to **CRM > Password Settings** to set the requirements for creating account passwords. You can set separate requirements for agents and users.

Note that if you are using DeskPRO Download, agents with admin interface access need to use a special tool to reset their passwords.

CAPTCHAs

You can enable CAPTCHA tests on the portal. These require users to recognize text or audio to check that you are receiving input from a human user and not an automatic spam-posting program.

DeskPRO uses the [reCAPTCHA](#) system.



Go to **Portal > Settings** to enable CAPTCHAs. You can have CAPTHCAs:

- for user registration
- for new feedback items and comments

If you require CAPTCHAs for feedback and comments, you can choose whether even registered users need to pass a test for each comment.

Authentication apps

You can install **authentication apps** to enable users and agents to sign on with credentials from outside DeskPRO, instead of needing to create a DeskPRO account.

For example, you can allow agents to use their existing login information on your network, or allow users to sign in with their Facebook accounts.

See the section on [Extending DeskPRO](#) for more details.

11. Automating the Helpdesk

DeskPRO provides a number of ways to automatically process tickets. You can use these to have the helpdesk carry out routine procedures, leaving your agents with more time to focus on helping users. You can also set automatic rules to bring tickets to the attention of agents and help them identify urgent tickets.

- **SLAs** track your helpdesk's response time goals, and can perform actions on tickets when a goal is failed or close to failing.
- **Triggers** run actions when a ticket is created, replied to or updated. DeskPRO's built-in processes, such as sending out agent notifications and validating user email addresses, are controlled by triggers, and you can edit them to change how they behave.
- **Escalations** run actions on tickets based on the elapsed time the ticket has been in a certain state.
- **Macros** carry out a series of actions on a ticket when applied by an agent, automating repetitive tasks. Agents can create their own macros without admin access (unlike SLAs, triggers and escalations).

11.1. SLAs

SLAs (Service Level Agreements) enable you to set goals for ticket response time. These goals might represent an actual SLA with a client who is paying for support, or just an internal quality standard.

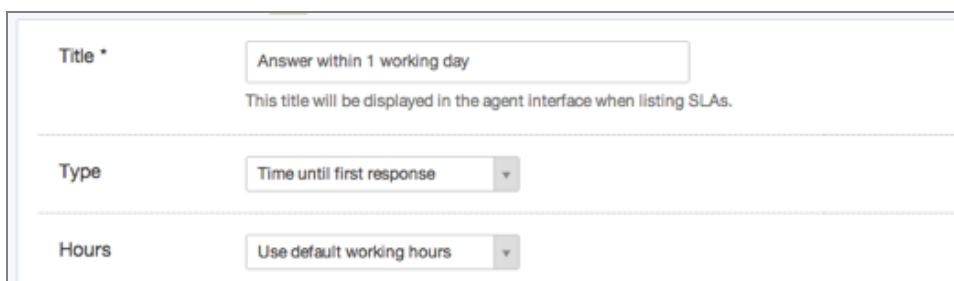
Tickets that are close to failing the goal (you define what is considered 'close') enter a **warning** condition, and tickets that exceed the goal have **failed**.

There are two effects of SLAs:

- 1 Tickets close to or failing an SLA are highlighted to agents: tickets on warning are edged amber, tickets that have failed are edged red.
- 2 SLAs can run automatic **actions** to modify the ticket on warning or failure.

Creating an SLA

Create a new SLA by going to **Tickets > SLAs** and clicking **Add**.



Title *	Answer within 1 working day
This title will be displayed in the agent interface when listing SLAs.	
Type	Time until first response ▼
Hours	Use default working hours ▼

Set **Type** to decide whether the SLA tracks:

- time until first response
- time until ticket is resolved
- user waiting time until ticket resolution (total)

You can use **Hours** to set whether time should be counted **24x7** (continuously), during default working hours (as defined in **Tickets > Settings > Default Working Hours**), or during custom hours that you define.

For example, suppose your helpdesk's default working hours are set as 9am to 6pm Monday to Friday, and you have an SLA that requires you to make a first response within 8 hours. A ticket arrives at 5pm on Monday and doesn't get answered. If you have set **Hours** as **24x7**, the elapsed time will be counted all night, and the ticket will fail the SLA 8 hours later at 1am. But if you set the SLA to count **Default Working Hours**, elapsed time will only be counted until 6pm. Then the clock will stop until 9am the next day, when the remaining 7 hours will start counting down again.

The screenshot shows two configuration sections: 'SLA Warning' and 'SLA Failure'.

SLA Warning: A dropdown menu is set to '6' hours. Below it, a 'then' block titled 'The followings actions will run:' contains two actions: 'Set Urgency' with 'Increase urgency by' set to '4', and 'Set Assigned Team' set to '2nd Level Support'. A green '+ Action' button is at the bottom.

SLA Failure: A dropdown menu is set to '8' hours. Below it, a 'then' block titled 'The followings actions will run:' contains two actions: 'Set Urgency' with 'Set urgency to' set to '9' and a checked checkbox 'Only set if urgency is lower', and 'Set Assigned Team' set to 'Support Managers'. A green '+ Action' button is at the bottom.

Define an **SLA Warning** time (when the ticket is considered close to failing) and a **SLA Failure** time.

Note the value you enter in SLA Failure is the total time elapsed on the ticket, *not* the time since warning.

You can define actions that run automatically at warning and at failure. For example, you might want to increase the **urgency** of a ticket that is about to fail an SLA, or assign the ticket to a more experienced team.

Click the + **Action** button under **SLA Warning** or **SLA Failure** to add **actions** that will run on warning.

The screenshot shows the 'SLA Application' section with a dropdown menu set to 'Apply to all tickets'. A blue 'Save' button is located at the bottom right.

Use **SLA Application** to set which tickets are affected by the SLA:

- **Apply to all tickets:** this applies the SLA to all tickets created *from now on* (not existing tickets)
- **Agents manually apply the SLA:** agents apply the SLA from the **SLAS** tab of the ticket
- **Apply to new tickets that match certain criteria:** you can enter conditions that tickets must meet for the SLA to apply.

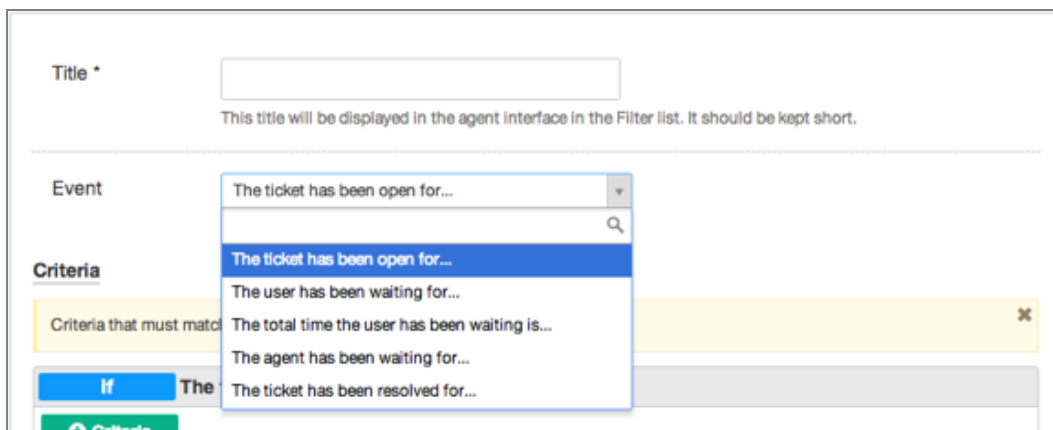
Click **Save** to store the SLA.

11.2. Ticket escalations

Ticket escalations run actions once a ticket has spent a set amount off time in a certain state. They are useful to ensure that tickets don't spend too long without attention from agents. For example, you can use escalations to increase the urgency of older tickets, or to automatically assign tickets that have gone unresolved for too long to a second level support team.

Create escalations from **Tickets > Escalations**.

When you create an escalation, you define what state a ticket must be in for elapsed time to count:



- **time the ticket has been open for** total time the ticket has existed without being resolved
- **time the user has been waiting** how long the ticket has been "awaiting agent", continuously since the most recent status change i.e. if the status is changed from "awaiting agent" and then back again, the clock resets
- **total time the user has been waiting** *cumulative* time the ticket has been **awaiting agent** over its whole life
- **time the agent has been waiting** how long the ticket has been "awaiting user", continuously; again, this resets if the status changes
- how long **the ticket has been resolved for** i.e. time elapsed since the ticket was resolved; this is useful if you want to delete older tickets or assign to a quality control team

You also define how long the ticket must spend in that state for the escalation to apply.

You can also set extra **criteria** that the ticket must meet for the escalation to run. For example, if you specify a department, the escalation will apply only to tickets in that department.

Criteria

Criteria that must match for the escalation to apply to a ticket.

if The following conditions are met:

Ticket Criteria

Status
Department
Agent
Agent Team
Product
Category
Priority

You then define the actions that run when the ticket has run up the correct elapsed time and meets any criteria.

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

Set Assigned Agent	A-1 IT Boss	
then Set Priority	Urgent	
then Set Flag	Red	

+ Action

Save

11.3. Ticket triggers

Triggers are automatic processes that can perform **actions** in response to ticket events.

Before a trigger runs, it checks its **criteria**. The trigger's actions will only run when the criteria are met.

There are three types of triggers which respond to different types of event:

- **New Ticket** - checked when a new ticket is created
- **New Reply** - checked when an agent/user replies to a ticket
- **Ticket Update** - checked when a ticket property changes

Simple triggers

DeskPRO has built-in **simple triggers** with fixed criteria:

- **Email Account triggers:** each account you have configured to receive tickets has a simple trigger which runs when a user creates a new ticket via email.

These triggers provide a simple way to link your email accounts to departments (by automatically assigning all new tickets submitted via the email account to the specified department). They are also used to send the default auto-response emails.

You can view and edit the simple Email Account triggers from ****Tickets > Email Accounts**** as well as ****Tickets > Triggers****.

- **Department Triggers:** each department on your helpdesk has a simple trigger which runs when a user submits a ticket via the web: either through the portal, or an embedded form or widget.

"Support" Department Trigger

This is a department trigger. It will apply when a user submits a new ticket from the web interface and selects this department.

Criteria

when The following conditions are met:

- if** Department is "Support"
- and** Ticket is created by a user from the web interface

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

- ☒ Set Email Account
- ☐ Send User Email

+ Action

You can view and edit the simple Department triggers from **Tickets > Departments** as well as **Tickets > Triggers**.

These triggers provide a simple way to link a department to an email account, for example, if you want tickets submitted through the portal to the Sales department to be answered from your sales@ account.

Advanced triggers

Advanced triggers are more powerful than simple triggers, since you can customize their criteria as well as filtering which events they respond to.

If you want a more complicated configuration than the straightforward cases that simple triggers are designed for, you'll need to use advanced triggers.

When you set up an advanced trigger, don't forget to change any simple triggers that would do the same thing. For example, suppose you set up an advanced new ticket trigger for your sales@ account which sends different auto-replies based on whether the user is new or registered. If you leave the simple **Email Account Trigger** for sales@ unchanged, users will get two auto-reply emails.

To create a new trigger, go to **Tickets > Triggers** then either **> New Ticket**, **> New Reply** or **> Ticket Update**, depending on the type of trigger you want to make.

- 1 Specify a **Title** for the trigger that describes what it does.
- 2 You can further refine when a trigger runs using the **Event** section. You can choose to have the trigger checked only in response to changes by users or agents, and only in response to changes from some of the possible interfaces - web, email or API ("API" means created automatically by other software that's been integrated with DeskPRO).

For example, you have a "new ticket" trigger that is checked only when the ticket was created by a user via email:

Click the gear icon next to **By a user > via the web** to further refine which web interfaces cause the trigger to be checked.

- **Portal** means the user web portal
- **Widget** means the Feedback and Support Tab widget (see under **Portal > Embed**)
- **Ticket form** means the embeddable Contact Form (see under **Portal > Embed**)

3

Set **criteria** which a ticket must meet before the trigger runs. These can be properties of the email, ticket, attachments, user, user's organization or the current time.

Criteria

The criteria section is a list of terms that must match before the actions are applied to the ticket.

or The following conditions are met:

User is new

Criteria

or The following conditions are met:

Department is Sales

Criteria

4

Set the **actions** which the trigger will run. Actions can be used to notify agents and users, or change the state of a ticket, or even trigger an API call to a web-based service.

Actions

These actions will apply when all of the criteria pass.

then The followings actions will run:

then Set Assigned Agent A-1 Sales Exec

Action

See the [Actions guide](#) section for full details of the available actions.

Trigger order

The triggers are checked in the order they are listed, with the top trigger first. You can drag triggers by the handles at the left to change the order.

9 Triggers

Enable email validation	☒
Check email validation	☒
Check agent validation	☒
2 Department Triggers	☒
1 Email Account Trigger	☒

In the example above, the **Enable email validation** trigger would run, then **Check email validation**, then **Check agent validation**, and so on.

Note that triggers can use the **Trigger control** actions to affect the normal flow of actions.

For example, if the user is awaiting email validation, **Check email validation** runs the **Stop processing triggers** action, which would stop any triggers lower down from running.

The **Trigger control** actions available are:

- Stop processing triggers
- Prevent emails to user
- Prevent emails to agents

Triggers example: assigning out-of-hours tickets to a special team

Suppose you want to treat incoming tickets differently outside working hours. For example, assigning them to a night shift team who you know will be checking their email.

This is easy to accomplish with triggers:

The screenshot shows the configuration for a new trigger in DeskPRO. The 'Title' field is set to 'New out-of-hours tickets to night shift'. Below the title, a note states: 'This title will be used throughout the admin interface to refer to this trigger.'

The 'Event' section is titled 'When a new ticket is created'. It has two columns of options. The first column, 'By a user', has four checked options: 'via the web', 'via email', and 'via the API'. The second column, 'By an agent', has four checked options: 'via the agent interface', 'via email', and 'via the API'.

The 'Criteria' section is titled 'Criteria'. It has two sections. The first section, 'when', has a dropdown menu set to 'Is outside of working hours' and two radio buttons: 'Default working hours' (selected) and 'Set custom working hours'. Below this is a green button labeled '+ Criteria'. The second section, 'or', has a green button labeled '+ Criteria'.

The 'Actions' section is titled 'Actions'. It has a section 'then' with a dropdown menu set to 'Set Assigned Team' and a dropdown menu set to 'Night Shift'. Below this is a green button labeled '+ Action'.

Note that the working hours here are taken from the **Default Working Hours** in **Tickets > Settings** - but you could specify custom hours just for this trigger.

You'd probably want to send out-of-hours replies from users to the same team:

The screenshot shows the configuration interface for a trigger in DeskPRO. It is divided into three main sections: Title, Event, and Criteria/Actions.

Title *
Out-of-hours replies
This title will be used throughout the admin interface to refer to this trigger.

Event
When a new reply is submitted
☒ By a user ☐ By an agent
- ☒ via the web ☐ via email
- ☒ via the API

Criteria ?
when The following conditions are met:
Is outside of working hours
☒ Default working hours ☐ Set custom working hours
+ Criteria
or The following conditions are met:
+ Criteria

Actions ?
then The followings actions will run:
Set Assigned Team
+ Action

Triggers example: tickets from organization managers are more urgent

If your agents are using the CRM app to record which users are managers of their organizations, you could use this information to increase the urgency of managers' tickets:

Title *

RHIP

This title will be used throughout the admin interface to refer to this trigger.

Event

When a new ticket is created

☒ By a user

☒ By an agent

☒ via the web

☒ via the agent interface

☒ via email

☒ via email

☒ via the API

☒ via the API

Criteria ?

when

The following conditions are met:

Is manager of organization

Criteria

or

The following conditions are met:

Usergroup is VIPs

Criteria

Actions ?

then

The followings actions will run:

Set Priority Urgent

Set Urgency Increase urgency by 5

Action

Save

Triggers example: automatically assign tickets to agents they reply to via email

If your agents reply to tickets from their mail client, they will not be assigned to the tickets they answer. You can automatically assign each ticket to whoever is answering it with this trigger:

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Title *

Assign agent to ticket if replies via email

This title will be used throughout the admin interface to refer to this trigger.

Event

When a new reply is submitted

☐ By a user

☒ By an agent

☐ via the agent interface

☒ via email

☐ via the API

Criteria ?

when

The following conditions are met:

Agent

is

✖ Unassigned

Criteria

Actions ?

then

The followings actions will run:

Set Assigned Agent

Current Agent

Action

Triggers example: emailing users when their ticket is assigned

You can use triggers to send an email to the user when their ticket is assigned (e.g. to reassure them that their problem has come to the attention of a real person).

Here's how you could implement this:

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- 1 Create a new trigger, and set the Event to be When a property on a ticket is changed/By an agent
- 2 You probably don't want the user to get a notification if their ticket was assigned and replied to at the same time, so deselect **Also run when properties have changed during a reply**.
- 3 Add the Criteria: **Agent / changed from/ Unassigned**
- 4 Add the Action: **Send User Email > Create new template** An editor opens where you define the email template.

Here's an example template:

Subject:

RE: {{ ticket.subject }}

Body:

{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}

Your ticket has been assigned to {{ ticket.agent.display_name }}.

{{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_access_ticket_online') }}
{{ ticket.link }}
- 5 Save the template and trigger. Make the trigger active with the toggle control next to its name.

Note that this trigger doesn't run when the assigned agent changes, only when the ticket moves from unassigned to assigned. So in most cases, the user would only get the custom email once. But there is a flaw in the trigger: it will also run if the ticket is moved back to unassigned, then assigned to an agent again.

You could refine this trigger so that it only runs the first time the ticket is assigned. One way to implement this would be by using a custom "Has been assigned" agent-only toggle field, which starts out as unchecked. Add an action to set the field as checked when the trigger runs. Then add to the criteria of the trigger a check that 'Has been assigned' is false. This ensures that the trigger can only run once (unless agents edit the custom field.).

Title *

This title will be used throughout the admin interface to refer to this trigger.

Event ☐ When a property on a ticket is changed

☐ By a user

☒ By an agent

- ☒ via the agent interface
- ☒ via email
- ☒ via the API

Options ☐ Also run when properties have changed during a reply

When this option is enabled, this trigger will run if an agent has made updates at the same time as replying. ?

Criteria ?

when The following conditions are met:

Agent changed from

Has been assigned is not

Criteria

Actions ?

then The followings actions will run:

Send User Email

Template:

Include CC's: ☐ CC in all additional user participants.

From Name:

From Email:

Has been assigned Yes

Action

Triggers example: sending a different auto-reply to new users

Suppose the sales team want to customize the email auto-response when tickets are submitted to the Sales department. They want to send existing users the normal response, but they want new users to get a more elaborate welcome email explaining your product range.

We'll assume you start out with your `sales@` account linked to the Sales department with simple **new ticket** triggers, configured to send the the default auto-response.

This **Email Account Trigger** sets tickets sent via the `sales@` account to the Sales department, then sends the auto-response.

6 Triggers

- Enable email validation ☒
- Check email validation ☒
- Check agent validation ☒
- 1 Email Account Trigger** ☒

Use these triggers if you want to perform actions based on the email address a user sends a new ticket to.

sales@a1corp.example

- 2 Department Triggers** ☒
- Send agent notifications ☒
- Send user new ticket by agent ☒
- Assign self when replying by email ☒

+ Add

"sales@a1corp.example" Email Account Trigger

This is a email account trigger. It will apply when a user submits a new ticket by sending an email to this email address.

Criteria

when The following conditions are met:

if The user created a new ticket by emailing "sales@a1corp.example"

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

☒ Set Department

☒ Send User Email

Template:

Include CC's: ☐ CC in all additional user participants.

From Name:

From Email:

Action

This **Department Trigger** sets tickets submitted via the web where the user has selected the Sales department to the `sales@` email account, then sends the auto-response.

The screenshot shows the '6 Triggers' section on the left sidebar. The '2 Department Triggers' item is selected. The main panel displays the configuration for the '"Sales" Department Trigger'. It includes a description: 'This is a department trigger. It will apply when a user submits a new ticket from the web interface and selects'. The 'Criteria' section shows two conditions: 'when' (The following conditions are met: 'if' Department is "Sales", 'and' Ticket is created by a user from the web interface). The 'Actions' section shows two actions: 'then' (The followings actions will run: 'Set Email Account' to sales@a1corp.example, 'Send User Email' with Template 'New Ticket Auto-Response', Include CC's 'CC in all additional user participants', From Name 'Site Name (A1 Inc)', and From Email 'The account set on the ticket').

The simple triggers can't do what the sales team wants, because their criteria are fixed, so there's no way to specify that you only want to do something to new users.

Instead, you would create a new trigger:

The screenshot shows the configuration for a new trigger titled 'Welcome email to new users'. The 'Event' section is set to 'When a new ticket is created'. The 'By a user' checkbox is checked, and the 'By an agent' checkbox is unchecked. Under 'By a user', the 'via the web' and 'via email' checkboxes are checked, and the 'via the API' checkbox is unchecked.

This trigger is checked when a user or agent submits a ticket via email or web. (We'll assume that you don't want to send acknowledgements for tickets created using the API).

The criteria you would use are:

The screenshot shows the 'Criteria' section for the new trigger. It includes a 'when' button and the text 'The following conditions are met:'. The criteria are: 'Department is Sales' and 'User is new'. There are 'x' buttons to remove each condition. A green 'Criteria' button is at the bottom.

That means the new trigger will only run its actions when the department is Sales, and the user is new. We're going to rely on the **Email Account Trigger** to set the department to Sales. Make sure the new trigger is below the simple triggers.

The action you want to run is sending a custom email. You would create a custom email template (see the chapter on [Editing Templates](#) for details), then run it like this:

Actions ?

then The followings actions will run:

Send User Email

Template: new-user-sales-welcome.html

Include CC's: ☐ CC in all additional user participants.

From Name: Site Name (A1 Inc)

From Email: The account set on the ticket

+ Action

You don't want users receiving more than one auto-response email when they submit a new ticket. So you would disable the **Send User Email** action for the simple triggers:

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

☒ Set Email Account sales@a1corp.example

☐ Send User Email

+ Action

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

☒ Set Department Sales

☐ Send User Email

+ Action

We're almost done. But we want users who don't receive the custom email to receive the default auto-response email. Since the simple triggers aren't sending that any more, we need another new trigger to do the job.

We could try to set up a complicated set of Criteria so that the new trigger runs if the user is not new and the department is Sales, or the department is anything else, but there's a simpler way. We can just put in a check to see if the custom email has already been sent, and make sure the default auto-response trigger is below the one that sends the custom response.

Criteria ?

when The following conditions are met:

The user has NOT been emailed ☒ a specific email template new-user-sales-welcome.html

+ Criteria

Actions

These actions will apply when all of the criteria pass.

then The followings actions will run:

Send User Email	Template:	New Ticket Auto-Response
	Include CC's:	☐ CC in all additional user participants.
	From Name:	Site Name (A1 Inc)
	From Email:	The account set on the ticket

+ Action

Here's the completed triggers in the right order:

2 Department Triggers	☒
1 Email Account Trigger	☒
Welcome email to new users	☒
Send default auto-response	☒

Triggers for built-in processes

Many of the built-in processes of the helpdesk, such as sending email notifications to agents or user email validation, are controlled by triggers you can edit.

The triggers which control these built-in processes are:

New ticket:

- Enable/check email validation
- Check agent validation
- Replying by email assigns to that agent
- Agent notifications
- Auto-reply confirmation
- Notify user about new ticket by agent

New reply:

- Send agent notifications
- Send auto-reply confirmation to user
- Send user new reply from agent

Ticket update:

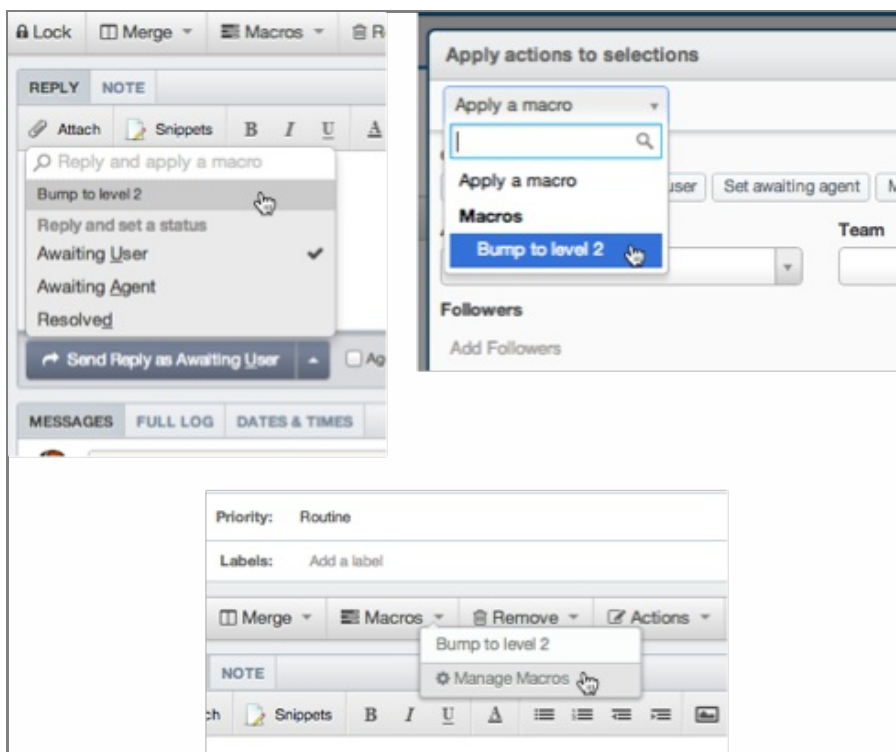
- Send agent notifications

11.4. Macros

Macros are stored sequences of actions which agents can apply from the agent interface. Macros are designed to automate sequences of steps that agents often have to repeat. An agent can apply a macro to a ticket with a couple of clicks. Using macros to perform commonly-repeated sequences of actions helps agents work more efficiently.

When a macro runs, the actions it contains are applied to the ticket it is run on.

Agents can apply macros from the content pane using the **Macros** button or the **Send Reply** control. They can also apply macros as a mass action from the list pane.



Macros can be shared (available to everyone), or limited to a specific agent. Note that if an agent tries to run a shared macro but lacks the permissions to run all its actions, the macro will not run.

Agents can create macros in the **Preferences** area of the agent interface. You can create macros from **Tickets > Macros**, where you can also edit agent macros.

To create a macro:

- 1 Enter a descriptive **Title** that makes clear to agents what the macro does.
- 2 Select a **Permission** level; the macro can either be shared or limited to a specific agent.
- 3 Click the **+ Action** button and select an action.
- 4 Keep adding actions until the macro is complete.
- 5 Click **Save**.

11.5. Using urgency to prioritize tickets

A common use of automation is to set the **urgency** score on tickets, to help agents decide which ones to deal with first.

Urgency is a score from 1 to 10. For a newly created ticket, it defaults to 1.

Actions can be used to increase or decrease urgency by a certain amount, instead of setting it to a particular value. This allows a number of different automated rules to be applied to a ticket, giving a combined urgency which reflects competing considerations.



For example, suppose your enterprise needs to encourage agents to prioritize tickets from the VIP usergroup, and to prioritize their support tickets over sales tickets.

You could set a triggers to increase the urgency for new tickets from the "VIP" usergroup by 6, and a second trigger running afterwards to decrease the urgency for new tickets in the "Sales" department by 3.

A new "Support" ticket from a VIP would start with urgency 1, get 6 urgency from the first trigger, for an overall urgency of 7.

A new "Sales" ticket from a VIP user would start with urgency 1, get +6 from the first trigger, then -3 from the second trigger, for an overall urgency of 4.

Urgency can never go below 1 or above 10. If an action would decrease a ticket's urgency to below 1 or above 10, it will be set to 1 or 10 respectively.

You can view the distribution of **urgency** values for your current unresolved tickets under **Tickets > Urgency**.



11.6. Actions guide

This section is a complete guide to the actions you can use in triggers, SLAs, escalations and macros.

Ticket Assignment

- **Set Assigned Agent:**
 - assign the ticket to an agent you specify, or
 - **Unassign** the ticket, or
 - assign to **Current agent** (the agent who activated the trigger - if the trigger was activated by a user, this action will be ignored)
 - **Set Assigned Team:**
 - assign the ticket to a team you specify, or
 - assign the ticket to **No Team**, or
 - assign to the **the Current Agent's Team** (the agent who activated the trigger - if the trigger was activated by a user, this action will be ignored)
 - **Set Agent Followers:**
 - add an agent you specify as a follower

Ticket Properties

- **Set Status:** set the ticket status from the built-in statuses
- **Set Department:** set the ticket's department
- **Set Product:** set the ticket's product
- **Set Category:** set the ticket's category
- **Set Priority:** set the ticket's priority
- **Set Workflow:** set the ticket's workflow
- **Set Urgency:**
 - **increase urgency** by an amount you specify
 - **decrease urgency** by an amount you specify
 - **set urgency** to a specified value
- **Set Subject:** set the ticket title to the specified value
- **Set Labels:** apply the specified labels to the ticket (specify them in a comma-separated list)
- **Set Flag:** apply the specified flag color to the ticket
- **Set Email Account:** set which ticket email account will send messages related to this ticket
- **Set CC'd Users:** enter user email addresses to CC:

Ticket SLAs

- **Set SLAs:** specify SLAs to apply or remove from the ticket
- **Set SLA Condition Status:** set whether the ticket is passing or failing any SLAs applied (regardless of elapsed time)
- **Set SLA State:** set whether the ticket is waiting or finished on any SLAs applied

Ticket Actions

- **Set Ticket User:** set the user associated with the ticket
- **Delete Ticket:** delete the ticket
- **Require User Email Validation:** set the ticket status to "awaiting validation" and send the user a link to confirm their email address
- **Call Web Hook:** send an HTTP request to a web service; see the section on [Calling web hooks from actions](#)

Trigger Control

- **Stop Processing Triggers:** don't run actions from future triggers (and SLAs/escalations) for this ticket; note that any actions below this one in the current trigger/SLA/escalation/macro will still run
- **Prevent Emails to User:** future actions which would result in sending an email to users about this ticket are ignored
- **Prevent Emails to Agents:** future actions which would result in sending an email to agents about this ticket are ignored

Custom Ticket Fields

- set values for any custom fields you have created

Custom Person (user) Fields

- set values for any custom user fields you have created

12. Chat

DeskPRO offers IM-style live chat to allow users to message your agents. Users can access chat from your portal or from a chat widget which you can embed into your website.

Use **Chat > Setup** to enable or disable the chat system altogether. This page also provides the code for embedding the chat widget - see the section on [Website integration](#) for details.

Note that by default, the chat widget (either on the portal or embedded) won't appear unless there is at least one agent signed into chat from the agent interface.

You can have chat **departments** which work much like ticket departments (although they are a separate system - i.e. creating a ticket department will not create a corresponding chat department). Manage them under **Chat > Departments**. You can use usergroups and agent permission groups to limit chat access by department. See the chapter on [Departments](#) for more details.

You can customize the information stored for a chat session using custom chat **fields**, under **Chat > Fields**. These work much like custom ticket fields.

You can also manage the **labels** that agents have applied to chats under **Chat > Labels**.

13. Editing Templates

The most powerful way to customize the user-facing content of your helpdesk is to use DeskPRO's **template** system.

You can edit templates to change:

- the content of automatic notification emails
- the portal design and interface text

You can also add custom email templates.

Templates can include **phrases**: short, re-usable pieces of text, used to store something like the user greeting at the beginning of an email, or the name of a section of the portal.

A major advantage of storing text using phrases is that you can include the same phrase in many templates. DeskPRO's multi-language support is also based around phrases.

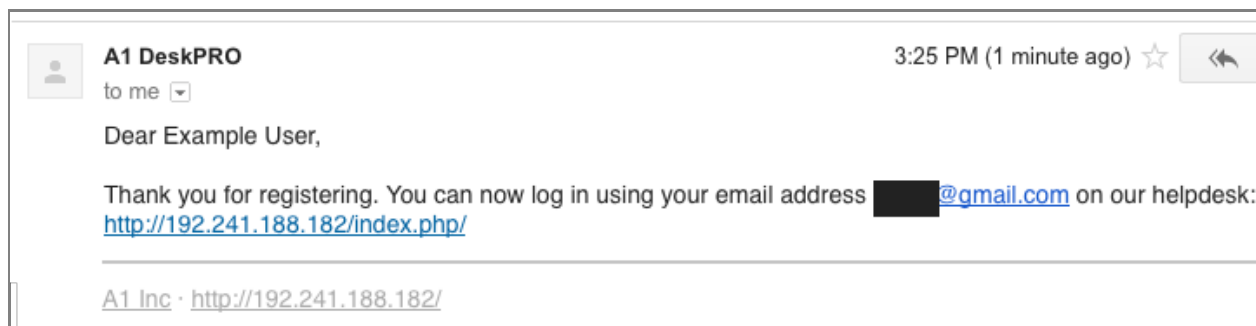
You can also access **variables** from a template, enabling you to retrieve information about the user who is logged in, the ticket they're currently viewing, etc., and display that back to the user.

You'll need a basic understanding of HTML to edit templates. If you want to customize the portal design, you'll need a more advanced knowledge of HTML/CSS.

13.1. Introducing templates

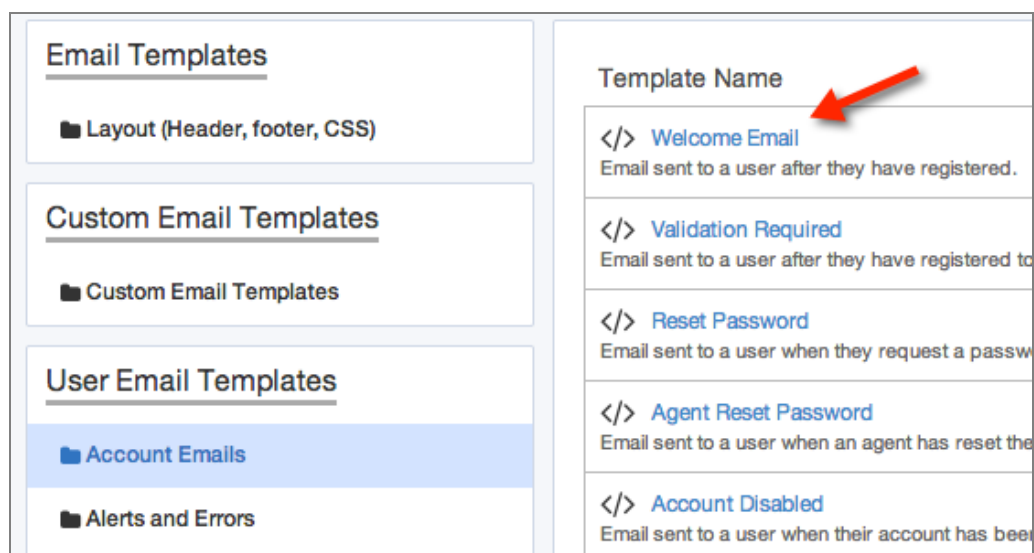
Here's an example of how to customize helpdesk content by editing a template and using phrases and variables.

Suppose you decide you want to edit the content of the automatic email users receive when they register an account. By default the email looks something like this:



As you'd expect, "Example User" is automatically replaced with the name of the user who's receiving the email. We'll see how this happens later.

Go to **Tickets > Email Templates** to find the corresponding template. Look under **User Email Templates** and you will see the **Welcome Email** template.



Click on the template to open the template editor window.

Welcome Email

Email sent to a user after they have registered.

Email Subject:

`{{ phrase('user.email_subjects.register-welcome') }}`

Email Body:

```

1  {{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}
2
3  <br /><br />
4
5  {{ phrase('user.emails.register-welcome') }}<br/>
6  <a href="{{ url_full('user') }}">{{ url_full('user') }}</a>
7
8  {% if not person.is_agent_confirmed %}
9    <br /><br />
10   {{ phrase('user.emails.register-agent-validation') }}
11  {% endif %}

```

Save

You'll see that the template contains code for the **Email Subject** and **Email Body**.

Let's look at the **Email Body**:

```

{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}

<br /><br />

{{ phrase('user.emails.register-welcome') }}<br/>
<a href="{{ url_full('user') }}">{{ url_full('user') }}</a>

{% if not person.is_agent_confirmed %}
  <br /><br />
  {{ phrase('user.emails.register-agent-validation') }}
{% endif %}

```

You probably recognize that some of this is HTML markup: `<br />` for line breaks and `<a href=` to make a link.

The other parts, such as `{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}` and `{% if not person.is_agent_confirmed %} ... {% endif %}`, are the template syntax.

`{{ phrase('X') }}` is the syntax to include a phrase in the email.

You can look up phrases by going to **Settings > Languages** Under **Installed Languages**, click on your default language, then **Edit Phrases**.

Default Language

English (English) ▼

Installed Languages

English (English) admin agent user

Title English
The language title as it a

Edit Phrases [Edit Phrases](#)

Under **User Interface Phrases**, click on **Emails** to see email phrases. The default content for `user.emails.greeting` is:

Dear {{to_name}},

When the email is sent, the content of the phrase is inserted into the email. Since the phrase contains the `{{to_name}}` variable, when the email is sent, the template system replaces this with the variable content, which is the name of the user.

If the email is being sent in another language, the translated version of `user.emails.greeting` from the corresponding language pack gets inserted instead. For example, here's the Spanish translation:

Phrase	Default	Translation	Custom
user.emails.greeting	Dear {{to_name}},	Apreciado/a {{to_name}}	Apreciado/a {{to_name}}

Let's suppose your marketing department has decided that user emails should start with "Hello ..." rather than "Dear ..."

You could replace `{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}` with `Hello {{to_name}}`, but that would only change the greeting for this email type, and it wouldn't be translated into other languages.

A better solution is to go to **Setup > Languages** and use **Edit Phrases** to enter and save a custom version of the phrase.

user.emails.greeting Dear {{to_name}}, Dear {{to_name}},

[Reset](#)

All the other email templates which use the phrase will now use the custom version. You can also use **Edit Phrases** to enter a custom translation for any other languages you have installed.

user.emails.greeting Dear {{to_name}},preciado/a {{to_name}}

[Reset](#)

13.2. Twig syntax basics

The templating system DeskPRO uses is called [Twig](#).

Below are the features you'll need to know to do the most common forms of customization.

Variables

You insert a variable into a template with double curly braces:

```
{{ }}
```

There are dozens of variables available for DeskPRO.

Here are some examples:

```
{{ ticket.subject }}      - the subject line of the current ticket
{{ ticket.agent.display_name }} - the user-facing display name of the
                                agent assigned to the current ticket
```

You'll find a listing of common variables below.

Tags

Twig also includes **tags** which control the logic of the template.

For example, the `{% if %}` tag lets you have a section of your template that only displays *if* a certain condition is met.

This code on a portal page:

```
{% if app.user.id %}
  <p>You are logged in.</p>
{% endif %}
```

would display the text "You are logged in" if the template could retrieve a user ID - i.e. if the user is logged in.

Other useful tags you will see in templates:

- `{% else %}` - used in conjunction with `{% if %}` to display content if its condition is *not* met
- `{% for %}` - creates a loop while a certain condition is met; you'll see this used in portal templates for displaying a list of items
- `{% include %}` - includes the content of one template within another

See the official Twig documentation at <http://twig.sensiolabs.org/doc/templates.html> for more information about tags.

Comments

You can leave comments to explain what your custom templates do. These will be ignored by the template system, but will be readable by the other admins on your helpdesk, or by your future self if you've forgotten why you made a certain change!

```
{# this is a comment #}
```

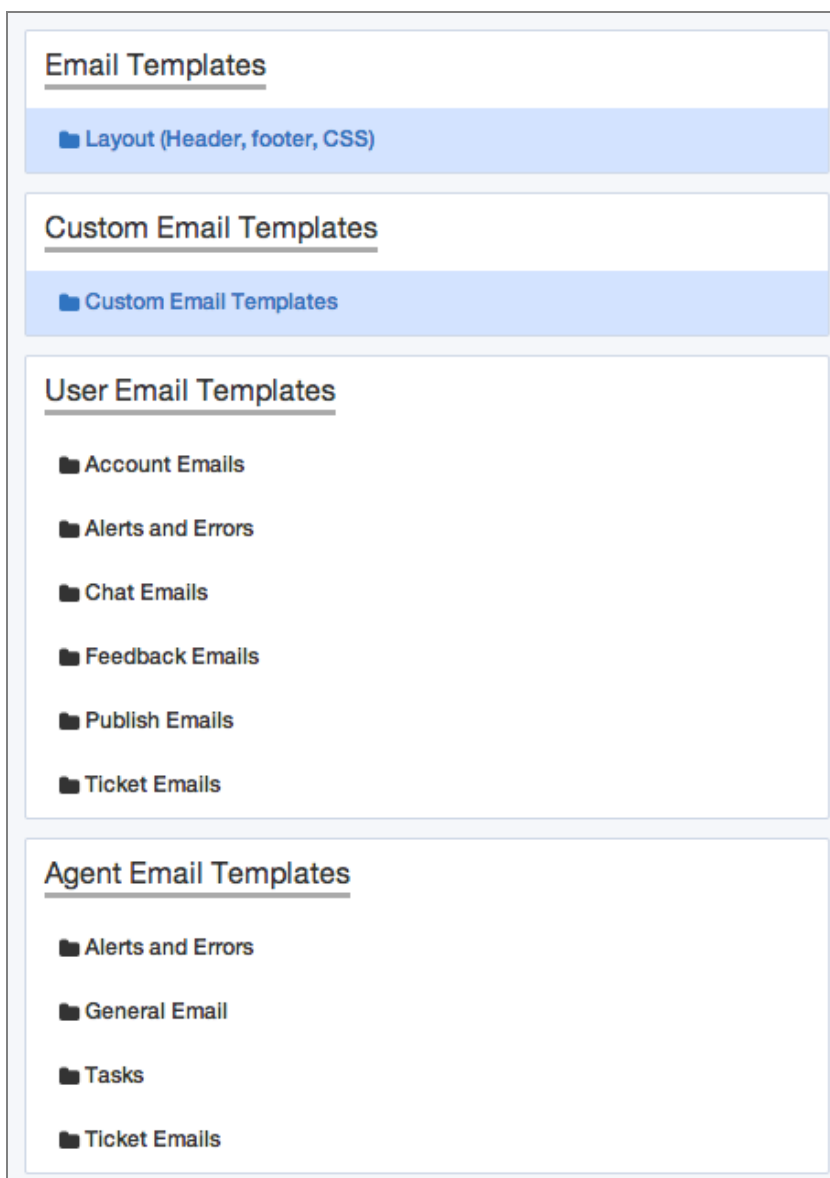
When you're troubleshooting a template, it's useful to comment out a section of code to quickly disable it, and see how the template behaves without it.

```
{# this comment wraps the code below  
{% for item in navigation %}  
    <li><a href="{{ item.href }}">  
        {{ item.caption }}</a></li>  
{% endfor %}  
#}
```

Don't use HTML comments within templates. If there are comments in a piece of inserted HTML, the two sets of comments can interact and cause mangled HTML display.

13.3. Customizing the email templates

You can access the email templates from **Tickets > Templates**.



The **Layout** templates affect the look of all emails by changing the HTML header/footer and CSS styling.

You can edit any of the existing built-in templates which are used for the emails DeskPRO sends automatically.

If you want to send an email as a result of an advanced, custom trigger, the default email templates may not be suitable. Also, bear in mind that editing a default template will change the emails sent by all the triggers that use it.

If you're sending email from a new trigger, it may be better to create a new **Custom Email Template**. You can look at the closest default templates to see which variables and existing [phrases](#) you can use.

When creating a custom template, it's always best to store the actual text of the email that recipients will read as new phrases, rather than entering it directly into the template. Even if you only use one language in your helpdesk at the moment, using phrases can make it easier to manage and update your templates.

For example, say your company slogan is "Simply the Best!" and your brand guidelines say you should use it in all outgoing email. You should store it as a phrase or add it to the email header/footer. Then, when the slogan changes, you could change it in one place instead of having to update all your templates.

Templates example: custom email auto-response by department

Suppose your helpdesk is configured to send the default automatic email response when a user submits a new ticket.

The marketing department comes to you with another great idea: users who submit new tickets to the sales department should get a custom acknowledgement email, with a 10% discount code, to reward their interest in your company.

How can you implement this?

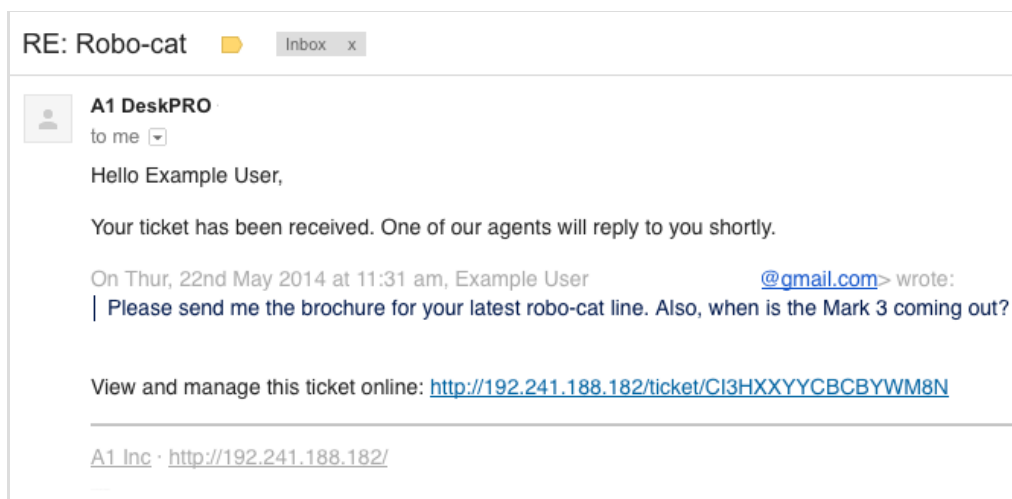
- 1 Got to **Tickets > Email Templates**, then click **Custom Email Templates**
- 2 Click **Create a New Email Template**
- 3 In the window that opens, enter a descriptive file name for the new template, e.g. `marketing-auto-response.html` . Save the new blank template.
- 4 You can use the template for the regular auto-response email as the basis for the new template. Under **User Email Templates**, click **Ticket Emails**, then **New Ticket Auto-Response**. Copy the code for the subject and body into a text editor.

Email Subject: `{{ phrase('user.email_subjects.tickets_re') }}`

Email Body:

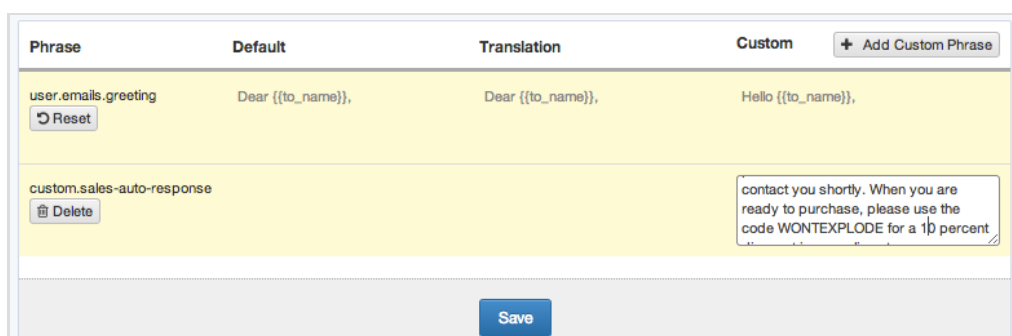
```
{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}  
  
<br /><br />  
  
{{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_received') }}  
  
<br /><br />  
  
<dp:ticket-messages />  
  
{% if app.isPortalEnabled() %}  
  <br /><br />  
  
  {{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_access_ticket_online') }}  
  <a href="{{ ticket.link }}">{{ ticket.link }}</a>  
{% endif %}
```

This is an example of the output of the default template:



- 5 To change the user message, you can remove `{{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_received') }}` and replace it with a reference to a suitable custom phrase.

- 6 Go to **Setup > Languages**, click **All Custom Phrases** then **+ Add Custom Phrase**. Enter a suitable custom phrase, then save it as something descriptive, e.g. `custom.sales-auto-response` :



- 7 Back in **Tickets > Email Templates**, edit the custom `marketing-auto-response.html` and add the code from the default response.
- 8 Replace the default `{{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_received') }}` with `{{ phrase('custom.sales-auto-response') }}` :

```
{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}  
  
<br /><br />  
  
{{ phrase('custom.sales-auto-response') }}  
  
<br /><br />  
  
<dp:ticket-messages />  
  
{% if app.isPortalEnabled() %}  
  <br /><br />  
  
  {{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_access_ticket_online') }}  
  <a href="{{ ticket.link }}">{{ ticket.link }}</a>  
{% endif %}
```

9

Now set your helpdesk so that it sends an email using the new template when a user submits a ticket to the sales department via email or the portal.

13.4. Customizing the portal templates

Editing portal and widget templates works along the same principles as editing email templates, but the templates tend to be more complicated.

If you are interested in redesigning the style of the portal, you will need HTML/CSS design skills. You can edit the **custom.css** template to override the default portal CSS.

[Expanded template editing guidance coming soon]

13.5. Useful template variables

You may recognize that many variables used in templates are the same ones you use for snippets in the agent interface.

They're also used in the DeskPRO Query Language you use when writing custom reports.

Logged-in user information

These variables will only work in contexts where the user is logged: portal or widget, but not email.

```
{{ app.user.name }} user's name
{{ app.user.email_address }} user's email address
{{ app.user.organization.name }} the name of users organization
{{ app.language.id }} - ID of user's language
```

Language

```
{{ lang.id }}
{{ lang.flag_image }}
{{ lang.title }}
```

Search results

```
{{ res.type }}
{{ res.object.id }} .title
```

Agent

```
{{ agent.display_name_user }}
```

Tickets


```

{{ ticket.subject }}
{{ ticket.department.title }} & {{ ticket.department.full_title }}

{{ ticket.fieldX }} (for custom fields; replace X with the field id)

{{ ticket.product.title }} current product of ticket
{{ ticket.category.title }} current category of ticket
{{ ticket.workflow.title }} current workflow stage of ticket
{{ ticket.priority.title }} current priority of ticket
{{ ticket.id }} ticket ID number
{{ ticket.ref }} ticket ref code
{{ ticket.fieldX }} display a custom ticket field; replace X with field ID
{{ ticket.date_created }} time and date ticket was created e.g. 2014-03-14 11:38:17
{{ ticket.agent.display_name }} name of currently assigned agent (override name if set)
{{ ticket.person.display_name }} user's name
{{ ticket.person.fieldX }} display a custom user field; replace X with field ID

<dp:ticket-messages /> list of ticket messages - NB no {{ }}

```

Ticket user information

```

{{ ticket.person.display_name }} name of user associated with ticket
{{ ticket.person.primary_email }} ticket's user's email
{{ ticket.person.organization.name }} ticket's user's organization
{{ ticket.person.organization_position }} ticket's user's position in organization
{{ ticket.person.fieldX }} for custom ticket fields; replace X with the field id

```

Ticket agent

```

{{ ticket.agent.display_name }}
{{ ticket.agent.primary_email }}
{{ ticket.agent_team.name }}

```

Ticket form

```

{{ f.title }}
{{ f.field_def.description }} xx???

```

Article

```

{{ article.person.display_name_user }} (author)
{{ article.title }} title

```

Message

```
{{ message.person.display_name_user }}
```

News

```
{{ news.person.display_name_user }}  
{{ news.category.title }}  
{{ news.content }}  
{{ news.link }}
```

Download

```
{{ download.title }}  
{{ download.content_desc }}  
{{ download.filename }}  
{{ download.readable_filesize }}  
{{ download.person.display_name_user }} - author of download  
{{ download.date_created|date('full') }} - piping
```

Feedback

```
{{ feedback.status }}  
{{ feedback.person.display_name_user }}  
{{ feedback.message }}  
{{ feedback.rating }}
```

Category

```
{{ category.title }}  
{{ subcat.title }}
```

Participant

"Participant" means a CC'd user.

```
{{ part.person.id }}  
{{ part.person.email_address }}
```

For a complete listing of DeskPRO variables, see the [DPQL Field Reference](#) article on the DeskPRO Knowledgebase. Note that not all of these variables will be available from every template; the available variables depend on context. The best way to work out what variables are available is to look at the default templates.

14. Extending DeskPRO

You can extend DeskPRO with **apps** to integrate your helpdesk with other services, or add new functions.

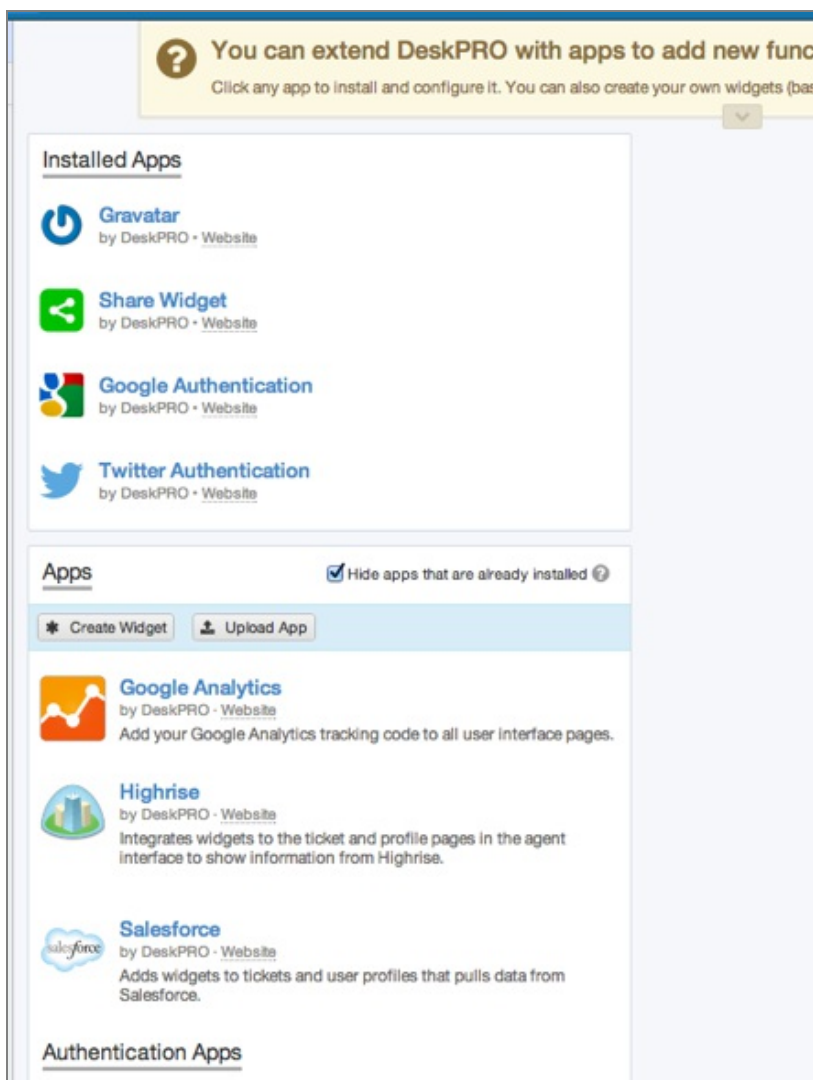
We have provided a number of ready-made apps, which you can quickly install. Some of these are **authentication apps** which enable agents or users to log in using credentials from other services, rather than a DeskPRO account. Others provide more extensive integration with other services.

We also provide two ways to develop your own apps:

- **widgets** are a simple way to customize the agent interface using HTML and Javascript
- **full apps** using the DeskPRO API require more development skills, but are more powerful

14.1. Installing the ready-made apps

We have provided a variety of ready-made DeskPRO apps to add new functionality and integration with other services.



Click on any app to install and configure it.

Most apps that operate with third-party services require you to set up an account with the service first. Some apps also require you to provide an **API token** or some other authentication code from the third-party service: consult the third-party support pages to find out how to get this.

14.2. Calling web hooks from actions

DeskPRO can use a **web hook action** (as part of a trigger, escalation, SLA or macro) to interact with external services that accept commands using the web's HTTP protocol.

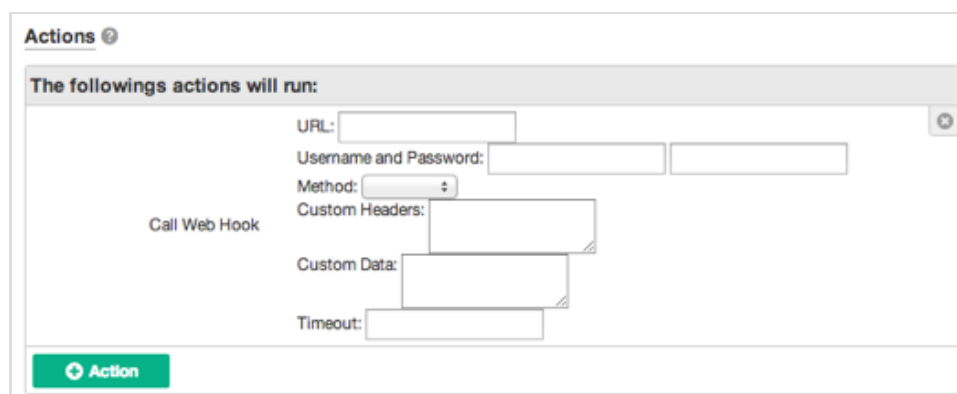
Many services offer HTTP APIs, so this provides a relatively simple way to have DeskPRO interact with other software you use (or software your enterprise has developed). For example, if a suitable API is available, you could post a warning on your intranet when a ticket fails an SLA, or send SMS notifications,

Note that this option can only send data from DeskPRO to an external service. If you want an external service to make something happen within DeskPRO, you will need to use the DeskPRO API.

To use web hooks:

- 1 Select the **Call Web Hook** action type.

- 2 Fill in the requested settings:



The screenshot shows the 'Actions' configuration window. At the top, it says 'The following actions will run:'. Below this, the 'Call Web Hook' action is selected. The configuration fields are: URL (text input), Username and Password (two text inputs), Method (dropdown menu), Custom Headers (text input), Custom Data (text input), and Timeout (text input). A green 'Action' button is at the bottom left.

You will need to consult the documentation for the software you are calling to find out the correct settings to use.

- 3 When the action runs, DeskPRO will make the specified HTTP request.

14.3. Generating DeskPRO API keys

Third-party apps which integrate with DeskPRO (including your own apps) will need a DeskPRO **API key** to gain access.

Bear in mind that anyone with access to one of your API keys can change data in your helpdesk, so you should be careful about who you share them with.

Go to **Apps > API Keys** to generate a key.

You can choose to generate a key that lets the app access your helpdesk as a specific agent account, or a key with "super user" permissions that will let the app act as any agent.

It's a good idea to make a separate key for each app you use. Delete a key if you want to permanently revoke access to an app. If a key has been compromised, you can regenerate it.

14.4. Creating your own widgets and apps

See the [Apps Developer Guide](#) on the DeskPRO Knowledgebase for how to develop widgets. You will need a basic understanding of HTML and Javascript.

The guide will shortly be expanded to explain how to create and upload full DeskPRO apps.

15. Maintaining DeskPRO Download

DeskPRO Download gives you more flexibility and control than the Cloud version, but requires server administration skills.

This chapter contains advice on maintaining and optimizing a DeskPRO Download installation.

15.1. Importing data from legacy systems

DeskPRO Download offers a flexible data importer for transferring information from other systems into your helpdesk. It can read data in CSV and osTicket formats, and with PHP programming skills, you can extend it to handle other formats, e.g. data from your own internal systems.

See the [DeskPRO Importer Manual](#) for details.

If you are using DeskPRO Cloud, please contact us at support@deskpro.com to discuss data import.

Importing data from Zendesk

If you are using DeskPRO Download, you can import the data from a Zendesk helpdesk using the Zendesk API. Please refer to the knowledgebase article [Importing from Zendesk](#) for details.

If you are using DeskPRO Cloud, please contact us at support@deskpro.com to discuss importing Zendesk data.

15.2. Securing DeskPRO

The standard security precautions for any web app software apply to DeskPRO. Here are some specific suggestions.

- 1 Make DeskPRO application files non-writable by the web server. This is good practice in general, so DeskPRO is no different.
- 2 You can go a step further and make DeskPRO files non-writable by anyone. Updating to a new version using the admin interface requires write-access to files, so if you do this, you will need to install updates manually.

The `data/` directory must always be writable by both the cron user and the web server. It's where log info and temp files are stored.

- 1 Move your `data/` directory outside of the web root. You must specify the new path in `config.php` using the `$DP_CONFIG['dir_data']` variable.
- 2 Configure the web server not to execute or serve files in the `data/` directory. This ensures that even if a malicious PHP file was written to `data/`, it cannot execute.
- 3 Regularly monitor the PHP and MySQL error logs from **Server > Error Logs** and the `data/logs/error.log` file that DeskPRO writes.

15.3. DeskPRO Download performance tuning

DeskPRO is fast and reliable enough to meet the demands of the vast majority of our customers, even on relatively modest hardware or a VPS.

If you have an exceptionally busy helpdesk, consider the following steps to optimize performance:

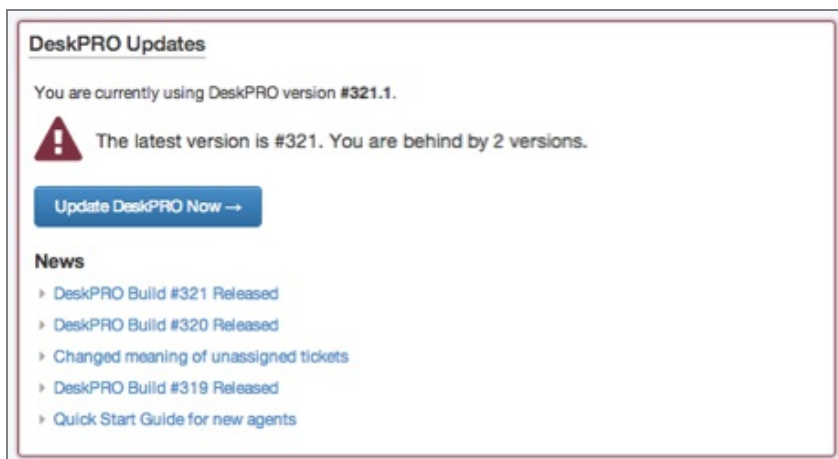
- 1 Check **Server > Error Logs** for any repeated errors that might be impacting performance.
- 2 Install a supported **PHP accelerator**:
 - [APC](#) (Alternative PHP Cache)
 - [Windows Cache Extension](#) for IIS
- 3 If you deal with very large numbers of tickets (over a million) and the agent interface is slow, enable ticket archiving via **Tickets > Statuses, Archived**.

15.4. Updating DeskPRO

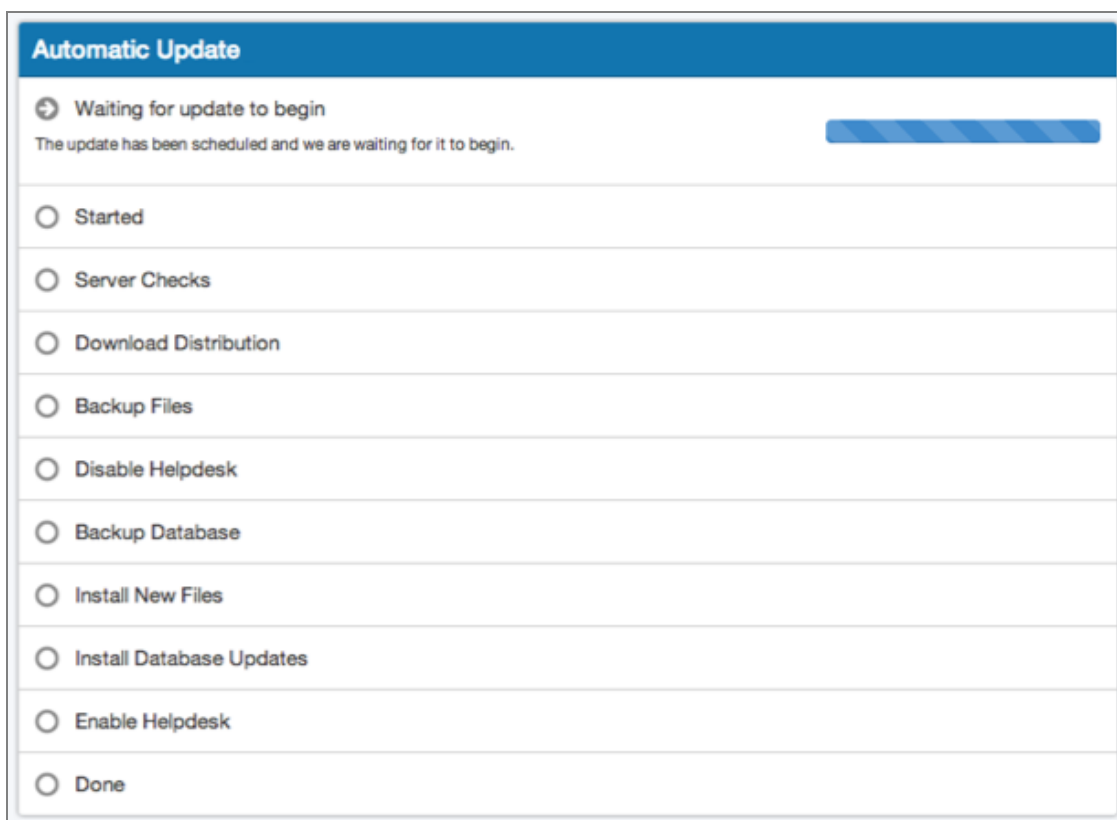
If you're using the Cloud version of DeskPRO, updating is automatic; you don't have to do anything to make sure that you have the latest version.

To update DeskPRO Download, you just have to run one of a variety of automatic upgrader tools. They handle all the details of transitioning between versions, such as database schema changes.

When an update for DeskPRO Download is available, you will be notified on the Home page. The best way to update is to use the automatic updater by clicking **Update DeskPRO Now**.



The automatic updater uses the cron/Scheduled Task system. This means the cron/Scheduled Task user must have write permissions on all DeskPRO files for the update to work. If the updater gets stuck at an early stage of the process, as shown in the screenshot below, that probably indicates a permissions problem. To work round this, you can use the command-line updater instead.



The automatic updater gives you the option to back up the database and/or the DeskPRO source files, so you can revert to them in the unlikely event there's a problem.

You can also choose to set a time delay before the update begins. This option will show an alert to any agents who are using your helpdesk, so they know to finish their work. You can use this to schedule the update for a time when there will be little usage of the helpdesk.

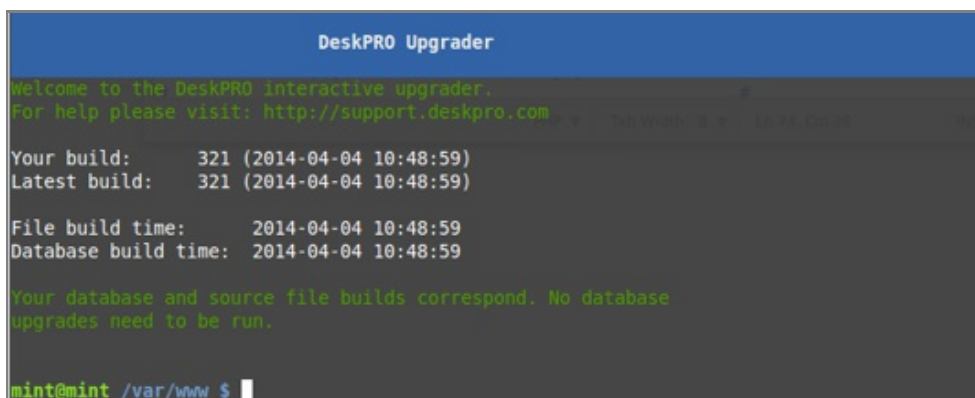
While the update happens, the helpdesk will be unavailable for a few minutes (depending on the size of your database). Under **User Offline Message** you can customize the notice that users will see on the portal during the update.

Command-line updater

If updating your configuration does not work from the admin interface, you can use an interactive command-line update utility.

From the directory where you installed DeskPRO, run:

```
php upgrade.php
```



```
DeskPRO Upgrader
Welcome to the DeskPRO interactive upgrader.
For help please visit: http://support.deskpro.com

Your build:      321 (2014-04-04 10:48:59)
Latest build:   321 (2014-04-04 10:48:59)

File build time: 2014-04-04 10:48:59
Database build time: 2014-04-04 10:48:59

Your database and source file builds correspond. No database
upgrades need to be run.

mint@mint /var/www $
```

The utility will guide you through the process of updating.

Manually installing updates

If the command-line updater does not work, you can manually update using the following steps:

- 1 Download the latest version of DeskPRO from <https://www.deskpro.com/downloads/deskpro.zip>.
- 2 Make a backup of the current DeskPRO files before you install updates in case you need to revert back.
- 3 Move the existing `data/` directory outside of the original DeskPRO install folder.
- 4 Copy your existing `config.php` to a safe place.
- 5 Extract the contents of `deskpro.zip` you downloaded in step 1, overwriting all existing files.
- 6 From inside the DeskPRO install directory, run the command-line upgrade tool:

```
php cmd.php dp:upgrade
```

The upgrade tool will ask if you want to produce a database backup before applying updates. We highly recommend you answer 'yes', in case you need to revert the upgrade.
- 7 The `data/` directory created in the install process may contain important log information, so copy it. Move the original `data/` directory from step 3 back into the DeskPRO install directory.
- 8 Move the original `config.php` file from step 4 back into the DeskPRO install directory.

15.5. Backing up or moving a DeskPRO server

You should turn off the helpdesk before moving your DeskPRO installation to a new server.

There are only two parts of DeskPRO with data that you need to copy when moving or backing up a server:

- 1 The MySQL database
To copy the MySQL database, use the [mysqldump](#) tool to dump the data (and then restore it if necessary). We recommend using the MySQL tools, not phpmyadmin.
- 2 The files on the filesystem.
Copy or move all the files within the root directory of your web server where you installed DeskPRO originally e.g. `/var/www` if you're using Apache.

When restoring a server, make sure you edit the `config.php` file to update any values that have changed in the new environment: e.g. location of your `/data/` directory. You will also need to recreate the `cron` jobs or Scheduled Tasks.

If you have moved a server and it is acting as if it is a fresh installation, check that the file `is_installed.dat` exists within your data directory.

16. DeskPRO Terminology

Admin: staff member within your company who has administrator access to configure and customize your helpdesk

Agent: staff member within your company who uses DeskPRO to provide help

Article: in the context of DeskPRO, an article refers to a piece of **knowledgebase** content

Assignment: a ticket can be assigned to an agent or a team to track who is dealing with that ticket

Chat: real-time instant messaging between agents and users; may be available to users from the web portal or integrated into a website

CRM: the app used for managing users and assigning them to **organizations** and **usergroups**; short for *Customer Relationship Management*

Downloads: useful files you provide to users through your web portal; e.g., software drivers or product manuals; maintained in the **Publish** app

Feedback: suggestions from users submitted through your **web portal**; e.g. a feature request or new product idea

Glossary: part of the **Publish** app used to maintain definitions of terms which are automatically displayed in **knowledgebase** articles

Knowledgebase: part of the **web portal** which contains rich-text help **articles**

News: part of the **web portal** which displays news posts chronologically; useful for product announcements

Organizations: used to track the company or other enterprise a user belongs to; you can assign users to organizations using the **CRM** app, or DeskPRO can automatically assign organizations based on user email addresses;

Permissions: settings which control what an agent or user can do with DeskPRO; your agent permissions are set by your admins and might, for example, prevent you deleting tickets; a user's permissions depend on their **usergroup**

Publish: the app used to maintain content for the web portal: knowledgebase articles, news posts, downloads and glossary entries

SLAs: short for *Service Level Agreements*; goals for dealing with tickets that your helpdesk aims to meet, e.g. that you must reply to a new ticket within 4 hours; shown in the **Tickets** app.

Snippets: short pieces of text which you can quickly insert into messages to users; useful to save time entering standard greetings, phrases, canned answers etc.

Status: a ticket's status is used to track who needs to act on a ticket next: **awaiting agent** means the helpdesk must do something related to that ticket; **awaiting user** means the helpdesk is waiting for the user to reply; **resolved** means the issue that ticket represents has been resolved

Tasks: an app used to track "to-do" items for agents

Teams: agents are grouped into teams to enable group ticket assignment

Ticket: represents a user question, problem or complaint; can be created automatically from incoming user email, or by a user from the **web portal**, or by an agent on a user's behalf

Ticket address: an email address that is linked to DeskPRO so that incoming emails are turned into tickets e.g. `support@example.com`

User: one of the people the helpdesk is trying to help

Usergroup: users belong to usergroups which determine what they are allowed to do and see when interacting with DeskPRO; created by admins, assigned with the **CRM** app

Web portal: the user-facing web interface of DeskPRO - can be integrated into your own website; help information on the portal is maintained using the **Publish** app